Project Odisha

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Odia Cinema
A Living Screen

Stories, People and the Places Between

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Odia Cinema: A Living Screen

Stories, People and the Places Between

By Ahimanikya Satapathy

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A film can lead us to a writer; a song can send us searching for its words. These pages follow such journeys through cinema and the people who make, preserve and show it. I began with a question about writers' livelihoods. Conversations about reaching audiences widened the search. The past offers examples to learn from, while the question of what we can do next stays open. Read through the seven parts, or begin with "Follow the central question" and follow the lives and works that draw you further.

Viewing and reading

The viewing links distinguish complete films, trailers and reference catalogues. Listings were checked in October 2026; playback, subscription and territorial access can change. Use the online viewing room for the latest recorded routes: https://projectodisha.org/cinema/watch/

Follow the central question

How can literature reach more people through cinema, and what would help its makers continue? These ten readings carry that question from a personal beginning through books, songs, films and the work of finding an audience. The connected profiles and wider survey remain close at hand for further exploration.

The question that brought me here

The page behind the screen

Basanta Kumari Patnaik

Akshaya Mohanty

Maya Miriga

Bhukha

Pratikshya

DAMaN

What makes the next film possible

Building Odia cinema together

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Ahimanikya Satapathy.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

01 The Question That Brought Me Here

A film seen with a parent can lead, years later, to a search for a book. We begin with that small journey, then meet writers whose people and words have found lives in print, performance and broadcasting. The question running through these pages is simple: what helps a story reach someone, and what helps its maker continue?

A line of poetry can travel far from the page.

I began noticing it in the folds of a sari, in stone shaped by patient hands, in a song that outlived its singer. Sometimes it returned through a familiar *Dhaga* - a few words spoken in an everyday conversation, carrying more experience than their length could hold.

Looking at Odisha, I found myself following these journeys. How did an idea become something we wore, something we remembered, something we passed on? And what happened to the person whose imagination gave it life?

These questions felt close to me. I am an artist and a poet at heart, though much of my creative life has unfolded before a code editor. Building software, I have known the pleasure of giving an idea a form another person could use. A canvas offers me that same invitation. The materials change; my desire to make something that reaches another human being remains.

For years, I had been absorbed in building my own world. Now my attention was turning towards the language and culture that had helped shape it.

Behind the things I loved were people trying to keep creating: a writer searching for a reader, an artisan seeking a fair return. Admiration

brought me closer to their work. A question about livelihood kept me there.

How could I help put money in writers' pockets?

During the pandemic, I had helped farmers sell fruit in large quantities - around 500 tonnes each season - with the aim of getting as much of the money as possible into their hands. When I turned towards Odia literature, that experience came with me.

Farming and writing have different needs. Yet I recognised a question about the distance between making something and earning from it. Who helps a work reach the people who might value it? How much of that value returns to its maker?

I wanted writers to have a fair chance to keep creating. I worried about the person who spent years writing a book, paid to have it printed, and then had to carry the burden of finding readers alone.

Art and poetry should live with people: with the person who enjoys a song without studying its metre, the child who remembers a character, the audience drawn into a performance. A book is one home for that work. I wanted to explore the others.

Odisha gave me many paths to explore. Pala, nataka and dance brought me towards the meeting of language, music, movement and an audience. Researching my own name led me towards Ahimanikya and Sashisena, and the relationship between a story and its remembered life in a place.

A child might love a melody before knowing it as poetry. A performer could make a line unforgettable. A story might enter a family's conversation long before anyone sought its written source.

Selling a poetry collection could be one way for a writer to earn. Songs, performances, adaptations and illustrated stories offered other possibilities. Royal patronage belongs to the history of sustaining art; in our own time, audiences, publishers, producers and others can

commission work, pay for its use or buy a ticket. Appreciation needed a practical expression.

Meanwhile, a poem from my own life was finding an unexpected form.

During a trip to the United States, I began turning *"I Am Free to Dream,"* which I had written as a teenager, into music. Words from my younger self returned through a voice I had not imagined for them.

That experiment grew into Kabita Without Borders and Poet Studio, an application for poets to publish and manage their work. Sri Pradeep Biswal and Sri Paresh Patnaik, whom I had known since my teenage years, encouraged my renewed involvement in Odia literature. Each beginning brought me back to the question of an audience.

For children, that question became especially immediate. At a birthday party, the need for relatable Odia cartoon characters gave it a concrete shape.

I wanted children to encounter their language through something they were excited to return to. Could affection for a character lead towards a story, and then towards a book?

It was easy to discuss what children should read or what a community should preserve. I wanted to help make things they would enjoy having in their lives.

Cinema began to gather many of these thoughts together. Here was a form in which writing, music, performance, visual imagination and technology could meet. It could carry an Odia story into a shared experience, and perhaps towards people who would never have encountered it on a bookshelf.

During a week in Bhubaneswar, I met *DAMaN* directors Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka, and producer Deependra Samal.[1] I had been thinking about cinema as a way to take literature to children. Our conversation brought me to a difficulty I needed to understand: even if

we made a good film, how would it reach people? We talked about the limited number of screens in Odisha.

I came away thinking beyond the children I had first imagined reaching. How could our literature reach ordinary people, of different ages, through cinema? Making the film was one undertaking. Getting it before an audience was another.

That question led me into this project. I began reading about the work behind the films, and about the people who found ways to show them. Conversations with writers, filmmakers and heritage storyteller Shakti Badjena kept opening further paths.[1]

A screen gathers attention around actors and stories, but many people make that encounter possible. Writers, producers, technicians, musicians, performers, distributors and exhibitors contribute different kinds of skill and take different kinds of risk. If I wanted to understand how cinema could support literature, I also needed to understand the livelihoods and relationships that sustained cinema itself.

Curiosity became research. That research is now taking shape as a book and a series of articles.

I did not set out to write a history of Odia cinema. I turned to its past to understand the people, choices and creative possibilities that might help us move forward. The history in these pages serves that exploration; it does not attempt to record every film, every contributor or every period.

Preserving a film, a script or a songbook keeps more than a date within reach. It keeps a way back to the people who made it. A viewer might find a book through a film; a filmmaker might find a writer through an older adaptation. I want those encounters to remain possible.

Cinema cannot guarantee readers or a writer's livelihood. But a thoughtful adaptation can offer a work another life. A fair agreement

can pay for that work. A film made with care can invite someone to look more closely at a place, a language, a neighbour.

That is the possibility I want to explore with makers and audiences alike. How can the achievements we already have make another beginning easier? How can our stories travel nationally and internationally while remaining attentive to the lives from which they come?

For me, this is an act of care: keeping our stories close enough for our own children to know them, and open enough for others to enter. Pride can grow from the work itself - from the attention we give it and the people we bring with us.

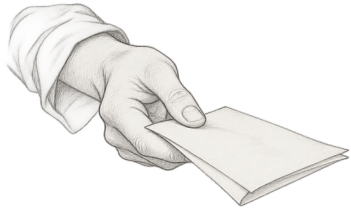
There is much I am still learning. These stories leave room for that learning - and for people whose experience may deepen or challenge what I have understood.

Through it all, a line from my teenage poem has returned:

“I am free to dream and allowed to get lost.”

I hear it differently now. The journeys through poetry, software, farming, literature and cinema are beginning to meet. Each has taught me to look for the person on the other side of what we create.

I began by asking how to put money in a writer’s pocket. The conversation about screens added another question: how would the work reach the people who might value it? These pages follow both.



What we make, and whom it reaches.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

02 The page behind the screen

A still from Matira Manisha, adapted from Kalindi Charan Panigrahi's novel. [34]

Sometimes a story comes home as a song, long before anyone asks for the book.

Manas Ranjan Mahapatra remembers watching ଆମଡ଼ା ବାଟ (Amada Bata) with his mother. Years later, working with the National Book Trust, he sought permission to publish Basanta Kumari Pattanayak's novel. In his account, Dr Narendra Prasad Das and his wife helped him reach the author; Pattanayak asked that the royalties go to the Krishnamurthy Foundation.[1]

The royalties in that recollection concern a later book edition. Even so, the journey from a childhood screening to a novelist's door gives my

question somewhere to begin. What might a film make possible for the writing behind it?

Writers who give a film its first world

A story need not wait for a screen to find listeners. Mayadhar Mansinha describes Pala and Daskathia performers carrying poetry through musical recitation, quotations in Odia and Sanskrit, and humour.[2] Their work offers another way into literature: hearing a voice interpret it before seeking the page.

A page can hold a voice before a camera finds a face for it. Basanta Kumari Pattanayak's *Amada Bata* became a 1964 film directed by Amar Ganguly, with Gopal Chhotray credited for the screenplay.[3]

Kalindi Charan Panigrahi's ମାଟିର ମଣିଷ (Matira Manisha) became Mrinal Sen's 1966 Odia film. Sen's filmography credits Panigrahi with the story and Sen with screenplay and direction.[4] In କା (Kaa), Kanhucharan Mohanty's novel meets the screenplay and dialogue of Sarada Naik; the Gour-Parbati archive names the directing collective Siddharth as Ram Chandra Thakur, Gour Ghose and Parbati Ghose.[5]

The literary sources crossed language borders too. Shyamhari Chakra identifies a novel by Bengali writer Ashapurna Devi as the basis of ସାଧନା (Sadhana, 1964).[6] Its production story follows the people who helped it reach the screen.

A novelist may give us access to a character's thoughts over many pages. A screenwriter must decide what can be seen and heard, what

can be left to an actor, and where one scene should end. Dialogue has to live in a performer's mouth. The source author remains present even when the film finds a different rhythm.

What a story asks us to notice

Fakir Mohan Senapati: writing and circulation

A commemorative bust of Fakir Mohan Senapati. [35]

Fakir Mohan Senapati worked as a teacher and an administrator. His literary life also involved printing: Ramakanta Rout records his bringing a press from Calcutta to Balasore in 1868. Making words available belonged beside writing them.[7]

In the chapter “Bhagia and Saria” of ଛମାଣ ଆଠଗୁଣ୍ଠ (Chha Mana Atha Guntha), Fakir Mohan Senapati’s narrator turns towards educated readers who know distant societies better than their neighbours. The question is deliberately ironic:

“ଆପଣାର ବା ପ୍ରତିବାସୀ ଜାତି ଓ ସମାଜର କଥା ଜାଣିବାର ଦରକାର କ'ଣ ?”

“What need is there to know about our own community and society, or our neighbours’?”

The narrator’s apparent dismissal is a rebuke to that indifference.[8]

The question reaches beyond any one adaptation. What do we learn to notice when we look closely at a place? A history of cinema can follow famous careers and prizes while attending to the labour, speech and unequal relationships that stories make visible. A familiar neighbourhood may contain lives we have scarcely learned to see.

Parbati Ghose’s chapter follows the novel’s adaptation and its credited makers. What can an actor convey without the narrator’s explanation? Where might a pause, a gesture or a cut carry the work of a sentence?

In Upendra Kishore Das’s ମଲାଜହ୍ନ (Malajanha), Satyabhama is about to go out when her father calls her back. Later, she listens from the doorway as her parents discuss finding her a groom. The first-person telling lets us hear the girl whose future the adults are discussing. When she overhears her mother objecting to the proposed marriage to an old man, she recognises her mother’s distress as concern for her.[9] Nitai Palit brought the novel to the screen in 1965; the opening credits retain Das’s name above the title.[10]

In the opening household passage of ରେବତୀ (Rebati), Fakir Mohan describes a child beside her father as he reads and sings:

“ରେବତୀ ପାଖରେ ବସି ଶୁଣୁଥାଏ|”

“Rebati would sit beside him and listen.”[11]

A few paragraphs later, Basudev gives Rebati a primer. Beside her father, she turns its pages, delighted by pictures of elephants, horses and cattle. She takes the book to show her mother and grandmother. The narrator measures that pleasure against grander possessions: kings have elephants and horses; others enjoy riding them; Rebi is happy with their pictures. Her grandmother responds impatiently. Before the alphabet lessons begin, the book has already set the child in motion, looking and showing. Reading this passage, we meet her pleasure before the work of learning to read.[11]

Writing between the stage, radio and cinema

Chhotray wrote across theatre, radio and cinema.[12] In Chhotray’s stage adaptation of *Amada Bata*, Maya reads a novel; the directions call for instrumental music and its characters’ offstage voices.[13]

The family archive for ମା (Maa) credits Chhotray and Biswajit Das jointly for dialogue, while Nitai Palit supplied screenplay and direction.[14] The AIR Cuttack chapter follows his work for listeners at home.

A writer’s movement into cinema can also involve learning a new craft. In a 2019 interview, Bijay Mishra recalled learning screenplay writing from Shyamal Mukherjee while working on ଯାଯାବର (Jajabara).[15]

Theatre also carried writing into other languages. At the 2015 Kalinga Natya Mahotsav, Pranabandhu Kar’s *Ashanta* was staged in Bengali and *Snayu Sanhara* in Hindi, according to his son Gitimoy’s account. Utsav Theatre Group performed the latter, directed by Sukumar Tudu.[16]

Songs open another path. A lyric has to find room within a tune and a voice, yet its phrasing can carry a writer’s wit and feeling. The Akshaya Mohanty chapter follows some of those exchanges through named

singers and lyricists. A remembered voice can lead us back to the person who found the words.

The connection continues

Pratibha Ray: a working life beside the fiction

Pratibha Ray in Kollam, 15 May 2010. [36]

Pratibha Ray's professional account traces a life in teaching, from schools to government colleges. She retired voluntarily as a Professor

of Education in 1998.[17] The work of education sits beside her fiction, whose journeys into performance take several forms.

Pratibha Ray's official bibliography identifies her novel ଅପରିଚିତା (Aparichita) as adapted into a film and the title story of ମୋକ୍ଷ (Moksha) as adapted into a feature.[18] *Moksha* was directed by Gouri Shankar Das and Malaya Kumar Roy, with Das writing the screenplay. It received the National Film Award for Best Feature Film in Odia for 1995.[19] A novel's sustained companionship and a short story's concentrated moment offer different possibilities to the screen.

The stage remains part of this film history. ଭୁଖା (Bhukha) grew from Manglu Charan Biswal's play, bringing folk performers' livelihoods into a Sambalpuri screen story.[20] ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା (Pratikshya) draws on a short story by Gourahari Das.[21]

Director Subhransu Das recalls the Tarang Productions team bringing him the idea for ପୁଷ୍କର (Pushkara) and handing him Sankar Tripathy's novel *Nadabindu*. After he read it, they decided to proceed with the film.[22] The official trailer's description credits Tripathy with story and dialogue, while the screenplay is credited to Debidutta Mohanty, Chitra Pattanaik and Janmejay Singh.[23]

In Fakir Mohan Senapati's ରାଣ୍ଡୀପୁଅ ଅନନ୍ତ (Randi Pua Ananta), villagers are troubled by Ananta taking fruit from their gardens. Yet they turn to him when a garden needs digging or a roof needs thatching.[24]

For the 2025 film ଅନନ୍ତ (Ananta), actor Sabyasachi Mishra described what he wanted audiences to feel: "People should feel they are watching Ananta and not Sabyasachi."[25]

A story can also travel through the care of a family. Umakanta Mahapatra's "Joseph", included in the Odia collection *Jiban Bahurupi* (ଜୀବନ ବହୁରୂପୀ), became Susant Misra's Hindi film *Josef - Born in Grace*.[26] Producer Ashok Mahapatra recalls having his father's story translated into English and approaching directors and writers with his son

Ishan.[27] Translation was part of bringing potential collaborators to the story.

A literary route also runs through producer Solila Parida. Prasanna K. Pati identified his story "The Woman from Georgia" as the source of *Desires of the Heart*. The film is in English with some Hindi dialogue; its place here follows the people carrying a story across countries, rather than an Odia-language adaptation.[28]

What returned to the writer?

The stage record gives one glimpse of writing as paid work. Kalindi Charan Panigrahi describes opera writers receiving payment per play from performing troupes.[29] That historical arrangement cannot tell us what a novelist received when a film used a book.

The credits above name literary contributions. Following those names into the agreements behind the films is harder. The public sources examined for these adaptations do not establish what the original authors received for screen use. A credit and a payment answer different questions.

That uncertainty troubles me. If adaptation is one way to sustain literature, we need to hear how its writers experienced the exchange: whether they felt recognised, what was agreed and what they received. Why is that part of the story harder to recover? The sources do not explain. Missing information cannot tell us that a writer went unpaid or was treated unfairly. It does leave a question about fair recognition and compensation that I do not want this book to pass over.

A better account could begin with writers and producers willing to describe their experience, while keeping private terms confidential where they wish. For new work, naming the author and source clearly, agreeing payment and later uses, and keeping a record of what was received would give the next conversation something firmer to build on.

Writers need not approach these conversations alone. The Screenwriters Association offers its members guidance on contracts and copyright.[30] The Screenwriters Rights Association of India accepts applications from eligible writers with story, screenplay or dialogue credits in any language; its terms make clear that joining does not mean immediate royalty payments.[31] These are practical places to explore while writers and producers work out how a particular story will travel.

When a film brings a book into view

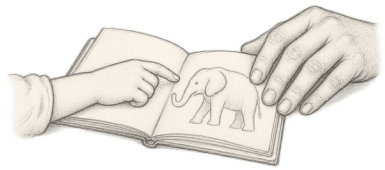
Mahapatra's remembered visit to *Amada Bata* eventually led to a new edition. His account cannot tell us how often that happens. It does give us a particular journey to follow.

A character may send us looking for a novel. A line may make us curious about the language in which it was first written. The book need not become an obligation after the pleasure of the film. It can be another pleasure waiting nearby.

Translation can keep the author close to this work of carrying a book towards new readers. In a 2026 interview, Ray recalled corresponding frequently with Kanak Hota during the English translation of *Uttarmarga*, helping clarify the novel's inner meaning.[32] Their exchange gives that collaboration a particular shape.

Spark of Light gathers Odia women's stories in English. Its co-editors, Valerie Henitiuk and Supriya Kar, recall that a Charles Wallace India Trust fellowship brought them together in England. Jatindra K. Nayak permitted a new edition of their earlier anthology; Asis Nanda helped obtain copyright permissions, while Kailash Chandra Dash found archival dates and biographical details. An encounter with a story can begin in this less visible work.[33]

Beside a film, there could be an obtainable edition, its author's name and a translation that welcomes another reader. The closing essay returns to the work that might make that possible. In *Rebati*, a child sits beside her father and listens. The words have already found someone.



The words have found someone.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

03 Basanta Kumari Patnaik: Writing, Publishing and the Screen

Basanta Kumari Patnaik. [9]

In Basanta Kumari Patnaik's story *Velvet Mites*, Nanda has sold her house to pay for two years of study abroad. Around her, the prospect of leaving takes a tender, ordinary form: Dheera's mother worries about her meals and presses more food on her. Rohan Kar's English translation lets ambition and affection share the scene.[1]

A wish to leave can sit beside the comfort of being cared for. That closeness is a way into Basanta's fiction: a large decision taking shape among small gestures. Her work belongs in a cinema reading journey through ଆମଡ଼ା ବାଟ (Amada Bata), but the screen offers only one entrance. There are other stories, other characters and the practical work she undertook to bring books into circulation.

The life within ordinary words

Jatindra K. Nayak, who translated *In Bondage*, draws attention to Basanta's irony, understatement and domestic settings. He describes the difficulty of carrying her idiomatic Odia into English.[2] His account invites a reader to notice how much can depend on the shape of an expression.

In the passage from *In Bondage* reproduced with Nayak's commentary, the narrator describes household work filling day and night. Even free time becomes knitting, leaving a pile of pullovers she wonders what to do with.[2] Here, domestic life closes around a woman's time.

His translation appears in *Spark of Light* (2016), edited by Valerie Henitiuk and Supriya Kar.[3] The anthology offers a route into her short fiction in English.

Jatindra K. Nayak: a voice reconsidered

Jatindra K. Nayak at Odia Wikisource's first anniversary in Bhubaneswar, 2015. [10]

Nayak describes narrative tone and culturally rooted characters as challenges for translation. He also says he would revisit his published translations: the work remains provisional.[4]

Making books as well as writing them

Basanta earned an MA in economics at Ravenshaw College, Cuttack. With her brother she established Shanti Nibas Bani Mandira, a publishing firm that operated from 1959 to 1962. Her novels include *Amada Bata*, *Chorabali* and *Alibha Chita*.[3]

She knew the work on both sides of a manuscript: writing it and helping it reach a reader. That publishing partnership belongs beside the novels when we remember her contribution.

A novel meets the stage and screen

The printed play names Basanta's novel on its title page, and Gopal Chhotray dedicates the adaptation to her. In his preface, Chhotray recalls a half-hour version broadcast by Cuttack radio in May 1954; encouragement led him to develop the stage play. He thanks its director, Samuel Sahu, and the actors. Basanta's response appears a few pages later. Having watched Annapurna's B group perform her story, she expresses her pleasure and praises both the dramatist and the performers. The novelist enters this record as a member of the audience, seeing her written world take shape in other people's voices.[5]

Black Eagle Books identifies *Amada Bata* with the 1964 film starring Jharana Das.[6] The film database credits Basanta's story, Gopal Chhotray's screenplay, Amar Ganguly's direction and Babulal Doshi's production.[7]

The literature-and-cinema chapter follows a later publishing connection through Manas Ranjan Mahapatra's recollection. Here, that path leads back to the woman who wrote the novel and had herself worked in publishing. Her place in the story extends beyond the moment an adaptation reached the screen.

Finding the writer again

Odisha's official award table records Basanta Kumari Patnaik's Atibadi Jagannath Das award for 2001.[8] The recognition sits beside something readers can still do: seek out a work and spend time with its language.

The film may bring us to her name. Her fiction asks us to stay: with Nanda preparing to leave, or with a woman whose apparently free hours fill with knitting. The lives on these pages have more to tell us than any single adaptation could hold.

Read her work

- In Bondage in the publisher's Spark of Light PDF - translated by Jatindra K. Nayak; printed p. 23.

- Velvet Mites in Usawa - translated by Rohan Kar.

A life within the stitches.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

04 Kalindi Charan Panigrahi: A Writer Among People

Kalindi Charan Panigrahi. [11]

Two brothers inherit land, but they do not see their inheritance in the same way. Their family lies at the centre of Kalindi Charan Panigrahi's ମାଟିର ମଣିଷ (Matira Manisha).[1] Land can be measured and divided. What people owe one another is harder to settle.

For someone arriving through Odia cinema, the title may first suggest Mrinal Sen's film. It also belongs to a much larger writing life. Panigrahi wrote poetry, stories, novels, drama, essays and accounts of lives. Following him back from the screen brings us to books and to the company of other writers.

A magazine made among friends

In his retrospective account of Panigrahi, Subash Nayak traces a circle of Ravenshaw students associated with the Nonsense Club and the Sabuja writers. A handwritten magazine, *Abakash*, later became *Shakti Sadhana*. Among the writers he names are Panigrahi, Annada Shankar Ray, Baikunthanath Pattnaik, Sarat Chandra Mukherjee and Harihar Mohapatra.[2]

A handwritten magazine makes this literary circle feel close: friends gathering work and putting it before one another. The shared page preceded the place these names would occupy in literary history.

Penguin describes the Sabuja movement through its Romanticism and inspiration from Tagore.[1] That description offers a starting point for exploring the circle. The individual poems and stories still invite their own encounters: a reader can follow a writer's name from the movement into a particular work, and discover what holds their attention there.

More than one kind of book

Alongside *Matira Manisha*, Panigrahi wrote the novels *Luhara Manisha*, *Ajira Manisha*, *Amarachita* and *Muktagadara Kshudha*. His work also includes the play *Padmini*, the essays *Sahitya Samachara* and *Sahityika*, biographies of Madhusudan Rao and Gauri Shankar, and the autobiography *Jaha Ange Nibhaichi*.[3]

These titles open different reading possibilities. Someone interested in the novelist can stay with fiction; another reader might turn to his

account of his own life or his writing about other people. A screen adaptation can introduce a name, while the books allow that first interest to develop in several directions.

Panigrahi lived from 1901 to 1991. The Sahitya Akademi elected him a Fellow in 1971.[4] The distinction belongs to the literary career as a whole, beyond the film through which some viewers may know him.

A novel reaches the stage and another language

Before the film, the brothers had already reached the stage. Panigrahi recalled several stage versions of *Matira Manisha*, including Pranabandhu Kar's version, performed by the National Music Association in Cuttack in early 1955.[5] The novelist's account gives the adapting writer and the performing group their place in the story's journey.

The Sahitya Akademi's Assamese catalogue records *Matir Manuh*, translated by Satyendranath Sarma from *Matira Manisha*. It dates the first Assamese edition to 1962 and lists a 2015 reprint.[6] Here is another route through the work, with a translator's name attached to the passage between languages.

The dates make a useful pause in a cinema-centred journey: this Assamese edition preceded Sen's 1966 film. The novel was already entering another language. Translation and adaptation offer different encounters with a story, each shaped by the people making the new work.

The story and the screenplay

Sen's filmography identifies ମାଟିର ମଣିଷ *(Matira Manisha)* as his 1966 Odia film. It credits Panigrahi with the story, Sen with screenplay and direction, and Chayabani as producer. Its synopsis describes the brothers' different attitudes towards inherited land and the pressures of the agrarian economy.[7]

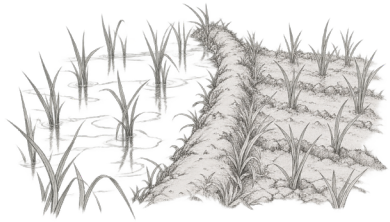
In a 1967 interview, Sen explained that he wrote the script and dialogue in Bengali; a translator rendered them into Odia. During shooting, actors and local villagers working as extras made changes.[8] The passage from page to screen continued among the people speaking its words.

For a reader who can reach both book and film, the family offers a manageable point of comparison. Follow one disagreement: what does the prose let you know, and what does the screen ask you to notice? The question leaves room for each work to make its own impression.

Begin with a book

An Odia reader can look for Black Eagle Books' 2022 edition of *Matira Manisha*.[3] In English, Penguin's *Salt of the Earth* appeared in May 2022, translated by K. K. Mohapatra, Leelawati Mohapatra and Paul St-Pierre.[1] Niyogi Books offers *Born of the Soil*, translated by Bikram Das.[9] For a wider introduction to the writer, the Sahitya Akademi lists Madhusudan Pati's monograph Kalindi Charan Panigrahi, first published in 2001.[10]

The brothers remain a place to begin. Land can pass from one generation to another; so can a story about what it means to share it. Through Odia, Assamese, English and cinema, different readers and viewers can enter that unsettled household.



A boundary within shared land.

Kanhu Charan Mohanty. [5]

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

05 Kanhu Charan Mohanty: The Household and the Wider World

An unpublished manuscript can hold the beginning of a writing life. Kanhu Charan Mohanty wrote *Utshabe Byasane* in 1923-24; it remained unpublished and was later untraced. The books that followed included *Ha Anna* in 1935, *Sasti* in 1946, *Abhinetri* in 1947 and କା (Kaa) in 1956.[1] Behind a familiar film title lies this longer companionship with writing.

Making room for the page

Financial constraints interrupted Mohanty's engineering studies. He graduated from Ravenshaw in 1929 and entered government service in 1931. Retirement came in 1964, followed by three years as secretary of the Odisha Sahitya Akademi.[1]

Writing continued through those working years: *Ha Anna*, *Sasti*, *Abhinetri* and *Kaa* appeared before his retirement.

Kaa received the **Sahitya Akademi Award in 1958**.[1] This was recognition of the literary work. The novel's later life on screen would involve another set of makers and decisions.

Home opens towards society

A critical discussion in *Orissa Review* connects *Ha Anna* and *Sasti* with famine, its aftermath and social inequality. It also considers widow remarriage in *Nishpatti*, placing rural relationships, poverty and social conventions within Mohanty's fiction.[2]

These concerns suggest why the household can be such a demanding subject for a novelist. Decisions about marriage, food and belonging

are intimate, but the freedom to make them is not shared equally. Reading Mohanty offers an opportunity to follow how such pressures enter relationships, rather than treating home as a world sealed off from public life.

His work belongs beside the other writers in this collection without becoming interchangeable with them. Basanta Kumari Patnaik brings another attention to domestic life; Kalindi Charan Panigrahi offers another encounter with family and land. Their books leave room for readers to discover differences as well as connections.

A novel finds other voices

The film *Kaa* credits Mohanty's novel as its source, **Sarada Naik** for screenplay and dialogue, and **Siddharth** for direction: Ram Chandra Thakur, Gour Ghose and Parbati Ghose.[3] Following Parbati Ghose's work brings that partnership into view.

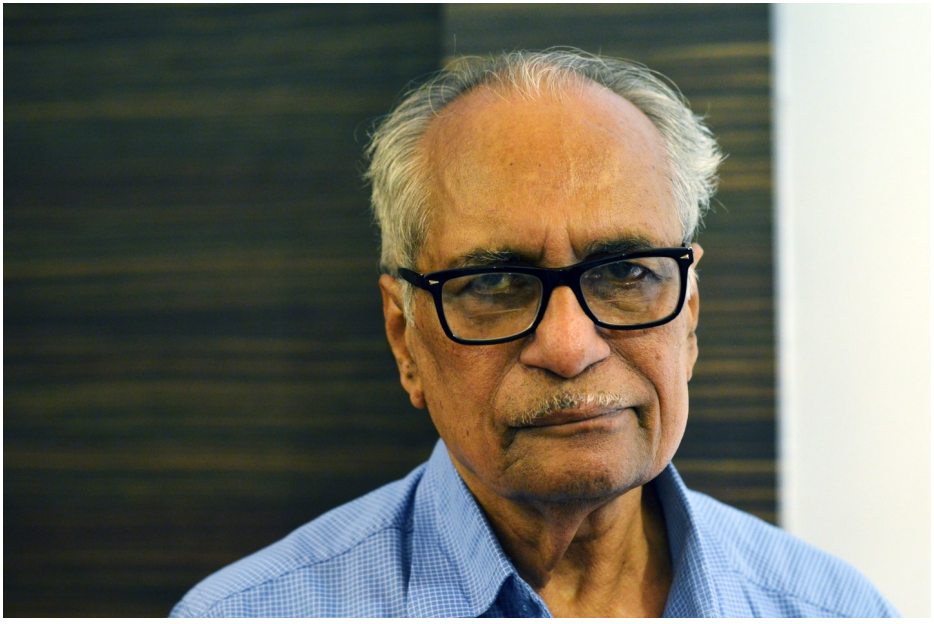
ଅଭିନେତ୍ରୀ *(Abhinetri)* also reached the screen, in a 1965 film directed by Amar Ganguly under Chhayabani Pratisthan.[4] These adaptations are part of Mohanty's continuing presence in cinema. They also offer a reason to return to the novels, where a character's life unfolds through the writer's language and the reader's time.

The literature-and-cinema reading follows that exchange more widely. Gopal Chhotray's career follows the work of finding words for performance. Between a source novel and a finished film, other people must decide what to carry forward and how to give it form.

Mohanty's place in this story begins with the page. A film may lead us there, but the writing has its own company to offer: households, social questions and lives that ask for more attention than a remembered title alone can give.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

06 Bibhuti Pattanaik: Books Within Reach



Bibhuti Pattanaik, photographed in 2015. [8]

Bibhuti Pattanaik's answer to a question about readers began with libraries. In a 2016 interview, he proposed making good books available there as a way to encourage Odia reading. He also spoke as a reader himself, naming Manoj Das, Surendra Mohanty and Rabi Pattnaik, and praising Basanta Kumari Pattanayak's *Amada Bata*.[1]

That attention to other writers also took a public form. At Sahitya Akademi's 2013 centenary seminar for Rajkishore Ray in Bhubaneswar, Pattanaik presided and discussed Ray's works.[2]

Writing about him in 2022, Kedar Mishra recalled the editor behind *Galpa* and his involvement in organising the Bhubaneswar Book Fair.

Mishra also described his work teaching Odia language and literature.[3] Books were part of that wider working life: writing them, discussing them and helping make occasions for readers to meet.

A novel reaches the screen

ବଧୂ ନିରୁପମା (Badhu Nirupama) connects that literary work with cinema. Its publisher's description dates the novel to 1965 and its Odia film adaptation to 1987.[4] Between those dates lies the distinction at the heart of an adaptation: the book has a life of its own before filmmakers take it up.

The novel can still be approached through a particular edition. IIT Bhubaneswar's library catalogue identifies a copy published by Odisha Book Store; a separate Black Eagle Books edition supplies another bibliographic route.[5, 4] For a reader arriving through the film, these records lead back to a book with its author's name on it.

His joint story credit with Nirad Mohapatra in ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga) leads to another kind of collaboration.[6]

Return to the books

His short-story collection *Mahishasurara Muhan* received the **Sahitya Akademi Award for Odia in 2015**.[7] The collection offers a further reading direction beyond the novels connected with films.

Begin with the form that draws you in: a novel, a short story, or a film that sends you looking for its writer. Then follow a name Pattanaik himself recommended. A writer's reading can become part of our own.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

07 Manglu Charan Biswal: Words for the Stage and the Page

Manglu Charan Biswal. [4]

A film can keep a play's name in circulation. A translation can bring us back to its words. In 2023, Hachette India published *The Starved*, Nirjharini Tripathy's English translation of Manglu Charan Biswal's

ଭୁଖ *(Bhukha)*.[1] For someone who knows the title through cinema, the book offers another encounter: with the writing from which the film began.

Biswal was a teacher, poet and playwright.[1] His literary life extended across plays, poems and children's stories in both Sambalpuri and Odia.[2] Following him beyond a single adaptation means making room for those different readers and listeners too.

A place, and a life of writing

He was born in Pitapali in 1935.[1] The village was later submerged following the construction of Hirakud Dam. Reporting his death in 2022, PTI named works including *Daria Parira Kabita*, *Astaragara Kabi*, *Di Dhara Luha*, *Agnisambhaba* and *Ananya*.[2]

These titles open a larger writing life beyond the familiar connection between Biswal and *Bhukha*.

The people behind the performance

His other plays include *Luraa*, *Ulgulaan*, *Baruaa*, *Maa Samlei* and *Udlaa Patar Budlaa Danga*. Hachette's introduction to *The Starved* describes five Bajnias, professional rural folk performers, facing poverty, caste discrimination and a declining livelihood.[1]

The performers' circumstances belong beside their art. A play can keep both within view: the pleasure of a performance and the lives its makers must sustain between engagements.

Bhukha belongs to his Sambalpuri writing; his wider literary life also includes work in Odia.

Returning from the screen

Biswal's Sambalpuri play became the basis of Sabyasachi Mohapatra's film *Bhukha*.[3] The film reading follows its music, audiences and circulation. Here, the connection brings the playwright into the foreground.

The English translation makes it possible to place the play beside the film and consider what each does with the performers' story.

The page behind the screen follows other writers through these exchanges. Biswal's name asks us to remember that a film's source has a life of its own - and that there may be poems, children's stories and other plays waiting beyond the work we first encountered.

A play waits for another company.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

08 Gopal Chhotray: Words Made for Voices

Gopal Chhotray. [7]

A playwright has found fame with a drama drawn from a beggar-girl's life. But what has become of her? That is the question in a 1957 radio programme notice for *Sova*, a play by Gopal Chhotray scheduled on AIR Cuttack for 8 April.[1] Even in this brief introduction, the person behind the successful story asks for our attention.

Born in Puranagarh in 1916, Chhotray made Cuttack the centre of his working life. His association with AIR Cuttack began in 1948. The archive of that life holds plays, stories, translations and unpublished scripts.[2] The radio notice catches one moment within a much longer movement of words between reading and performance.

A story finds another company

Odia Bibhaba's collection identifies ଶ୍ରୀମତୀ ସମାର୍ଜନୀ (Srimati Samarjani) as Chhotray's opera adaptation of Fakir Mohan Senapati's short story *Patent Medicine*.[2] A work of fiction had become something that singers and performers could take up together.

Fakir Mohan's story and Chhotray's musical play remain available as two encounters with the work. The AIR Cuttack chapter follows the writers and performers who gave such exchanges a home.

Room for humour

Chhotray's *Hasyarasara Natak* received the Sahitya Akademi award in 1982.[3] The recognition gives readers a particular work to seek out, with humour at its centre.

Learning from other languages

The Library of Congress notes Chhotray's translations from Hindi, Marathi and Gujarati.[4] Odia Bibhaba's catalogue includes his translation *Natasamrat* in a 1994 edition.[2] Translation was another strand in a career that continued across forms and decades.

Words within a film

In ଶ୍ରୀଜଗନ୍ନାଥ (Sri Jagannath, 1950), the Gour-Parbati archive credits Chhotray for dialogue and C.R. Mitra for screenplay and direction.[5] For ମାଆ (Maa), Chhotray shares the dialogue credit with Biswajit Das; Nitai Palit is credited with screenplay and direction.[6]

The literature-and-cinema reading follows more of these connections between originating stories and the people who transform them. Chhotray belongs to that story as a working collaborator, moving between the possibilities of a stage, a microphone and a film.

Return to a voice

The Library of Congress offers Chhotray's readings from *Pheria*, *Parakalama* and *Sei phula*.[4] They provide a direct route into the author's voice alongside the written works.

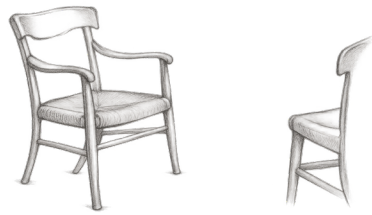
Begin with an excerpt that interests you. Where a matching text is available, place it beside the recording and notice the pace of the spoken passage. The digitised works also offer a separate route into the writing.

The question from *Sova* stays with us: what becomes of the person whose life gives a successful story its shape? It belongs beside our admiration for the playwright. Chhotray's words can still be heard, and the people within them can still ask something of us.

Read and listen

- Gopal Chhotray's literary readings at the Library of Congress - author readings, distinct from original AIR drama broadcasts.

- Digitised works in the Odia Bibhaba collection.



Room for another voice.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

09 Bijay Mishra: People, Plays and the Work of Cinema

Bijay Mishra, 2019. [6]

Bijay Mishra remembered observing people at railway stations and travelling in general compartments during his government-service years.[1] His recollection begins with attention to ordinary lives.

For readers arriving through cinema, his name opens a path back towards theatre. A screenplay is one form of writing; a play has another life, returning whenever performers take up its words. Mishra's work allows us to follow both without losing sight of the writer between them.

From poetry to a first play

In a 2013 interview, Mishra recalled beginning with poetry, then writing short stories and novels before his first play, *Janani*, in 1960. He described his characters as ordinary people facing struggles. More than five decades later, he spoke of the recently staged *Bhanga Aina*, concerned with live-in relationships and senior citizens.[2]

His account places a first play and contemporary urban relationships within one continuing practice of writing for performance.

Learning among collaborators

He recalled learning screenplay writing from Shyamal Mukherjee during ଯାଯାବର (Jajabara), which he co-directed with Hemanta Das and Akshaya Mohanty as Trimurty.[1]

The Akshaya Mohanty reading follows another member of this collaboration through songs and voices. Learning Cinema Together gathers further accounts of introductions, assistance and shared practice.

A play keeps its own life

His play *Banaprastha* received the **Sahitya Akademi Award for Odia in 2013**.[3] It offers a literary starting point alongside the films associated with Mishra's name.

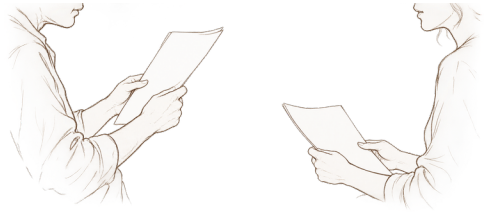
His work also travelled into other theatrical productions. The National School of Drama's festival programme identifies *Nirmaan se Nirvaan*

Tak as based on his *Tat Niranjana*.[4] A named source keeps the earlier writing visible within a new production. It gives a reader or spectator somewhere else to turn after the performance ends.

Other voices take up the words

In June 2026, Pradeep Pattanayak reported four groups performing Mishra's plays at Shruti Natak Utsav in Bhubaneswar, organised by the Odisha Sahitya Akademi and Odisha Natya Sangha. Canmass of Paradip presented *Taari Laagi*; Sobha Ebang Kalakar of Balasore, *Last Train*; Swara of Sambalpur, *Ekada Labanya*; and Damayanti Kala Parishad of Kotpad, *Janta*. The performances used live dialogue without elaborate costumes, lighting or props.[5]

Gopal Chhotray's story offers another passage through writing made for voices. Mishra's plays invite a further encounter of their own: choose a title, seek a text or performance, and listen for the people it brings into conversation.



Words passed between voices.

PART 1 · A SHARED STORYTELLING WORLD

10 ଆକାଶବାଣୀ କଟକ | AIR Cuttack: where stories found another voice

All India Radio, Cuttack, photographed in March 2013. [14]

A radio play gives the listener no stage to look at. A voice must establish who has entered; a pause can change the meaning of a reply. Music can carry a transition that a film might show through an image. The listener supplies a room, a face, a distance. This makes radio an art of collaboration between people making sound and people imagining what it means.

AIR Cuttack belongs within the history of Odia storytelling for that reason. Its importance reaches beyond the installation of a transmitter. It offered another place for writers, actors and musicians to work, and another form in which a story could meet its audience.

Before Cuttack had its own station, Odia drama had a place in AIR's programme listings. For **22 April 1939**, Calcutta 2 scheduled କେଦାର ଗୌରୀ **(Kedar-Gouri)**, an Odia playlet. The listing credits Adwaitya Chandra Mohanti with writing and production, Nittyananda Sarma with music, and Abani Mukherjee with musical effects.[1] Writing, music and the shaping of sound were being planned together.

1948: a new institution in a city of stories

All India Radio's Cuttack station opened in **1948**. The district administration's history places its early establishment in the old Madhupur building.[2] Radio enthusiast Jose Jacob's account of an engineer-guided visit dates the inauguration to **28 January 1948**: a temporary studio at Madhapur House and a small transmitter at Killa Fort.[3]

ସୀତା ବିବାହ **(Sita Bibah)** appeared in 1936, before AIR Cuttack. The cinema history follows its earlier stage connections.[4]

What followed was an overlapping history. A writer could work for theatre and broadcasting, then contribute dialogue to a film. A literary work could become a musical play. These movements are more revealing than a simple sequence in which one medium replaces another.

A connection

In the literature reading, Rebati sits beside her father and listens. Radio asks a household to imagine through sound. Chhotray's work carries this thread between writing and performance.[5]

Gopal Chhotray: the writer between the media

Gopal Chhotray connects this history with theatre and cinema. The Library of Congress recognises his contribution to reviving Gitinatya, the verse-based musical-play tradition.[5]

The Gour-Parbati film archive credits him with dialogue for ଶ୍ରୀଜଗନ୍ନାଥ **(Sri Jagannath, 1950)**. The same record names C.R. Mitra for direction and screenplay.[6]

For a dramatist, dialogue is more than information. It must reveal a relationship, sustain an exchange and give an actor something to do with a line. The same writer's presence in different media gives us a way to investigate how those skills travelled.

A short story becomes a musical play

Odia Bibhaba's Chhotray collection identifies ଶ୍ରୀମତୀ ସମାର୍ଜନୀ **(Srimati Samarjani)** as an opera adapted from Fakir Mohan Senapati's short story *Patent Medicine*.[7]

Senapati opens with a household rule: Chandramani may take a short walk, but must remain within his wife's sight. Chhotray turns that confinement into a musical complaint. In the printed play's opening, Chandramani sings about his predicament; Sulochana enters and asks whether he is crying. He insists that he is singing. His lament has become an argument between two voices. Chhotray explains in his preface that the play is led by song, with much of its dialogue also

written in song metre. A story has acquired another way to meet its audience.[8]

Pala, Daskathia and Prahallad Nataka have their own performance arrangements and histories. They offer further ways to listen for the relationship between narration, song and an audience.

From stage response to studio recording

Radio musicians also helped make performances that listeners could not see. Recalling programmes organised by Cuttack's Kumar Utsav Samiti, dancer Kumkum Mohanty describes students from Kala Vikash Kendra and the National Music Association joining AIR artists. Gobind Tej was among the scriptwriters guiding Kelucharan Mohapatra's choreography; Bhubaneswar Mishra composed the music, while AIR staff played violin, flute and harmonium. The dance belonged to the stage. In her account, AIR recorded and broadcast only the music.[9]

Lyricist Devdas Chhotray gives a performer's view of the difference. In an interview conducted by Shyamanuja Das in 2018, he contrasts studio singing with a stage performance shaped by immediate audience response. Devdas recalls that his first recorded ghazal was composed and sung by Akshaya Mohanty for AIR Cuttack, and explains that such songs were placed under the programme category *adhunika*.[10]

For Devdas, a newly recorded song also had to find a place within the station's listening life.

A stage performer can notice a response and extend a phrase. A recording fixes a particular performance for another listening situation. That difference helps explain why the same song or dramatic passage can acquire another rhythm when it moves between media.

Who had the opportunity to be heard?

The history also needs the experiences of women performers. In an interview with David Dennen and Amir Kumar Jeetendra Nayak, Shyamamani Devi recalled opposition from relatives to a girl singing publicly, alongside encouragement within her family. She remembered becoming an Akashvani child artist in 1950; the cited recollection does not identify a station, so it belongs here as a wider broadcasting connection.[11]

A transmitter could carry her voice only after she had found a way to sing. The encouragement and opposition she remembers belong within broadcasting history as surely as the studio and its equipment.

Making room for musicians

Programme leadership could help creative work find a home. In a 2020 retrospective, **Shyamanuja Das** credits station director **P.V. Krishnamoorthy** with encouraging lighter music and convening informal exchanges among musicians and lyricists at AIR Cuttack. Das draws on published recollections and artists' accounts. The contribution was to make space for collaboration; the singers, composers and writers remained its creators.[12]

The work behind the voice

Jacob's 2008 visit account describes specialised rooms in the studio complex opened in 1977: spaces for talks, drama, music, dubbing and playback. He observed computers alongside reel-to-reel tapes. His account also recalls transmission disruption during the 1999 cyclone and the effort to restore service.[3]

These are dated observations, but they help recover a less visible part of cultural history. A broadcast depends on technical work as well as a script or singer. Recording, editing, scheduling and transmission determine whether a performance can reach a listener at all.

Preserving that history means remembering engineers and programme staff alongside the names printed on books and records.

Listening now, preserving what remains

The listening continues. Akashvani's official Cuttack page provides dated Odia news bulletins online.[13]

The Gopal Chhotray profile offers a route into the writer's work, with links for reading and listening. Listening to an author read, we meet the pace and grain of a voice. The next chapters follow songs into that intimate space between a performer and someone listening.

Watch and explore

- **Literary audio catalogue: Gopal Chhotray at the Library of Congress.** Author readings, not original AIR drama broadcasts.

- **News audio listings: Akashvani Cuttack bulletins.** Browse dated bulletins; not a complete historical radio archive.

A voice travels from the radio into daily life. In the next part, songs carry their own stories beyond the screen.

A voice finds a listener.

PART 2 · SONGS AND VOICES

11 Odia Cinema Music: The Songs We Carry Home

A melody can leave the theatre with us. Inside it are words someone chose, a tune someone shaped and a voice that made them intimate. These lives bring us closer to the shared work within songs we may already love.

Trupti Das at the Odisha State Television Awards, 2014. [22]

A song can be the part of a film we keep closest. We may forget the order of its scenes and still want to hear a voice again. Following that wish can lead us back into the film - or towards another singer,

another soundtrack, another person whose name deserves a place beside the melody.

Take ମମତା *(Mamata)*. “Re Mita Aa Sangata” brings **Pranab Kishore Patnaik** and **Sikandar Alam** into the same recording, with music by Prafulla Kar and words by **Sibabrata Das**.[1] Elsewhere on the soundtrack, **Chitta Jena** and **P. Susheela** sing “Dekhi Se Banamalli,” again with Kar’s music and Das’s lyrics.[2]

The poem inside the soundtrack

A novel can give a film its story while other writers supply its songs. In ମଲାଜହ୍ନ *(Malajanha)*, Upendra Kishore Das’s name appears above the title, while Kabisurya and Banamali appear under lyric-writing. The singing credits include Kalyani Bhattacharya, Nandita Ghosh, Pranab Patnaik and Akshaya Mohanty.[3]

“ଗଲାଣି ତ ଗଲା କଥା, ରେ ସଙ୍ଗାତ !” - “What is past is past, my friend.” The opening belongs to Kabisurya Baladeva Rath’s *Ga Champu* in *Kishore Chandrananda Champu*, reproduced in Kalicharan Pattnaik’s *Champu Prabesha*.[4] The film excerpt of “Galani ta gala katha” credits Akshaya Mohanty as singer and composer in its upload description.[5]

Kavisurya Baladeva Rath and Banamali Das also appear in Srjan’s account of the poetry performed in Odissi abhinaya.[6] Following these names offers a path from a film’s soundtrack to dance, and back to the written word.

Kalicharan Pattnaik’s ସିନେମା ସଙ୍ଗୀତ *(Sinema Sangita)* (1941) brings another kind of page into this musical story. Its opening entry places Hindi and Odia song texts side by side, then aligns their syllables beneath shared musical notation.[7]

The possibilities inside a voice

Pranab Patnaik described that shared work from a singer’s side. In a 2017 interview, he remembered successive composers finding different possibilities in his voice. His profile follows that learning through composers, languages and regular practice.[8]

That is a generous way to approach a long career: listen for what changes when a familiar singer works with a different composer. Recognition of a voice can sit beside the surprise of hearing it do something new.

Women in the shared musical story

Geeta Patnaik joins **Akshaya Mohanty** in “Danei Das Kahere Bhai” from ଯାଯାବର *(Jajabara)*; **Trupti Das** sings with him in “Gadi Chale Pachhei.” Saregama credits Mohanty as the film’s composer.[9] His dedicated profile follows these exchanges more closely, alongside the writers who worked with him.

Bhubaneswari Mishra offers another starting point with “Tiki Mora Naa Ti” in କୃଷ୍ଣ ସୁଦାମା *(Krushna Sudama)*.[10]

The movement between recordings and listeners also reaches beyond the cinema hall. The AIR Cuttack story follows broadcasting as another setting for words and music. A singer’s work may be encountered through a film, a radio recording or a concert; each encounter can prompt us to look for the others.

The stage brought these kinds of work together too. Gopal Chhotray’s stage adaptation of Basanta Kumari Patnaik’s ଅମଡ଼ା ବାଟ *(Amada Bata)* credits Narasingha Mahapatra with lyrics, Balakrushna Das with the musical setting and Samuel Sahu with direction.[11]

Tapu’s choices, and a newer duet

Tapu Mishra’s work reached beyond film playback to stage performance and the non-film Hindi single “Bali Umariya.” Her profile follows her choices and plans for making songs.[12]

Her voice also meets **Humane Sagar’s** in the title song of ଇସ୍କ ତୁ ହି ତୁ *(Ishq Tu Hi Tu)*. The recording credits both singers, **Abhijit Majumdar** as composer and **Nizam** as writer.[13] Reporting on Sagar’s career identifies the 2015 film’s title track as a breakthrough.[14]

Other voices to follow now

Aseema Panda's training began with Odissi music under Prafulla Kumar Sahoo, followed by Hindustani music under Artatrana Bhola. In her account, that learning sits beside the film work for which she received state best-singer recognition, ମୁଁ ଖାଣ୍ଟି ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଝିଅ *(Mu Khanti Odia Jhia)*.[15]

Diptirekha Padhi and **Sabisesh Mishra** share "Bhala Paigali Tate" from ତୁ ମୋ ଲଭ୍ ଷ୍ଟୋରୀ-୨ *(Tu Mo Love Story 2)*, as the official Tarang Music recording credits show.[16]

Journeys beyond Odia film

An Odisha musician's wider career can introduce another language or another form of performance. **Krishna Beura** recalled Salim Merchant recommending him for "Maula Mere Lele Meri Jaan" in the Hindi film *Chak De! India*. He credited **Salim-Sulaiman** with the composition and **Jaideep Sahni** with the words; the label names Krishna and Salim Merchant as singers.[17, 18] The connection is part of Hindi playback history, carried by an artist from Odisha.

Sona Mohapatra's "Ambarsariya" in the Hindi film *Fukrey* brings another collaboration into view: **Ram Sampath** composed the music and **Munna Dhiman** wrote the lyrics.[19]

Rituraj Mohanty sang "Sahib" for the Hindi film *Bhoothnath Returns*, also with music by Ram Sampath and lyrics by Munna Dhiman.[20] His victory in *India's Raw Star* in November 2014 belongs to television, a separate achievement from that film recording.[21] The two settings offer different ways an audience might first encounter the same singer.

Keeping the work beside the song

The literature and cinema reading begins with writers. Music brings that question close to the ear: whose words are these, who shaped the tune, and who performed it? A concise, dependable credit can help the next listener find all three.

Krishna Beura also spoke in favour of live recording, where singers and instrumentalists could work together and musicians could earn from the session.[17] His preference brings the people making the accompaniment into the conversation about a singer's work.

There is practical work here for producers and labels. Agreements could make payment, credit and permitted uses clear before recording begins; a release could carry complete contributor information alongside the audio. Reissues could retain the earlier recording's identities while distinguishing a new arrangement or performance. Such agreements would need to fit the particular recording and the people making it.

The cinema economics reading asks how money moves through a production. Music belongs in that conversation: singers, lyricists, composers and instrumentalists need paid work as well as recognition. For listeners, a smaller action is available now. Follow an official recording, read its credits, and let a familiar song introduce someone new.

PART 2 · SONGS AND VOICES

12 Akshaya Mohanty: Khoka Bhai and the art of singing to people

ଅକ୍ଷୟ ମହାନ୍ତି - Akshaya Mohanty, remembered as Khoka Bhai. [10]

“Khoka Bhai” is a name with room for affection: Akshaya Mohanty remembered with the familiarity of a brother.[1] It offers a way into his

work, through the kinds of company a song can invite - a teasing answer, a shared refrain, words that leave space for another voice.

His songs also lead to writers, fellow singers and a historian he encouraged to search old newspapers. Their recollections bring the musician into company.

The pleasure of an answer

One useful way to approach his *rasika pana* is through the pleasure of exchange: affection, teasing, a question and a quick reply. Flirtation can be part of that world without explaining all of it. Humour also depends on timing and on allowing the other person an answer.

In a public caption headed "ଲୋକପ୍ରିୟ ଛାଞ୍ଚ", film historian Surya Deo discusses a duet by Akshaya Mohanty and **Trupti Das**, with lyrics by **Sirshananda Das Kanungo**. Deo draws attention to a folk-shaped pattern of question, answer and retort, and to a simple, expressive delivery.[2] His account directs attention to something shared: the lyric creates an exchange, and two singers carry it.

From a voice in a film to making its music

Mohanty entered cinema as a playback singer in ମାଆ **(Maa)** in the late 1950s, under composer **Bhubaneswar Mishra**, alongside fellow playback singers **Pranab Patnaik** and **Ila Chakraborty**.[3] By ମଲାଜହ୍ନ **(Malajanha, 1965)**, he was its music director.[4] A voice heard within a film was now helping shape its musical world.

A later return screening of *Malajanha* brought some of that company together again. A 2011 report identifies Mohanty as producer, music director and singer. **Pranab Patnaik** recalled hearing songs he had sung; actress **Jharana Das** attended, and **Binodini Debi** was honoured as a lyricist.[4] Her words belong in the account beside the voices. A film's music is made through such contributions, even when one name becomes its most familiar point of entry.

More than one voice in Jajabara

The song catalogue for ଯାଯାବର **(Jajabara, 1975)** gives another small map of collaboration. Saregama credits Mohanty as composer and lists **Pranab Kishore Patnaik** singing *Hai Se Harini Akhi*, **Geeta Patnaik** with Mohanty in *Danei Das Kahere Bhai*, and **Trupti Das** with him in *Gadi Chale Pachhei*.[5]

Words worth keeping beside the music

Lyricist **Devdas Chhotray** remembers Mohanty's pleasure in words, wit and repartee. He also recalls a book of Ghalib beside Mohanty's bed - and buying his own copy at Cuttack railway station.[6] That small journey from one reader's bedside to another reader's hands belongs beside the story of their songs.

Mohanty also wrote beyond the immediate demands of a film. Shyamanuja Das's study discusses collections including *Ei Katha Rahila* (1962), *Geeti* (1968) and *Madhushala* (2001), the last edited by **Renubala Mishra**. Das describes the four pieces on the 1984 album *Kalankita Nayaka* as written, composed and sung by Mohanty.[7] The singing and the writing were both part of his work.

A musician who sent a historian to the newspapers

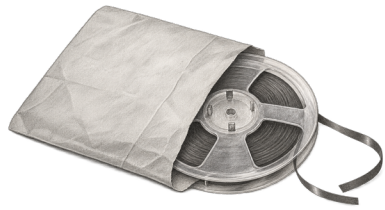
Surya Deo recalls Mohanty encouraging him to search old newspapers for information about Odia films.[8] The suggestion gave his curiosity somewhere concrete to go.

The advice has a practical generosity. A newspaper may preserve something that memory alone cannot settle: a credit, an announcement, a response from the time. The Surya Deo profile follows that wider work of collecting and sharing. Remembering a musician can include following the paths he encouraged others to explore.

Let the next listener find the song

A 2016 Prasar Bharati archive announcement described *Punyara Nadi Tire*: thirty-five Akashvani Cuttack recordings of Mohanty spanning four decades.[9] His preserved work therefore reaches beyond film soundtracks into broadcasting, another setting in which a voice could meet its listeners.

A recording kept within reach can still bring people together: a listener returning to a familiar voice, or a musician discovering words to carry into a new performance. Trupti, Geeta, Pranab and Binodini belong beside Mohanty in that continuing company.



A song kept within reach.

Prafulla Kar in Bhubaneswar, 2014. [9]

PART 2 · SONGS AND VOICES

13 Prafulla Kar: A Composer in the Company of Voices

Pranab Patnaik remembered a birthday request. At a celebration for Prafulla Kar at Rabindra Mandap, Kar asked him to sing his compositions “Majhire” and “Re Atman.” Recalling their long friendship after Kar’s death, Patnaik kept that occasion among his memories.[1]

In Pranab’s story, a song could recall years of working with its composer. Here it was also a request from a friend.

A singer who made music for others

Kar entered film playback with ଶ୍ରୀ ଶ୍ରୀ ପତିତପାବନ *(Shri Shri Patita Pabana)* in 1962 and made his debut as a film music director with ମମତା *(Mamata)* in 1975.[2] These were different responsibilities within the same musical world: singing a part and shaping music for a production.

His work also reached the microphone through All India Radio and Doordarshan. The Sangeet Natak Akademi’s 2015 citation describes him as a vocalist, composer and lyricist.[3] Individual recordings bring those roles into focus.

A soundtrack with several companions

The cinema-music reading follows two of *Mamata*’s duets, composed by Kar with lyrics by Sibabrata Das.[4, 5]

Another song, “Mu Ta Manisha Marini,” gives Sikandar Alam the singer’s credit, Kar the music-direction credit and Sibabrata Das the

lyric credit.[6] Kar and Das worked across these changing combinations of voices.

Hearing the composer sing

The distributed soundtrack listing for ଶେଷ ଶ୍ରାବଣ *(Sesa Srabana)* credits him as composer and main artist for “Kali Kapali.”[7]

His musical range also included compositions for Odissi dance dramas.[2] Film, broadcast and dance place music in different relationships with words, performers and an audience. The AIR Cuttack reading follows one of those wider settings, where a song could have a life beyond its place in a film.

Recognition, and the recordings that remain

The Sangeet Natak Akademi honoured Kar for Sugam Sangeet in its awards for 2015, presented on 4 October 2016. He also received the Padma Shri in 2015.[3, 2] Earlier, the Odisha Society of the Americas recorded its own 2012 lifetime achievement award for his contributions as singer, music director, composer and lyricist.[8]

Pranab’s birthday recollection leaves a more personal invitation: return to “Majhire” or “Re Atman,” the songs Kar asked his friend to sing.

A friend asks for a song.

PART 2 · SONGS AND VOICES

14 Pranab Patnaik: A Voice That Kept Learning

Pranab Patnaik performing in Bhubaneswar, 2014. [6]

Pranab Patnaik remembered learning Urdu from friends while an undergraduate at Aligarh Muslim University. Singing Urdu poetry and

listening to ghazal singers helped him develop his style. Recalling that learning in 2017, he also spoke of sustained *riyaz* - practice.[1]

A voice among composers

Patnaik said successive composers had explored his voice differently. Among them were Akshaya Mohanty and Prafulla Kar.[1]

His duet with Sikandar Alam in ମମତା *(Mamata)*, "Re Mita Aa Sangata," opens the cinema-music reading.[2]

"Hai Se Harini Akhi," from ଯାଯାବର *(Jajabara)*, carries Patnaik's voice in a composition by Akshaya Mohanty.[3] Kar and Mohanty are two of the composers in the wider Odia cinema-music story; here their songs meet in one singer's career.

A wider musical life

Patnaik's work extended beyond film playback into devotional, folk, Odissi, semi-classical and ghazal music. His collaborators included Vani Jairam, Usha Mangeshkar, S. Janaki and P. Susheela.[4]

An honoured career, an open door to listening

Patnaik received seven Odisha State Film Awards. His selection for the Jayadev Puraskar **for 2016** was announced in **November 2017**, recognising his lifetime contribution to Odia cinema.[4, 5] He died on 21 August 2026, aged 88, after a musical career spanning more than five decades.[4]

A first encounter with that career need not be an enormous playlist. Begin with "Re Mita Aa Sangata" or "Hai Se Harini Akhi," then follow whichever song holds your attention. There is room for a new listener in this musical company, as there was once room for the young singer learning from his friends.

PART 2 · SONGS AND VOICES

15 Tapu Mishra: A Singer Choosing Her Own Work

Tapu Mishra, Bhubaneswar, 2016. [4]

In 2018, Tapu Mishra was thinking about which work to accept. She said she had become selective about stage appearances and film

playback, and wanted to create new songs through her own production house.[1]

From Sambalpur to film songs

Mishra grew up in Sambalpur and began singing young. She attended Sambalpur University and obtained a music degree from Gandharva Mahavidyalaya. Her film career began with Himanshu Parija's କୁଳନନ୍ଦନ *(Kulanandana)* in 1995; "Na Re Na Bajana Bansi" from ଆଇ ଲଭ୍ ୟୁ *(I Love You)* brought her wider recognition.[2]

Her career continued across film songs, bhajans and recordings in languages including Bengali and Hindi.[2]

A duet, and a song outside cinema

Tapu and Humane Sagar shared the title song of ଇସ୍କ ତୁ ହି ତୁ *(Ishq Tu Hi Tu)*. Abhijit Majumdar composed the music and Nizam wrote the words.[3] The recording places her within a newer chapter of the Odia cinema-music story, alongside a fellow singer whose voice also became closely associated with contemporary film songs.

Another project took a different form. Her Hindi single "Bali Umariya," with music by Sushil, was released by Venus on 14 February 2018. It was a music video outside a feature film, with Poonam Mishra appearing on screen.[1]

The work she left, and the choices she voiced

Mishra won four Odisha State Film Awards and also released albums through her own YouTube channel. She died on 19 June 2021.[2] Alongside that loss, her recordings preserve the work itself, while her interview preserves something more personal: her wish to choose carefully and make new music.

Her plans for making new songs leave a practical question for the economics reading: what would give a singer the time and resources to choose her next work?

The songs lead us back towards the screen - and the many people who helped it become a place for Odia stories.

Choosing the next work.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

16 Odia cinema: the world in our own voice

The voices now meet a screen. A household, a village, a child's imagination: each becomes a world people make together. The history gives us our bearings; the films and lives that follow let us stay with the choices, friendships and labour behind a finished work.

Pranab Das with Bijay Mohanty and Mihir Das; dated 1989 by the source. [95]

On 27 June 2024, ମାୟା ମିରିଗ *(Maya Miriga)* met an audience again in Bologna. Its restored images carried an Odia household story into another generation of viewing.[1]

Nirad Mohapatra's film asks what family gives its members - and what it withholds. His programme note holds warmth alongside daughters-in-law's desire for freedom.[1] Bringing that story back to the

screen required people to work with a badly damaged negative. The screening was an achievement in preservation as well as an encounter with a film.

A writer's words find actors; a production finds its audience. Between them lie rehearsals, borrowed spaces, recording sessions and the work of keeping a finished film available. This collection follows those connections through particular films and careers.

The first Odia film: Sita Bibah, 1936

Odia cinema's first feature was ସୀତା ବିବାହ *(Sita Bibah)*, made by Mohan Sundar Deb Goswami. Film writer Kapilas Bhuyan's IFFI retrospective records its formal opening in Puri on **28 April 1936**, after a Calcutta screening the previous month. The next Odia feature, ଲଳିତା *(Lalita)*, arrived in **1949**.[5]

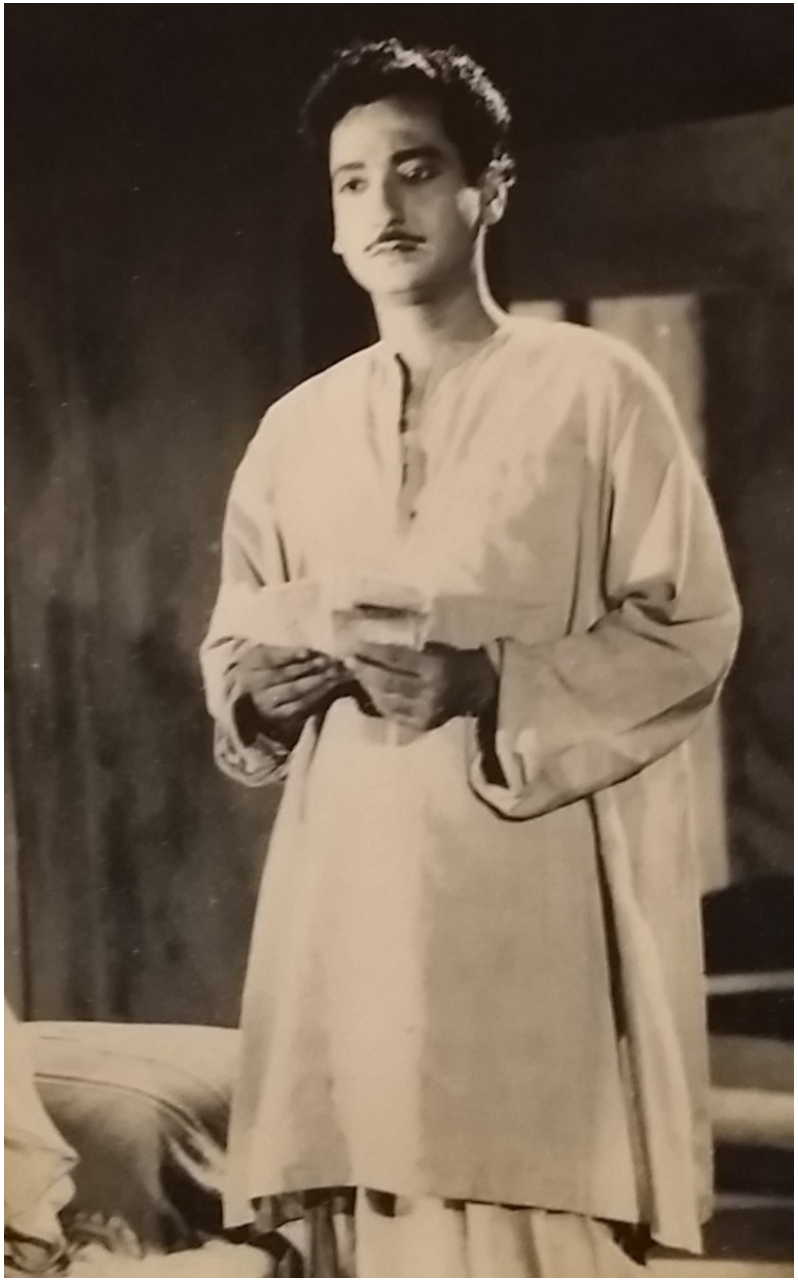
Thirteen years is a striking interval. A first film establishes possibility; it does not by itself establish a continuing industry. The familiar anniversary date deserves to be remembered alongside the difficulty of making the next film.

Music was present from the beginning. Bhuyan records fourteen songs in *Sita Bibah*, sung by its actors, and a move to background singing in *Lalita*. Later films drew on Odia literature, including ଅମଡ଼ା ବାଟ *(Amada Bata)*, ମଲାଜହ୍ନ *(Malajanha)* and ମାଟିର ମଣିଷ *(Matira Manisha)*.[5]

The screen offered another life to words and voices already circulating through the culture. Writers and composers helped shape that life alongside directors and performers.

The companion survey follows the wider history.

One of those beginnings took shape around Gour and Parbati: a partnership in performance and in making films.



Gour Prasad Ghose, from the archive's Maa gallery. [5]

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

17 Gour Prasad Ghose: from the stage to making films

A film version of *Bhata* was planned, but never made. Among the people involved were Gour Prasad Ghose, Nitai Palit and Gobinda Tej; they went on to form the United Artists theatre group.[1] An unfinished film had brought future collaborators together.

Gour Prasad Ghose (1929-1994) would work as actor, producer and director, later extending his work into television.[1]

The stage before the screen

The Gour-Parbati archive traces his early acting to Ravenshaw College in Cuttack and to theatre under the name Rai Gour. It recalls his participation in Manoranjan Das's *August Na* and Kalicharan Patnaik's *Bhata*.[1]

The film remained unmade; the theatre group continued the association. In Gour's early career, the people gathered around a story could matter beyond the fate of that one production.

Bhai Bhai and the work of a producer

The archive identifies ଭାଇ ଭାଇ **(Bhai Bhai, 1956)** as Gour's first production, under Chitram. Its subject concerned caste and untouchability. The credits name **Santanu Kumar Das** for the story, **Nitai Palit** for screenplay and direction, and **Manoj Das** for dialogue. **Bhubaneswar Mishra and Balakrushna Das**, credited as Bhuban-Kissen, provided the music.[2]

Gour and Chapala, later known as Parbati Ghose, appeared in the cast alongside performers drawn from the stage and radio. The archive also

remembers assistance from Odisha's Information and Public Relations Department and the government of Nabakrushna Choudhury.[2]

Maa and a wider creative circle

For ମାଆ **(Maa, 1959)**, the credits again name Gour as producer and Nitai Palit for screenplay and direction. **Gopal Chhotray and Biswajit Das** supplied dialogue; **Bhubaneswar Misra** composed the music. Playback credits include **Akshay Mohanty, Pranab Patnaik and Ila Chakraborty**, while **Kelucharan Mahapatra** is credited for dance.[3]

Drama, radio, music and dance met in this production. The AIR Cuttack article follows the writers and performers who also worked around the microphone.

Gour and Parbati as collaborators

The archive's filmography records Gour and Parbati across productions including ଲକ୍ଷ୍ମୀ *(Laxmi)*, କା *(Kaa)* and ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ *(Stree)*. For the latter two, it identifies the directing name **Siddharth** with **Ram Chandra Thakur, Gour and Parbati**.[4]

Parbati's own profile follows her producing, writing, directing and performance work, including ଛ' ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ *(Chha Mana Atha Guntha)*. Their partnership continued across these changing responsibilities.

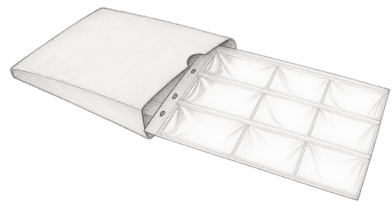
Another audience through television

The memorial biography records Odia telefilms *Samadhan* and *Hawker* and later Hindi television work: *Prashna*, *Sopan* and *Yashodhara*. It associates these with dowry, labour exploitation and drug abuse respectively.[1] The subjects gave his later television work a continuing interest in social relationships.

The archive records Gour's death on **9 December 1994**.[1] His work remains connected to a practical question for cinema's future: how can a production make room for other people's abilities, and leave behind more than a single release?

Explore the archive

The Gour-Parbati archive offers individual biographies, film credits and photographs. Its Bhai Bhai page reports that the film could not be located when that account was written. That is an archival search status, not proof that no print survives anywhere. Photographs and their credits offer another way to explore the careers recorded there.



A trace still worth following.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

18 Parbati Ghose: the woman behind the credits

Parbati Ghose. [6]

One name in the credits invites a second look: **Shrabani**.

In the published credits for ଛ’ ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ *(Chha Mana Atha Guntha)*, Parbati Ghose appears as producer, director and performer. The screenplay and dialogue are credited to Shrabani, identified there as Parbati Ghose. The archive dates this adaptation of Fakir Mohan Senapati’s novel to 1986.[1]

Parbati was both shaping the adaptation and performing within it. Writing, producing and acting met in the same working life.

Parbati Ghose on India Post’s 2023 commemorative stamp. [7]

Chapala before Parbati

Born in Cuttack in 1942, Parbati was also known as **Chapala** and **Chandana**. Her archive biography describes a childhood connected to books and performance: her father Basudev Naik worked at ManMohan Press, and her mother Sebati encouraged the children's education and cultural interests. It records dance training and childhood participation in All India Radio.[2]

Publishing, listening and performance were part of the world in which Chapala grew up. Her later career would bring those arts together through the responsibilities of making a film.

A career built through collaboration

The Gour-Parbati archive records her as co-producer with Gour Prasad Ghose on ଲକ୍ଷ୍ମୀ *(Laxmi)*, କା *(Kaa)* and ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ *(Stree)*. It also identifies "Siddharth," the directing credit associated with *Kaa* and *Stree*, as a collaboration involving Ram Chandra Thakur, Gour and Parbati.[3]

Her producing, directing and writing credits sit alongside the work of these collaborators. Gour Prasad Ghose's profile follows his theatre and production career, while the shared archive lets readers explore both lives.

Gour and Parbati Ghose, from the archive's Maa gallery. [8]

Land, power and a literary inheritance

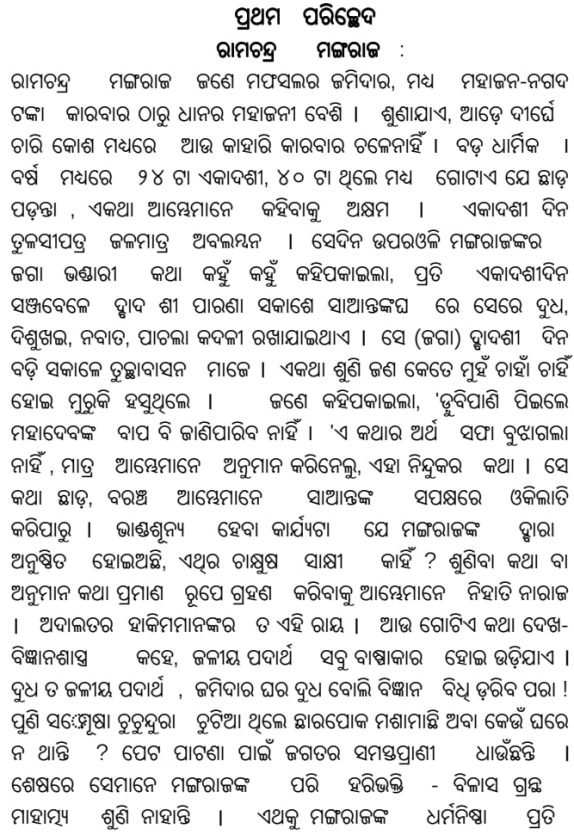
The novel at the centre of Parbati's adaptation concerns Mangaraj, a moneylender who exploits the colonial legal order to acquire other people's property. Among those he ruins are the weaver couple Bhagia and Saria. Peter Samuels explains how the story turns the workings of law and rural power into satire.[4]

The weavers' place in this literary world gives a reader a starting point for the adaptation: whose speech, livelihood and loss must find a form on screen?

A connection

The literature reading asks us to look closely at Bhagia and Saria. Here the archive gives those characters performers: Bijay Mohanty and Parbati Ghose.[1]

When a novel becomes a film



ପ୍ରଥମ ପରିଚ୍ଛେଦ

ରାମଚନ୍ଦ୍ର ମଙ୍ଗରାଜ :

ରାମଚନ୍ଦ୍ର ମଙ୍ଗରାଜ ଜଣେ ମଫସଲର ଜମିଦାର, ମଧ୍ୟ ମହାଜନ-ନଗଦ ଟଙ୍କା କାରବାର ଠାରୁ ଧାନର ମହାଜନୀ ବେଶି । ଶୁଣାଯାଏ, ଆଡ଼େ ଦୀର୍ଘେ ଚାରି କୋଶ ମଧ୍ୟରେ ଆଉ କାହାରି କାରବାର ଚଳେନାହିଁ । ବଡ଼ ଧାର୍ମିକ । ବର୍ଷ ମଧ୍ୟରେ ୨୪ ଟା ଏକାଦଶୀ, ୪୦ ଟା ଥିଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ ଗୋଟାଏ ଯେ ଛାଡ଼ ପଡ଼ନ୍ତା , ଏକଥା ଆମ୍ଭେମାନେ କହିବାକୁ ଅକ୍ଷମ । ଏକାଦଶୀ ଦିନ ତୁଳସୀପତ୍ର ଜଳମାତ୍ର ଅବଲମ୍ବନ । ସେଦିନ ଉପରଓଳି ମଙ୍ଗରାଜଙ୍କର ଜଗା ଭଣ୍ଡାରୀ କଥା କହୁଁ କହୁଁ କହିପକାଇଲା, ପ୍ରତି ଏକାଦଶୀଦିନ ସଞ୍ଜବେଳେ ଦ୍ୱାଦ ଶୀ ପାରଣା ସକାଶେ ସାଆନ୍ତଙ୍କଘ ରେ ସେରେ ଦୁଧ, ଦିଶୁଖଇ, ନବାତ, ପାତଳା କଦଳୀ ରଖାଯାଇଥାଏ । ସେ (ଜଗା) ଦ୍ୱାଦଶୀ ଦିନ ବଡ଼ି ସକାଳେ ତୁଚ୍ଛାବାସନ ମାଜେ । ଏକଥା ଶୁଣି ଜଣ କେତେ ମୁହଁ ଚାହାଁ ଚାହିଁ ହୋଇ ମୁରୁକି ହସୁଥିଲେ । ଜଣେ କହିପକାଇଲା, 'ଡୁବିପାଣି ପିଇଲେ ମହାଦେବଙ୍କ ବାପ ବି ଜାଣିପାରିବ ନାହିଁ । 'ଏ କଥାର ଅର୍ଥ ସଫା ବୁଝାଗଲା ନାହିଁ , ମାତ୍ର ଆମ୍ଭେମାନେ ଅନୁମାନ କରିନେଲୁ, ଏହା ନିନ୍ଦୁକର କଥା । ସେ କଥା ଛାଡ଼, ବରଞ୍ଚ ଆମ୍ଭେମାନେ ସାଆନ୍ତଙ୍କ ସପକ୍ଷରେ ଓକିଲାତି କରିପାରୁ । ଭାଣ୍ଡଶୂନ୍ୟ ହେବା କାର୍ଯ୍ୟଟା ଯେ ମଙ୍ଗରାଜଙ୍କ ଦ୍ୱାରା ଅନୁଷ୍ଠିତ ହୋଇଅଛି, ଏଥିର ଚାକ୍ଷୁଷ ସାକ୍ଷୀ କାହିଁ ? ଶୁଣିବା କଥା ବା ଅନୁମାନ କଥା ପ୍ରମାଣ ରୂପେ ଗ୍ରହଣ କରିବାକୁ ଆମ୍ଭେମାନେ ନିହାତି ନାରାଜ । ଅଦାଲତର ହାକିମମାନଙ୍କର ତ ଏହି ରାୟ । ଆଉ ଗୋଟିଏ କଥା ଦେଖ- ବିଜ୍ଞାନଶାସ୍ତ୍ର କହେ, ଜଳୀୟ ପଦାର୍ଥ ସବୁ ବାଷ୍ପାକାର ହୋଇ ଉଡ଼ିଯାଏ । ଦୁଧ ତ ଜଳୀୟ ପଦାର୍ଥ , ଜମିଦାର ଘର ଦୁଧ ବୋଲି ବିଜ୍ଞାନ ବିଧି ଡ଼ରିବ ପରା ! ପୁଣି ସଂଶ୍ଳିଷ୍ଟା ଚୁଚୁନ୍ଦୁରା ଚୁଟିଆ ଥିଲେ ଛାରପୋକ ମଶାମାଛି ଅବା କେଉଁ ଘରେ ନ ଥାନ୍ତି ? ପେଟ ପାଟଣା ପାଇଁ ଜଗତର ସମସ୍ତପ୍ରାଣୀ ଧାଉଁଛନ୍ତି । ଶେଷରେ ସେମାନେ ମଙ୍ଗରାଜଙ୍କ ପରି ହରିଭକ୍ତି - ବିଳାସ ଗ୍ରନ୍ଥ ମାହାତ୍ମ୍ୟ ଶୁଣି ନାହାନ୍ତି । ଏଥକୁ ମଙ୍ଗରାଜଙ୍କ ଧର୍ମନିଷ୍ଠା ପ୍ରତି

Opening chapter of Fakir Mohan Senapati's Chha Mana Atha Guntha, from the digitised text. [9]

In the adaptation, Parbati played Saria, Bijay Mohanty played Bhagia and Sarat Pujari played Mangaraj. The archive names Ashok Swain for camera, Tapas Mukherjee for editing and Prafulla Kar for music.[1]

Parbati's Saria belongs to that ensemble: a weaver from the novel given a voice and presence alongside Bhagia and Mangaraj.

Beyond the feature film

The archive also follows Parbati through television, radio drama, literacy work and films for public institutions. Its biography credits her with *Salabeg* for Films Division. It also identifies *Pratibha* as a television adaptation of Harekrushna Mahtab's novel. These extend the literary connection beyond her better-known Fakir Mohan adaptation.[2]

Television and public programmes were also part of her working life. The archive records her death on **12 February 2018**.[2]

The work within the recognition

The archive records national recognition for *Laxmi*, *Kaa* and *Stree* as film honours.[5]

Shrabani's screenplay and Parbati's Saria bring us back to the same woman: writing the adaptation and taking her place among its performers.

Watch and explore

- **Film information: ଛ' ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ (Chha Mana Atha Guntha).** Gour-Parbati archive: credits and production context, not a player.

- **Film information: ଲକ୍ଷ୍ମୀ (Laxmi).** Gour-Parbati archive.

- **Film information: କା (Kaa).** Gour-Parbati archive.

- **Film information: ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ (Stree).** Gour-Parbati archive.

- **Song clip: ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ (Stree) - Kali Juga.** GPG Productions, the channel linked by the Gour-Parbati archive; a song excerpt, not the full film.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

19 Sadhu Meher: an actor beyond one language

Sadhu Meher receiving the Padma Shri from President Pranab Mukherjee on 13 April 2017. [6]

Kishtaya comes back to the village with money he has earned. Seeking work from Surya, the landlord's son, he is beaten; his wife Lakshmi intervenes. The National Film Awards catalogue describes this painful return in ଅଙ୍କୁର *(Ankur)*, the Hindi film for which **Sadhu Meher** received Best Actor for 1974.[1]

The same catalogue records Meher's Odisha background and training at the Film and Television Institute of India.[1] His career would carry him from this performance into choosing and directing actors in Odia films.

Kishtaya: the man who comes back

Meher plays Kishtaya, a poor potter and husband of Lakshmi, played by Shabana Azmi. Anant Nag plays Surya.[2] Kishtaya had left following public humiliation. On returning, he accepts his wife's approaching motherhood, before the encounter with Surya turns violent.[1]

The conflict puts employment, dependence and the landlord's power inside a marriage. Kishtaya's return is therefore more than a change in the household: it brings a vulnerable worker back within reach of the person who can decide whether he earns.

The actor was also a director

Kapilas Bhuyan's 2010 retrospective credits Meher's ଅଭିମାନ *(Abhiman)* (1977) with helping revive cinema attendance.[3]

Uttam Mohanty recalled meeting Meher, who photographed him and cast him in *Abhiman*. In the 2018 interview, Mohanty described obtaining his family's permission and completing the shoot in 35 days.[4]

The official 60th National Film Awards catalogue later listed him as chair of its South I feature-film jury panel. Its biography recorded six directed feature films by that point, alongside work in acting and television.[5]

In *Ankur*, Meher was the actor returning as Kishtaya. In *Abhiman*, he was the director giving Uttam Mohanty a role. Both belong to the career.

Watch and explore

- **Full-film listing: ଅଙ୍କୁର (Ankur) on Shemaroo's YouTube channel.** Official-channel upload identified in the indexed listing; playback and regional access untested.

- **Film information: ଅଭିମାନ (Abhiman) in an IFFI retrospective.** Historical account of the Odia film, not a stream.

On either side of the performance.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

20 Bijay Mohanty: Learning a Role, Sharing a Craft

Bijay Mohanty (centre) on the set of Sahari Bagha. [6]

At his National School of Drama audition, **Bijay Mohanty** remembered being uncertain of his Hindi and English. He asked whether he could perform in Odia. The answer was yes. In his account, the journey to that room had begun with **Prasanna Mohanty**, who encouraged him and sent an application form from Delhi.[1]

The language he brought with him had a place in his training. Years later, he would help other performers find their footing, carrying his own learning into classrooms, rehearsals and films.

Preparing to become someone else

For ଚିଲିକା ଟାରେ **(Chilika Tire)**, Mohanty recalled living with fishermen while preparing to play one. The writer and lyricist **Sibabrata Das** had connected him with filmmaker **Biplab Ray Choudhury**.[1] Preparation meant spending time with people whose daily lives would inform a role.

His *Chilika Tire* co-star **Tandra Ray** described another kind of learning. In a joint interview with Mohanty, she recalled learning Odia from senior colleagues and reading Odia novels. She had signed *Chilika Tire* before *Punar Milan*, although the latter reached audiences first.[2]

Their accounts bring language and reading close to performance. The literature and cinema reading follows those connections through writers and adaptations.

A classroom could become a stage

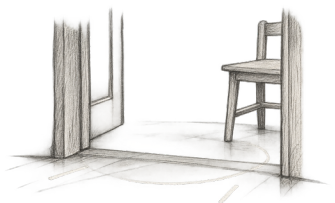
Mohanty taught at Utkal Sangeet Mahavidyalaya. Theatre director **Subodh Pattnaik**, remembering his teacher, singled out his work with props in *Madhyanha Ra Ranga*. He also recalled a production that used the entire college building as its performance space, and learning while assisting Mohanty on *Bhuli Huena*.[3]

Other students remembered different aspects of his care. **Ashrumochan Mohanty** recalled being given tasks when his teacher was away filming. **Mihir Swain** remembered encouragement that recognised individual students' strengths.[4] Their accounts give the classroom a continuing life beside the screen career.

Words for another company

Mohanty also wrote for theatre. Manana Natya Sanstha's productions of *Amari Bhagaban* in 1990, 2004 and 2006 credit him as writer and **Manoj Pattanayak** as director.[5]

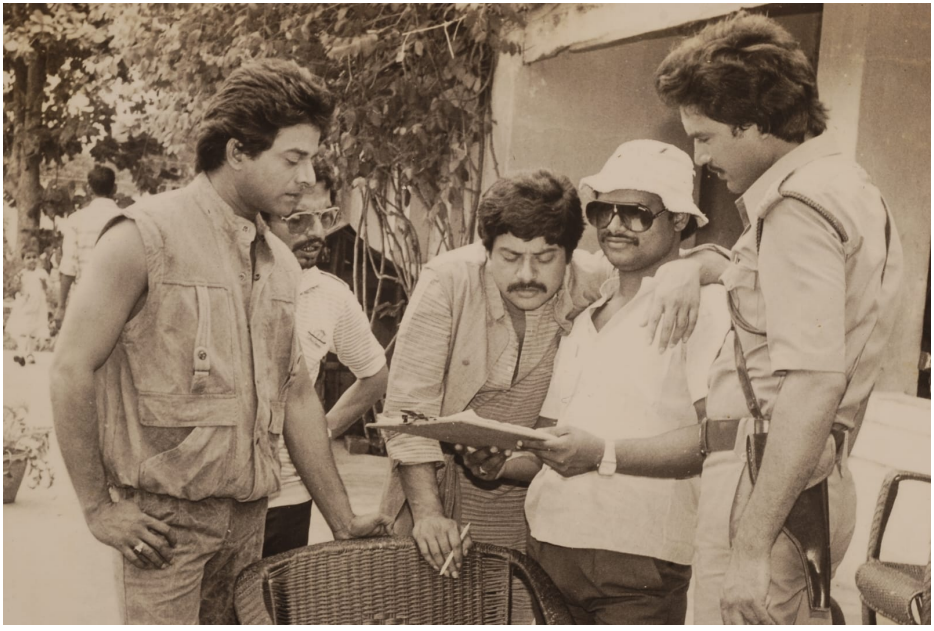
The cinema overview places Mohanty among the performers audiences returned to. Here, the memories of preparation and teaching let us accompany him a little further. Learning Cinema Together continues that conversation through introductions, shared work and the attention one practitioner gives another.



A classroom makes room for performance.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

21 Uttam Mohanty: The Work Beside the Performance



Uttam Mohanty with colleagues on the set of Paka Kambala Pota Chhata. [4]

Jayiram Samal remembered Uttam Mohanty wanting to improve each shot. **Mahasweta Ray** remembered the hard work they brought to sets with limited amenities.[1]

Working with others

Filmmaker **Sabyasachi Mohapatra** remembered Mohanty's responsiveness, alongside a talent he described as natural and untrained.[2]

The Sabyasachi Mohapatra profile follows the filmmaker's other collaborations.

Friendship across screen rivalry

Mohanty's own remembrance of **Bijay Mohanty** offers a more personal connection. He recalled their frequent pairing as hero and villain, while describing Bijay as an elder-brother figure who stood by him.[3]

The opposition within a story and the affection between its performers can coexist. Bijay's story follows his teaching and preparation for roles; Uttam's recollection adds the company one actor found in another.

Helping the work continue

Kuna Tripathy remembered encouragement for newcomers and help offered to crew members. Producer **Pradyumna Lenka** recalled Mohanty helping filmmakers through difficulties involving finance and post-production.[1]

Lenka's recollection connects this help with the practical work of bringing a film to viewers.

Company between performances.

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22 Aparajita Mohanty: Helping a Film Take Shape

Aparajita Mohanty. [4]

The writer **Imraan** remembered Aparajita Mohanty staying late to offer suggestions during the making of ବଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ **(Bou Buttu Bhuta)**. Speaking about her character **Ratnamala**, he said she brought more to the role than he had imagined.[1]

Imraan remembered her contribution to the discussion as well as the performance.

What another woman taught her

Aparajita's remembrance of **Anita Das** brings an earlier relationship into view. She described Anita as an elder-sister figure who taught her about acting and the workings of the industry.[2]

The affection in that memory accompanies a practical acknowledgement: another woman helped her learn her work. Learning Cinema Together follows such relationships across the collection, from introductions and assisting to the knowledge exchanged between colleagues.

Taking responsibility for a film

In 2012, Aparajita produced *Love Master* through her production house, **Sai Maa**. Reporting that move, *The Times of India* attributed to her the wish to make good films for audiences.[3]

Her production work connects with the cinema economics reading, which follows the resources and agreements behind a film.

Helping the work take shape.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

23 Manmohan Mahapatra: households under pressure

Manmohan Mahapatra. [5]

In କ୍ଲାନ୍ତ ଅପରାହ୍ନ *(Klanta Aparanha)*, retired Adikanda lives with his mother and daughter Niru. Niru teaches alongside Sandhya and Veena, with whom she exchanges news and hopes. An anticipated marriage proposal draws the family into financial pressure: Adikanda mortgages land to raise money for the dowry.[1]

The premise brings a social expectation into one household. Marriage becomes a question of property and security as well as affection. In his account of Odisha's new-wave cinema, critic Ashok Palit discusses Mahapatra's films through changing rural society and tensions within families.[2]

Working with the filmmaker

Colleagues' recollections add another view of his practice. In Bijay Mandal's 2020 retrospective, actor Jayaswami described his help in developing her work while keeping actors within their characters. Susant Mani recalled subtitling and mentorship; Pradeep Mohanty remembered borrowing Mahapatra's 35mm camera rather than hiring one from Madras.[3]

The journey from training to recognition

The 1985 Indian Panorama catalogue identifies Mahapatra as a graduate of Utkal University who completed film-direction studies at FTII in 1975. It dates the making of ଶୀତରାତି *(Seeta Raati)* to 1976 and its national recognition to 1982.[1]

The 29th National Film Awards catalogue lists *Seeta Raati* as Best Oriya Film in the awards for 1981.[4]

Prabhat Studio Complex at FTII, Pune, photographed in 2018. [6]

The people making Klanta Aparanha

For *Klanta Aparanha*, the Panorama catalogue names Nandalal Mahapatra for the story, Ranajit Ray for cinematography, Satyendra Mohanty for editing and Shantanu Mahapatra for music.[1]

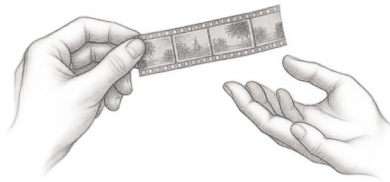
A practice carried by people

Alongside the finished films, his colleagues' recollections preserve the help one filmmaker could give another person's work. Maya Miriga takes us into another household story and the people who made it.

Watch and explore

- **Official catalogue:** ଶୀତରାତି **(Seeta Raati).** National Film Awards catalogue, page 53; not streaming.

- **Official catalogue:** କ୍ଲାନ୍ତ ଅପରାହ୍ନ **(Klanta Aparanha).** Indian Panorama 1985. No authorised full-film route was established in this check.



Looking closely at another person's work.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

24 ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga): a family, a fragile film, a second life

A household scene from Maya Miriga (1984). [11]

In January 2025, an Odia film made four decades earlier appeared on the programme of New York's Museum of Modern Art. ମାୟା ମିରିଗ *(Maya Miriga)* was being shown in its restored form, as part of the museum's film-preservation festival.[1]

There are two journeys here. One belongs to a film that found audiences far from the place where it was made. The other belongs to the physical material that had to survive for those audiences to keep finding it.

A household large enough to hold a world

Nirad Mohapatra's 1984 film follows an extended middle-class family in a small Odisha town. MoMA's account describes a household pulled between obligations and individual ambitions, brought to life by a nonprofessional cast and Bhaskar Chandavarkar's music.[1]

Mohapatra's own note, reproduced in the Bologna programme, describes married sons balancing competing responsibilities and daughters-in-law seeking freedom within the household. His interest held affection and frustration together: family could offer warmth while also constraining the people who lived within it.[2]

The household was shaped by several kinds of work. The Bologna programme credits **Nirad Mohapatra and Bibhuti Patnaik** with the story, **Rajgopal Mishra** with cinematography and **Bibekananda Satpathy** with editing.[2]

A house made ready for a family

Mohapatra recalled arriving in Puri months in advance with a small crew and nonprofessional performers. They prepared an abandoned house and its courtyard as the film's only set. In his director's note, he described improvising within a written story.[3] The household on screen had required another kind of shared work before filming: making a place ready for it.

MAMI's restored-film programme names Ramakanta Mohanty and Bijay K. Mahapatra as production designers.[4]

Different doors into the world

The film was selected for Cannes Critics' Week in 1984. Mannheim's 1984 archive records it in the Grand Prize of the Third World competition, shared with ଲଇଲା ଏ ଲଜ ଗୁ *(Leila et les loups)*; that category was distinct from the festival's overall Grand Prize.[5, 6]

At home, it received the Second Best Feature Film recognition in the 31st National Film Awards, covering films of 1983 and presented in 1984.[7]

The work of bringing a film back

The negative had been found abandoned in a warehouse in poor condition, according to Film Heritage Foundation's Shivendra Singh Dungarpur in the Bologna programme.[2]

The restored version was assembled from a 16mm original camera negative and a 35mm print. MoMA credits Film Heritage Foundation's 4K restoration at L'Immagine Ritrovata in Bologna, using material preserved by the foundation and NFDC-National Film Archive of India.[1]

Bologna's programme also credits the director's family, Digital Film Restore for digital restoration, and Prasad Corporation for scanning.[2]

The family's contribution included detailed work on the film itself. Sandeep Mohapatra told Scroll that he supplied his father's shooting script and taught himself to work on the new subtitles in his spare time. He consulted his mother and siblings; an unnamed friend from the National Institute of Design helped recreate damaged credits.[8]

The restoration was screened at Il Cinema Ritrovato in Bologna on 27 June 2024.[2]

A new encounter with the family

Prabha, the eldest son Tuku's wife, is played by Manaswini Mangaraj.[2]

Writing after that screening, film historian Antti Alanen placed her at the film's emotional centre and traced the family's tensions through gender and generation. He admired its atmosphere and music, while also finding moments when it lacked intensity.[9]

An older man sits towards the front of a long-backed chair, leaning forward, his hands near his chin. In this brief image from the restoration excerpt, dark openings punctuate a pale wall. The chair has room for him to recline; he does not use it. His posture draws our attention, but so does the space around him. How would the moment change if we saw only his face? The house would disappear.[10]

Watch and explore

- **Restoration clip and information: ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga) at Film Heritage Foundation.** Restoration story and before-and-after comparison clip; not the full film.

A household threshold, imagined.

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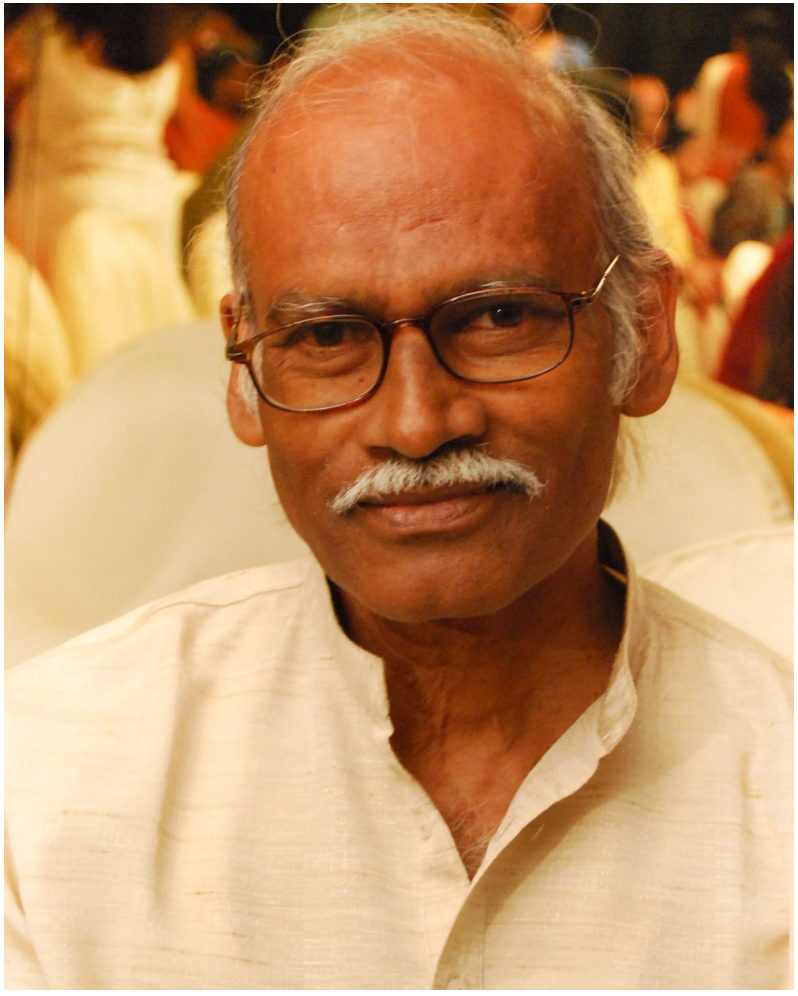
25 Nirad Mohapatra: making a film, making room for others



Nirad Mohapatra, photographed in 2010. [4]

Nirad Mohapatra left postgraduate political-science study for film training at FTII. By 1972 he was teaching there; from 1974 to 1983 he ran **Cinexstasy**, a Bhubaneswar film society pairing world-cinema screenings with analysis.[1]

A film could be something to make, but also something to gather around and discuss. Those encounters belong to Mohapatra's working life alongside his own production.

A place to encounter cinema

The same account connects his film-appreciation courses at Utkal University with his work on the film section of the literary journal *Mana Phasal*.[1] Cinema entered a literary journal as well as a classroom. Screening and discussion gave it a shared place in the city.

A household at the centre

The extended family at the centre of ମାୟା ମିରିଗ *(Maya Miriga)* provides the subject of our companion film article, which follows its collaborators and later restoration. The filmmaker who made that household drama also made time for other people's films.

During the making of Maya Miriga. [5]

Recognition, and the work after recognition

The film received **Second Best Feature Film** at the 31st National Film Awards, covering films of 1983 and presented in 1984. Cannes Critics' Week records its **1984 selection**. The award and the festival selection mark distinct forms of recognition.[2, 3]

What can be carried forward?

The film society, the classroom and *Mana Phasal* leave us with a different picture of a filmmaker's work. The screen was also a place around which he brought other people together.

Cinexstasy lasted nearly a decade. Making those screenings and discussions possible was itself sustained work, worth remembering beside the film that travelled abroad.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

26 ଭୁଖା (Bhukha): when a tradition must also feed a family

A still from Bhukha in the 1990 Gijón festival catalogue. [10]

A tradition can be admired long after the people who practise it have begun to struggle. The drum remains a symbol; the drummer still needs to earn a living.

In ଭୁଖା *(Bhukha)*, Sabyasachi Mohapatra's 1989 Sambalpuri film, folk performers live within a changing society. Film critic Ashok Palit discusses it as an encounter between inherited ways of life and modernity.[1]

Behind the sound, a livelihood

The film grew from a play by Manglu Charan Biswal. A later report about Mohapatra's work describes its concern with bajnia folk drummers whose livelihoods were threatened by changing musical tastes.[2]

In the opening scene of the play *Bhukha*, read in Nirjharini Tripathy's English translation *The Starved*, Hadu suggests making music, but Paltu asks what the Nisan can do alone. They wonder why Maharagu is late and tease him. He arrives with his dhol and challenges their remarks; Hadu answers that they wanted him to hear. Before the livelihood question, this opening lets us meet the performers through their banter.[3]

For a working musician, cultural change can arrive as the loss of the next engagement. The film's subject brings an economic question into the celebration of inherited art: what allows a performer to continue?

Himanshu Shekhar Guru's 2015 account in *OrissaPOST* credits Ramesh Mahanand with the music and identifies a Nachnia song and a Sajani geet in its repertoire.[4]

Finding an audience at home

In a 2022 interview, Mohapatra recalled that *Bhukha* did well in western Odisha and also reached audiences in Bhubaneswar, Cuttack and Puri. Looking back on the broader difficulties of distributing his films, he described the separate expense of posters, banners and promotion. Completing a film was only one part of bringing it to viewers.[5]

In his recollection, the film travelled between western Odisha and the coastal cities. Its local audiences belong to its history alongside the festival record.

A regional voice reaching another audience

Gijón's July 1990 programme lists *Bhukha* among its official feature films. Its credits name Sabyasachi Mohapatra as director and producer, B. Satish Kumar for cinematography, and a cast including Sadhu Meher, Sarat Pujhari, Chitta Pattnaik, Swati Ray and Usha Nayer.[6]

The 70th National Film Awards catalogue records an International Jury Award at Gijón for *Bhukha*, but gives no prize year.[7]

Amrit Amlan Pattanaik's study places Mohapatra's Sambalpuri films within western Odisha's literary and cultural worlds.[8]

Following the filmmaker forward

Mohapatra's later, National Film Award-winning ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର (Aadim Vichar) offers another encounter with community life and outside authority.[9]

The drum in this story belongs to someone's working life. Listening to the music while following that livelihood keeps art and its practitioners together. Mohapatra's account of reaching viewers adds the next step: a story about performers also needs people willing and able to see it.

Watch and explore

- **Institutional reference: Sabyasachi Mohapatra and ଭୂଖା (Bhukha).** National Film Awards catalogue, printed page 036. A director biography, not a player; an authorised full-film route was not established in this check.

PART 3 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

27 Sabyasachi Mohapatra: stories rooted in western Odisha

Sabyasachi Mohapatra at the Odisha State Film Awards, Bhubaneswar, 21 November 2014. [4]

In a 2022 interview, **Sabyasachi Mohapatra** described learning through discussions with his cinematographer son, even when their

ideas about an image differed.[1] A director rooted in western Odisha's stories was still working out how to tell them with another generation.

Our article on ଭୁଖା (Bhukha) follows its performers' livelihoods, musical world and international recognition. Here, the discussion with his son brings those collaborations close to home.

A film must also travel

Mohapatra recalled promotion as a separate expense; the Bhukha chapter follows his account of reaching audiences across western and coastal Odisha.[1]

Mohapatra also argued that art films and mainstream films could coexist.[1] His account leaves room for different audiences and ambitions within the same film culture.

The names beside the director

ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର *(Aadim Vichar)* offers a later point of entry. Its Indian Panorama credits name **Kapileswar Prasad Mohapatra** for the story, **Kumar C. Dev Mohapatra** for cinematography, **Rajendra Mohapatra** for editing, and **Pankaj Jal and Ghasiram Mishra** for music. Sabyasachi wrote the screenplay and directed.[2]

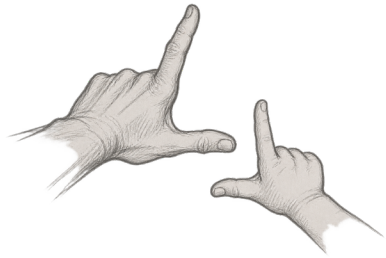
What the national award recognises

Aadim Vichar received the National Film Award for **Best Odiya Film**, with Mohapatra Movie Magic Pvt Ltd and Sabyasachi Mohapatra named as producer and director recipients.[3]

Our film companion considers its encounter between a community's understanding of justice and outside authority. Its credited writer and performers give that discussion particular voices.

A regional world, with room for difference

The discussion with his son returns us to a work still taking shape. Regional rootedness can coexist with disagreement over an image - and with a filmmaker's willingness to keep learning.



Another way to frame the story.

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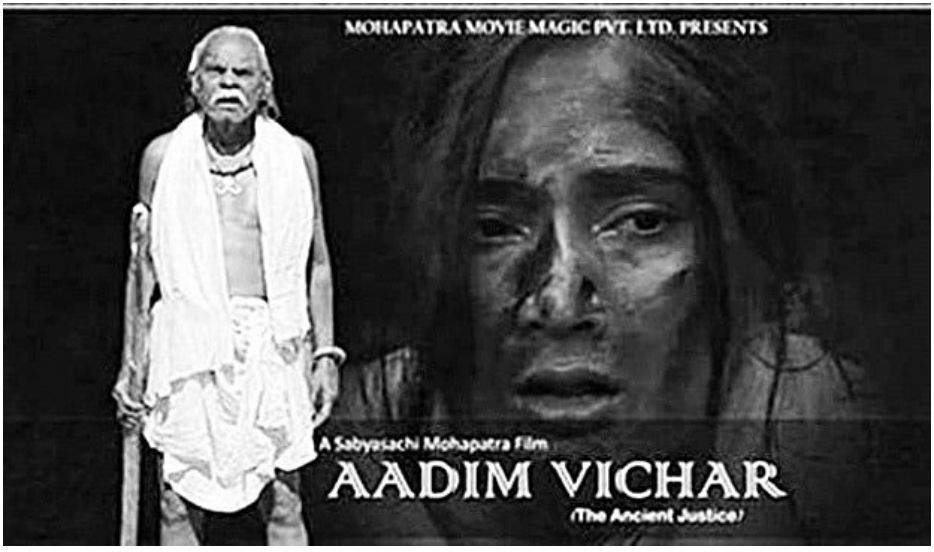
28 ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର (Aadim Vichar): whose understanding of justice?



Publicity image for Aadim Vichar. [8]

At an IFFI press conference in November 2014, **Atal Bihari Panda** spoke about acting as a search for truth through illusion. The official account introduced him as an octogenarian with nearly seven decades in theatre. Beside the film's director, Sabyasachi Mohapatra, was a performer carrying a long life on the stage into the conversation about cinema.[1]

In a 2013 interview, Panda recalled theatre around trees, without a raised platform. Spectators preferred to sit in a circle rather than have a separate stage.[2]

ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର *(Aadim Vichar)* brings those forms of storytelling together. Its protagonist faces a court, but the film asks viewers to consider a

question that extends beyond a verdict: whose understanding of justice is being heard?

An older man before the court

The official festival account describes a righteous tribal man implicated in a case, whose candid defence surprises the judge. Mohapatra presented the film as an argument for the value of traditional justice.[1] This is the director's artistic argument within a fictional story, rather than a description of all Kandha communities.

The character's voice, and the authority listening to him, invite viewers into the question. How is a person heard when the language of an institution meets the values by which he has lived?

From a written story to a shared performance

The Indian Panorama catalogue credits **Kapileswar Prasad Mohapatra** with the story and Sabyasachi with screenplay and direction. Its cast includes **Atal Bihari Panda, Tapaswini Guru and Sushree Smita Panda**.[3]

Speaking to Ashok Palit about the planned sequel to *Sala Budha*, Sabyasachi identified its source as his father's short story *Adim Bichar*.[4]

Panda recalled Kapileswar as his classmate, and Sabyasachi as a young man who had played a small part in his play *Phata Mardala*. Before *Aadim Vichar*, Sabyasachi asked him to help adapt his father's stories for ଶଳାବୁଢ଼ା *(Sala Budha)*, then invited him to play its lead. For *Aadim Vichar*, Panda remembered winter filming in Kandhamal and the research and practice he undertook for the demanding role.[5]

In a 2019 interview, Sabyasachi described his usual way of working with family collaborators: he would tell the story to his brothers, nephews and nieces, then hear their individual views. Debate could bring useful suggestions. He welcomed those contributions while keeping the final decision with himself.[6]

Selection and award

The film appeared in **Indian Panorama at IFFI 2014**. It subsequently received **Best Odiya Film for 2014** at the 62nd National Film Awards, announced on 24 March 2015.[3, 7]

Return from the award to the older performer at the press conference: Panda brought decades of theatre to the role. The court in the story gives that voice an authority to confront; the performance gives us a person to listen to.

Explore the film

The official Indian Panorama catalogue, printed page 31, provides the synopsis and credits. This is a film reference, not a viewing link. An authorised full-film player has not been verified for this page.

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29 ଲାବଣ୍ୟ ପ୍ରୀତି (Lavanya Preeti): growing up with a story

A still from Lavanya Preeti, reproduced in the 41st National Film Awards catalogue. [3]

A story heard in childhood can become a way of understanding feelings that arrive later. In ଲାବଣ୍ୟ ପ୍ରୀତି **(Lavanya Preeti)**, A. K. Bir places adolescent experience beside the story of Kedar and Gouri. NFDC's catalogue describes a story within a story, in which elders misunderstand the young lovers and tragedy follows.[1]

The film, also catalogued as **Loving Hearts**, is a 1993 Odia live-action feature.[1] Young performers bring its friendships and misunderstandings to the screen.

An inherited story and a present feeling

The National Film Awards catalogue connects the Kedar-Gouri story with jatra and describes the contemporary classmates **Gopal, Vidyulata and Mayadhar** living under its imaginative influence.[2] An older story can become part of how a young person understands a new friendship or separation.

The inherited tale and the classmates' experience give the film two connected levels of storytelling. What do young characters recognise in it, and where might their own lives depart from its ending?

The people making the film

The catalogue credits Bir with script, direction and cinematography; **Dilip Panda** with editing; **Manoj Sikka** with sound; and **Bhavdeep Jaipurwalle** with music. It lists **Tara Shankar Misra** as a child artist.[2]

Recognition for children's cinema

Lavanya Preeti received **Best Children's Film of 1993** at the 41st National Film Awards.[2]

The classmates encounter Kedar and Gouri through an inherited tale; young viewers encounter the classmates through a film. Between those two acts of watching, a story acquires another life. What will the next listener recognise in it?

Find the film in the catalogue

Explore the official NFDC catalogue. This is a reference, not a playback link; an authorised full-film stream has not been verified here.

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30 A. K. Bir: from the camera to the child's world

A. K. Bir, Parambrata Chatterjee, Suman Ghosh and Asha Achy Joseph at an IFFI press conference in Panaji, Goa, 25 November 2015. [5]

A. K. Bir trained in cinematography at FTII, then went on to write, photograph and direct films, including ଆଦି ମୀମାଂସା *(Adi Mimansa)* and ଲାବଣ୍ୟ ପ୍ରୀତି *(Lavanya Preeti)*.[1] A story could stay with him through the writing, the camera and the direction of its performers.

Making a film for younger viewers

Bir was a director recipient of the **Best Children's Film of 1993** award for *Lavanya Preeti*.[2]

The film companion follows its connection between an inherited love story and the feelings of young people. NFDC's children's catalogue also lists it under **Loving Hearts**.[3] Both names lead to the same film.

For his Hindi film *Baaja*,[3] Bir recalled preparing the boy's character before looking for a young performer. Two students from the National

School of Drama helped him run a workshop with the child. During filming, he said, he offered only a few instructions.[4] Preparation, in this account, made room for the child to perform.

Work beyond a single title

The 45th National Film Awards catalogue records Bir's films associated with the National Literacy Mission and his involvement in organising international film festivals for children and young people.[1]

Looking at the work together

Our series follows directors through different routes: Nirad Mohapatra through film societies and teaching, Sabyasachi Mohapatra through regional stories and performance, and Bir through cinematography and children's cinema. Their activities meet in a shared interest: making room for viewers to encounter cinema.

The filmmaker behind the camera also helped make a place for the child in the audience.

Making space for a younger viewer.

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31 Bijaya Jena: Making a Film, Finding Its Audience

Bijaya Jena. [5]

For her Odia-language film ତାରା *(Tara)*, Bijaya Jena had to find the means to make the film in which she would also perform. In her production notes, she recalls shooting on 16mm with limited lighting

and money borrowed from family, friends and government agencies.[1] Acting was part of the work; keeping the production possible was hers too.

Choosing the work

In her own profile, Jena describes choosing acting studies at the Film and Television Institute of India despite opposition within her family. Her subsequent work included acting in Odia and Hindi cinema and television, before producing and directing her own films.[2]

The move behind the camera added responsibilities to an existing performance practice. Parbati Ghose's career offers another account of a woman working across acting, writing, direction and production. Their distinct careers give us more than one way to follow how a film is made.

Tara, and the people making it

Jena's synopsis centres on a rural woman whose husband and an admired social worker disappoint her, bringing questions of identity and authority into the story.[1] That introduction offers a starting point for a viewer: whose judgement does Tara trust, and what happens when those she respects fail her?

The National Film Awards catalogue names Jena as producer, director and leading actor, with **Bimal Dutt** sharing the screenplay credit. **Neelabh Kaul** handled cinematography and **Gadadhar Puty** editing.[3] These collaborators belong beside the central performance: the film's writing, images and rhythm were shared work.

Tara received **Best Feature Film in Oriya for 1991 at the 39th National Film Awards**, with Jena named as producer and director.[3]

A book beside the writing

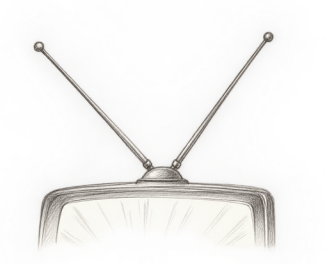
Her next feature, the Hindi-language *Abhaas*, is dated 1997 in her filmography.[2] Speaking with Anees Aref for *Film International*, Jena recalled rereading *Crime and Punishment* before writing it and considering guilt in the construction of her characters.[4]

A book can accompany a filmmaker's thinking without becoming the story being adapted. The page behind the screen follows both the originating work and the writing that gives a film its form. Jena's recollection opens another literary connection: reading as company during the work of creating something new.

Finding the audience

In the same interview, she recalled difficulty obtaining theatrical distribution for *Abhaas*. Its premiere on national television, she said, helped her recover her money.[4]

Her account of recovering the money through television belongs beside the economics reading: completing *Abhaas* and finding its audience were separate difficulties.



A film finds another route home.

Nandita Das, 2008. [6]

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32 Nandita Das: roots, routes and the stories between

For Nandita Das, the journey to Baripada was part of childhood. In a 2013 essay, she recalled summer visits to her father's family home and the anticipation of arriving. She was born in Bombay and grew up in Delhi; her father, artist Jatin Das, connected her to Odisha.[1]

Acting in Odia: Biswaprakash

Her connection to Odia cinema also includes acting in the language. She appears in ବିଶ୍ୱପ୍ରକାଶ *(Biswaprakash / The Young Rebel)*, Susant Misra's 1999 film. Her official acting filmography lists the work, and the national-awards catalogue names her in its cast.[2]

The film received Best Feature Film in Oriya recognition for 1999 at the 47th National Film Awards. The film honour went to its producer and director.[2]

Odisha was part of her acting life as well as her family memory.

Cannes: serving on a jury, bringing a film

Cannes records Das as a member of its feature-film jury in 2005 and its Cinéfondation and short-film jury in 2013. It also lists ମଣ্ଟୋ *(Manto)*, which she directed and wrote, in the 2018 Un Certain Regard selection.[3]

Manto: a writer between two cities

Manto follows the writer Saadat Hasan Manto through Partition and the move from Bombay to Lahore. Cannes' synopsis describes a life unsettled by separation, difficulty publishing and obscenity trials. Das wrote and directed the film.[4]

A writer's freedom is at stake in *Manto*. In ଜ୍ୱିଗାଟୋ *(Zwigato)*, the pressures gather around earning a living.

Bhubaneswar, seen through working lives

With *Zwigato*, Odisha becomes the setting of a film she directs. The official synopsis places a delivery rider and his family in Bhubaneswar, where changing employment shapes both his work and his wife's search for opportunities. The film's official page lists Hindi and Odia as its languages.[5]

In her director's note, Das describes the challenge of making ratings, incentives and algorithmic work legible through human lives. The same page records festival premieres at Toronto, Busan and Kerala in 2022.[5]

Baripada belongs to her family memory; *Biswaprakash* to her acting work in Odia; *Zwigato* to her work in Odisha as a director. *Manto* extends that working life to another writer and another set of places.

Watch and explore

Availability may vary by region and subscription.

- **Paid provider listing:** ବିଶ୍ୱପ୍ରକାଶ **(Biswaprakash) on Prime Video.** Check current availability and account terms; regional responses differed during verification.

- **Provider catalogue:** ମଣ୍ଟୋ **(Manto) on Netflix.** The 2018 Nandita Das film. Unavailable in the returned locale during verification; this is not a current-playback assurance.

- **Paid provider listing:** ଜ୍ୱିଗାଟୋ **(Zwigato) on Prime Video.** Check local availability; indexed regional listings differed.

- **Filmmaker's page and trailer:** ଜ୍ୱିଗାଟୋ **(Zwigato).** Official film page with a trailer link, not a full-film stream.

A working life beyond the screen.

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33 Solila Parida: Carrying a Story Across Oceans

Solila Parida. [10]

A story can travel long before a camera begins to turn. “The Woman from Georgia”, by physician and writer Prasanna K. Pati, travelled from a collection of stories to the film *Desires of the Heart*. In a contribution to the Odisha Society of the Americas’ 2015 souvenir, Pati named Solila Parida as the producer who had brought it to the screen.[1]

Her part in that journey gives us another way to look at cinema: through the person who helps a written work gather a team and become a film.

Parida’s connection to Odisha belongs beside her work across languages. *Desires of the Heart* is an English-language film with some

Hindi dialogue. It belongs here as the work of an Odisha-born producer, within a wider conversation about stories and the people who carry them.[2, 3]

The producer before this film

Parida produced *Vishkanya* (1991), directed by Jag Mundhra, with music by Bappi Lahiri. Its cast includes Pooja Bedi, Kunal Goswami and Kabir Bedi.[4]

By 2012, she was discussing a film made between Savannah in the United States and Bikaner in Rajasthan. Contemporary reporting described her as the founder of DOTH Entertainment and also recorded her earlier productions *Koi Hai* and *Bandit Lovers*.[5] These were different projects and different working relationships, part of the experience she brought to a new adaptation.

A book, then a film

Pati's collection, *Adventures and Misadventures of Dr. Sonjee*, was published by Snehalata Press in 2001. It received a review in *JAMA* in 2003.[6] His later souvenir contribution identifies "The Woman from Georgia" as a story in that book and the source for *Desires of the Heart*. He also invited Odia producers to consider other stories he had written.[1]

That invitation gives the connection a human scale. A writer has more work to share; a filmmaker may find a possibility in it. For readers who come to a story through cinema, the book's title and the writer's name offer a way back to the page.

The film follows an Indian psychiatrist practising in Savannah, his relationship with a local artist and a summons home to a marriage arranged by his family.[2] Its crossing between countries is part of the story as well as its production.

The work around an idea

In September 2012, Georgia Southern University reported that the film had finished its American photography in Savannah and was preparing to move to Rajasthan. It named Parida as producer and executive producer.[7]

Director James Kicklighter later recalled that Parida gave him the opportunity to direct. His account describes months of script revision, further work with lead actor Val Lauren and the help of Rajesh Rathi, co-director for the India portion, with logistics and cultural details.[8]

Parida shares the film's writing credits with several collaborators. Its producing team also includes Juan Manotas, Jitendra Mishra and Terry Chase Chenowith.[2] Following those names lets us see how many kinds of work surround the decision to make a film.

A film finds an audience

The LA Femme International Film Festival's official 2013 results list *Desires of the Heart* and Solila Parida under **Best Foreign Film**.[9] Its Indian release followed on 6 November 2015.[2]

Parida died in Bhubaneswar on 31 March 2025.[3] Returning to her work brings us back to a living question for the series: how does a story find the people who can help it reach another audience?

Her career offers one particular connection to follow. Read the writer, notice the producer and stay with the collaborators in the credits. A film can take us outward into another world, then send us home to a book we had not known to open.

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34 Pramod Pati: A Room for Experiment

Pramod Pati. [7]

A door could be placed in the floor. That was one possibility explored when Pramod Pati and the artist **Abid Surti** worked on a film together. Surti remembered Pati asking him to recreate a room he had painted, this time inside a Films Division studio.[1]

Surti proposed an arc in which an artist arrives, creates and disappears, while the work remains. He joined staff discussions about turning that idea into images and recalled having a say in rejecting suggestions. The room's arrangement changed as they worked. In his

account, the film *Abid* grew through the painter's participation in its making.[1]

From public information to moving images

Pati's connection with Odisha included practical filmmaking work. In his retrospective account, Golaka Bihari Singh traces Pati's beginnings in Sambalpur, science studies at Utkal University and cinematography training in Bangalore. As a Film Officer for the Odisha government, he made films intended for public use. Training in puppetry and animation in Prague preceded his later work leading animation at Films Division.[2]

A camera, an object and the time between exposures could all become tools for shaping an idea. Animation offered a way to make familiar things behave unexpectedly, inviting a viewer to look again.

Making room for other hands

Animator **Ram Mohan** remembered Pati encouraging graphic, stylised designs and experiments with materials. Puppets, objects and cutouts could be animated; live action and animation could be brought together.[3]

Those possibilities give a practical meaning to experimentation. A drawing need not carry every movement. An object can become part of the action, and a photographed person can enter a differently constructed world. Mohan's recollection places that freedom within a workplace shared by people making films together.[3]

Short films, shared work

Explorer (1968) brings youth, science and modernity into a collage without narrative commentary. Its collaborators include **B. K. Parthasarathy** on photography, **S. D. Patil** on sound, **U. Harish Rao** on editing and **Vijay Raghav Rao** on music.[4]

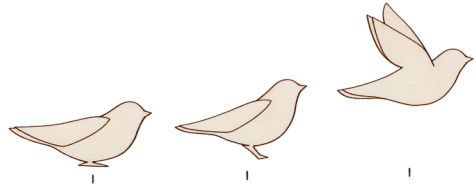
Trip (1970) uses time-lapse images of Bombay and an abstract soundtrack. **B. V. Dhavale** handled photography; Patil, Harish Rao and Vijay Raghav Rao also worked on its sound, editing and music.[5] The moving city and the studio experiment belong within the same body of work, with different tasks meeting in the finished film.

These shorts widen the geographical frame of this series: an Odisha filmmaker's work can belong to the story without being an Odia-language production.[6]

An invitation to look again

Pati's experiments sit beside the listening and documentary practice explored in Lipika Singh Darai's story. Each offers a different way into the work between an idea and a film.

Watch Abid, Explorer and Trip on Films Division's channel. Notice what an image asks of its sound, or how an ordinary object changes when its movement is broken into frames.



Between one position and the next.

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35 Lipika Singh Darai: Listening Beyond the Performance

Lipika Singh Darai at IFFR, 2023. [8]

After seeing a curated puppetry programme in 2013, Lipika Singh Darai wondered how much a city audience understood about the practitioners beyond their performance. In her account to journalist Nandini Ramnath, that question became a reason to seek them in their own surroundings.[1]

Finding the people behind the puppets

Darai recalled asking rickshaw pullers at a station how to find the puppeteer **Maguni Charan Kuanr**, then meeting him at his home in Keonjhar. She worked with cinematographer **Indraneel Lahiri**[2] and a crew over several years, with other filmmaking between periods of production.[1]

At the Mumbai International Film Festival in 2022, she spoke of spending a year and a half on research. The official account identifies her as *Backstage*'s director and editor.[3]

Ramnath's report places the puppeteers' livelihoods and changing forms alongside their art.[1] An audience's enjoyment and a performer's ability to continue meet within the same story. The Bhukha reading approaches that relationship through a fictional screen world; *Backstage* brings documentary attention to particular practitioners.

Sound as a way of working

Darai received the non-feature **Best Audiography** award for *Gaarud* at the 57th National Film Awards, for films of 2009. Her credited role was **re-recordist of the final mixed track**.[4]

A final sound mix is part of how a viewer encounters a film: voices, spaces and other sounds must be heard in relation to one another. Recognising that work widens our attention beyond the visible frame.

She records location sound and designs sound for her own films, and edits for other filmmakers. Her editing credits include *The Sound Man Mangesh Desai* and *In the Shadow of Time*.[5] These collaborations sit alongside her directing, bringing another person's material into the work of shaping a film.

A conversation held in a film

For her first film, *Eka Gachha, Eka Manisa, Eka Samudra (A Tree, A Man, A Sea)*, Darai turned towards her late Hindustani music teacher, Prafulla Kumar Das. An old surviving cassette held his voice. In 2013, she recalled retracing his teaching journey from Balasore to Baripada and meeting his family before filming. Mani Kaul encouraged her to begin with her own feelings of the teacher's presence.[6]

Her filmography also describes an imagined conversation with her late grandaunt, developed while revisiting image and sound recordings from Mumbai in 2013. Her film letters include କଙ୍କି ଓ ସାପ **(Kankee O Saapo)**, ରାତି ଓ ଭୟ **(Raati O Bhaya)** and ବି ଓ ଏସ **(B O S)**.[5]

An imagined conversation leaves room for a present voice and for what remains beyond reply.

Night and Fear appeared in Rotterdam's Tiger Short Competition in 2023; *B and S* was programmed in its Short & Mid-length section in 2025.[7] These festival encounters offer further routes into the work.

Follow the listening

In the search for Sita Bibaha, she turns to surviving records and remembered voices. That search follows another kind of listening.

Listening for what remains.

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36 Learning Cinema Together

Filmmaker Sisir Mishra. [10]

Sisir Mishra remembered three bicycles. In a 2018 interview, he recalled screenplay and dialogue discussions at his home in Jhanjiri Mangala. Two assistants, Srikant Choudhury and Jyoti Nayak, introduced a theatre actor, Hara Patnaik. He remembered the three arriving by bicycle.[1]

It is a small detail to carry through a filmmaking life. An introduction, a place to meet and some work to discuss give this memory its shape. Before we reach a finished film, there are people finding their way into a conversation.

An introduction that travels

Himanshu “Chandi” Parija remembered another introduction. His account begins with Annapurna Theatre’s Group B and Samuel Sahu, with whom he worked between 1979 and 1985. He said Hara Patnaik introduced him to Sisir Mishra for assistant work on ଏଇ ଆମ ସଂସାର *(Ae Ama Sansara)* in 1985.[2]

Read beside Sisir’s memory, Chandi’s recollection makes Hara a connecting person: first introduced, later introducing someone else. Theatre experience entered film production through these personal introductions.

Letters could keep a connection alive across a change of work. In his memoir, Sarat Chandra Pujari recalls Dhira Biswal keeping him in touch with cinema by letter after he moved into teaching. Pujari promised to help, provided his job did not suffer. For ସାଧନା *(Sadhana)*, he credits Biswal with bringing performers from Cuttack and later handling distribution in coastal Odisha.[3]

Working through a story

Sisir also recalled receiving payment for story discussions without receiving screen credit.[1] His memory separates two things that can easily become blurred when we look only at a film’s titles: being paid for a contribution and being publicly named for it.

Chandi’s account includes help closer to home. He recalled Sadhana Parija, his wife, helping him develop the story of ସୁନା ହରିଣୀ *(Suna Harini)*.[2] He remembered her help with the story; this was an acknowledgement in his interview, not a formal screenplay credit.

The writer’s craft has its own learning history. Bijay Mishra recalled being taught screenplay writing by Shyamal Mukherjee during ଯାଯାବର (Jajabara).[4] The literature and cinema reading follows that passage between forms more closely. Writing for cinema was something an experienced writer could still learn.

Someone willing to look again

In recollections of Manmohan Mahapatra, actor Jayaswami described developing through his guidance and his attention to keeping performers within their characters. Susant Mani remembered him examining learners' rushes and offering guidance.[5]

Mahapatra's profile gathers other collaborators' memories. Nirad Mohapatra's profile opens a related path through teaching and watching films together. Read alongside the assistant introductions, these lives widen the settings in which learning can happen.

Learning with the ear

Lipika Singh Darai's biography traces her interest in Audiography at FTII to her earlier music training. She specialised in sound recording and design. She also volunteers with Film Society Bhubaneswar and is a mentor for Docustan India, according to her biography.[6]

Working on *Gaarud*, Darai recalled capturing the changing sounds and atmosphere of a hotel room near a railway station. The soundtrack, she said, was mixed manually on 35 mm magnetic track.[7] The search for Sita Bibaha follows another part of her work, where recordings and remembered voices help approach a film that cannot simply be watched today.

Working with light

Cinematographer Rudrakanta Singh recalled shooting a short film in Koraput with a Canon 600D, a single lens and bounce boards to redirect light.[8] In a 2024 profile, he said he was reading Kalpana Kumari Devi's *Achinha Basabhumi*.[9]

Make room for the next conversation

A conversation about a scene or a rough edit can help a maker continue. There should be room to respond, disagree and try again. Where that work becomes part of a production, responsibilities, payment and credit deserve their own clear agreement.

The road ahead considers paid development and mentoring more fully. The bicycles in Sisir's recollection leave us with a simpler beginning: people arriving, an introduction made, work waiting to be discussed.

Learning leaves traces too. We turn now to the people who gather the records through which another generation can learn.

Arriving for a conversation.

PART 4 · MEMORY AND DISCOVERY

37 Surya Deo: keeping a cinema's memory alive

A screening ends. A film's life need not. Materials kept in a home, a collection entrusted to another person, a question pursued through an archive: these acts can bring a story within reach again. Remembering is work that another generation may one day depend on.

Surya Deo at Bhadrak, 2023. [9]

A collection of magazines, songbooks and photographs once needed a mini-truck to make its journey from Puri to Bhubaneswar. Recalling it in a 2022 interview, Surya Deo credited Srikant Mohanty, publisher of *Manoranjan*, with entrusting the material to him.[1] There is something quietly moving about that scale: cinema's memory travelling as things someone had kept.

The gesture belongs to a larger story. Deo's writing, collecting, exhibitions and screenings have helped make Odia cinema available for another kind of encounter - one that continues after the lights come up.

A question sent him to the newspapers

Deo traced the beginning to a cinema-history column for *Dharitri*'s Sunday supplement, *Chhutidina*, developed with fellow journalists Gopal Mohapatra and Bibhuti Mishra. Dependable information was difficult to find. He remembered Akshaya Mohanty encouraging him to consult old newspapers, and acknowledged the help of journalists, Film Journalists' Forum members and film workers. He also described setting aside part of his earnings for the work.[1]

A column needs an answer by its deadline. Research can leave the writer with more questions. A notice may establish that a film was advertised; a songbook may preserve a lyricist's name. Neither, by itself, explains everything that happened. Their value grows when they can be read together.

When a singer finds a photograph she does not own

At *Geeti Chhaya*, an exhibition opened at the Odisha State Museum in 2017, singer Trupti Das expressed surprise at seeing photographs she did not herself possess. Reporting on the exhibition described more than a hundred photographs of film-music work from 1950 to 1986, alongside gramophone records. The Culture Department and Film Journalists' Forum collaborated on it; Deo credited material gathered from producers, directors, composers, lyricists, researchers and actors.[2]

Writing that travels beyond a screening

Some of the writing collected in *Kali Paine Kalira Cinema* grew from booklets prepared around Film Journalists' Forum screenings. The book brings together accounts of 21 films, giving an evening's encounter a life on the page.[3] Its recognition was a **Special Mention in Best Writing on Cinema at the 68th National Film Awards**, for the 2020 award cycle, announced in 2022.[4]

Deo's wider work includes *Odia Cinema Rupa Rupantara*, *Jhura Mana Jhara Giti* and compilations of Odia film lyrics. A narrative history, writing about music and a collection of song texts serve different readers and different questions.[5] Our guide to books on Odia cinema places these alongside work by other authors.

The National Film Archive of India also lists his *History of Odia Film* among its completed research-fellowship projects.[6]

Finding a copy is also work

A 2024 account of efforts to screen ଉଲ୍କା *(Ulka)* describes a damaged film print that could not be projected. A U-matic video cassette was subsequently traced and cleaned for use.[7] It was a way to bring the film back before viewers; the report does not establish a restoration from the original film negative.

A surviving video copy allowed an audience to meet the film again. Its recovery mattered, even while the future of the film elements remained a separate question.

Memory can become another film

Filmmaker **Lipika Singh Darai's** project *Rediscovering Sita Bibaha* provides a particularly suggestive connection. India Foundation for the Arts names Deo as her collaborator and describes gramophone recordings, contracts, poster copies and press material in his collection informing her search. The project concerns the missing first Odia film and the world around its making.[8]

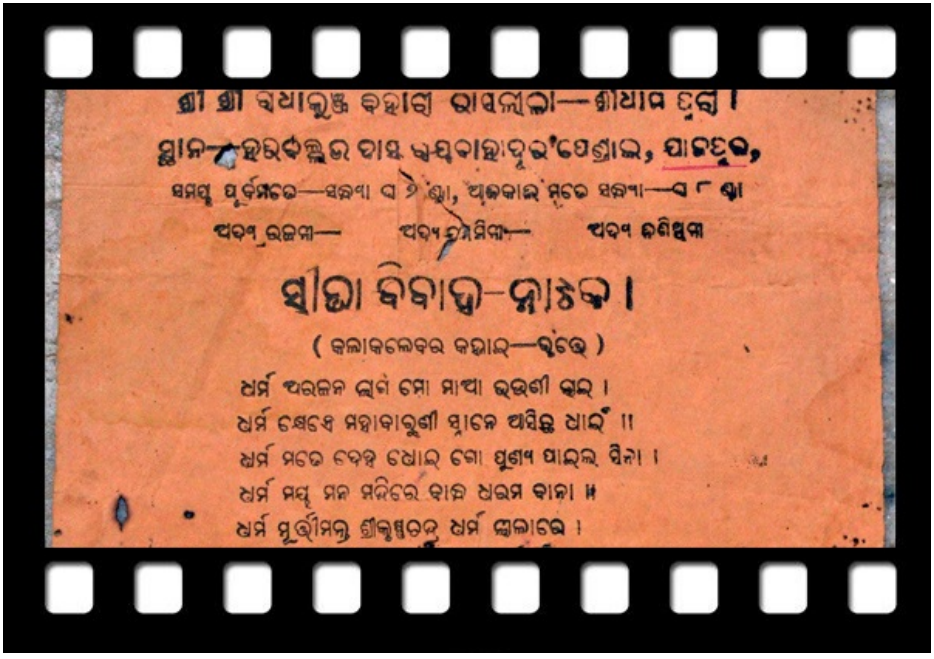
Here, the archive is part of a new creative process. A filmmaker asks what surviving traces can tell us - and how to tell a story when the film itself is absent. Our companion article follows that search.

Deo's public record gives us a picture of sustained attention, supported by many people who kept something, shared something or helped an audience see it again. For a cinema seeking its next possibilities, that work offers more than reassurance about the past. It leaves material with which someone else can begin.

Something kept, ready to be passed on.

PART 4 · MEMORY AND DISCOVERY

38 Searching for Sita Bibaha: the film beyond the missing print



Sita Bibaha printed material, reproduced by OrissaPOST. [8]

A song, a contract, a poster: small things can hold a large absence.

The first Odia film, ସୀତା ବିବାହ *(Sita Bibaha)*, has a place in our histories that few readers have been able to encounter on a screen. In 2011, Mohan Sunder Deb Goswami's grandson, Kabiraj Deb Goswami, told a reporter that no print was available.[1] That was a statement about what could be found then, not a reason to stop asking.

Years later, filmmaker **Lipika Singh Darai** made the search the subject of a new project, with **Surya Deo** as collaborator. Their point of departure includes recordings and paper records he has collected.[2] A

history that seems to end with an unavailable film opens into the possibility of another.

Returning to 1936

An earlier Calcutta screening preceded the film's **28 April 1936** Puri opening.[3]

Our cinema overview places this beginning within a longer story. Here, the question is what survives around it - and what those traces might allow us to understand.

The people before the screen

The 2011 report identifies a play by **Kamapal Mishra** as the source and names **Makhanlal Banerjee**, **Aditya Ballav Mohanty** as Lakshman, and **Prabhabati Devi** as Sita among the performers.[1] A beginning commonly remembered through one filmmaker's name was also an adaptation and a collaboration.

Piyush Roy's research connects Goswami to touring rasalila and records Surya Deo's interpretation of the film as primarily *gitinatya*, or musical drama. Roy also distinguishes Goswami's credited role from accounts of Kali Films and technical collaborators in Calcutta.[4] These are questions for closer historical reading, rather than grounds for silently rewriting the credits.

An existing dramatic text and Goswami's performance experience met a new recording medium. That connection is specific to this production; it does not make every Odia performance tradition its direct ancestor.

What a surviving object can tell us

India Foundation for the Arts describes the material informing Darai's project: gramophone recordings of musically narrated versions, artists' contracts, copies of posters and newspaper coverage.[2]

Each kind of record invites a different question. What does a contract say someone was expected to do? What did a poster promise an audience? How was a story presented in a recording? A record may answer one question and leave another open.

These musical narrations have not been established as the film's original soundtrack. Heard alongside a poster or contract, they can still help us explore the world around its making.

A filmmaker who listens for memory

Darai's own account gives this project a human setting. She trained in sound recording and design at FTII. She describes **Ho as her mother tongue and Odia as the language of her schooling and filmmaking**. Her biography also recalls how tracing her late childhood music teacher became the subject of her first film.[5]

Language here is a place of meeting, with different personal histories entering it. That belongs in the story of Odia cinema as much as a release date does.

Her filmography includes *Backstage*, concerning puppeteers in Odisha, and works shaped as imagined conversations with her late grandaunt.[6] These descriptions suggest an interest in the relationship between memory and the form a film can take. They do not tell us in advance what *Rediscovering Sita Bibaha* will become.

IFA's 2024-25 annual report records the project as a proposed **docufiction**, combining documentation and fictional interpretation.[7] The distinction is useful for a viewer: a new enactment can be part of a

filmmaker's response to the past while remaining recognisable as something made in the present.

A completed film, release date or recovered print has not been confirmed.

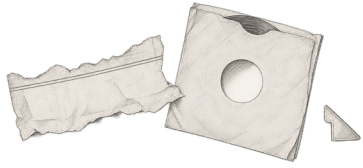
What the search leaves open

This story returns us to the work of keeping cinema's memory available. A collection acquires another life when a filmmaker brings new questions to it. Research can support an artwork; that artwork can lead a viewer back to the records.

There are still things to seek: a traceable copy, original credits, fuller accounts of the performers, and the relationship between the surviving music and the film. A responsible telling can acknowledge these gaps without making absence the whole story.

For Darai, the process of looking has itself become a subject. The newspaper, the song and the conversation are material for a new work, even while the older film remains unavailable.

Sita Bibaha remains a beginning. The search around it offers another.



Following what remains.

Film cans from the restoration of Maya Miriga. [10]

PART 4 · MEMORY AND DISCOVERY

39 Who Keeps a Film Alive?

Biren Das's television work reached another stage of its life when he donated tapes to JD Centre of Art. Das, a filmmaker and founding trustee of the centre, had directed the 1990s programme *Ajira Orissa*. Its U-matic and Beta tapes became part of a collection encompassing films on art and recordings of tribal and folk culture. JDCA reports that selected tapes were digitised with the National Cultural Audiovisual Archive at IGNCA.[1]

A programme made for one audience could now become material for another. Between those encounters stood a handover, an institution willing to keep the recordings, and people able to work with their formats. The question in this article's title begins there: who takes responsibility after a film or programme has finished its first public life?

Keeping the film, and the world around it

A cinema's memory includes more than completed features. Photographs, posters, song booklets and press material belong to NFDC-National Film Archive of India's documentation collection. Its work combines cataloguing with digitisation intended to reduce handling of originals.[2]

A name on a photograph or a date on a booklet can give a later researcher somewhere to begin. The object and the information accompanying it need to stay connected. A digital image becomes more useful when someone can establish what it shows, who supplied it and where the original is held.

Surya Deo's story follows the contribution of collectors and film workers to that shared memory. Searching for Sita Bibaha asks what

can be made from surviving traces when a film print cannot be found. Here, the next question is how such material can receive continuing care.

Different tasks, a shared purpose

Conservation means caring for the material itself. Digitisation makes a digital representation of a film, tape or paper object. Restoration may involve further work on damaged or incomplete images and sound. Cataloguing makes the material identifiable and findable; arranging access allows someone else to encounter it. These are distinct skills, reflected in the Film Heritage Foundation and FIAF preservation workshop held at Kalabhoomi in Bhubaneswar in November 2025.[3]

The distinction is practical. Scanning a poster does not settle how to store the paper. Having a video file does not settle its identification or future upkeep. And a restored film still needs a route to viewers. The return of ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga) gives that last connection a particular history, with the restoration and its later screenings described together.

Maya Miriga before and after restoration. [11]

OFDC's 2024-25 reporting described an archive at its Cuttack corporate office and recorded 51 films stored on LTO, with ten undergoing digitisation. Those are figures from that reporting period, rather than a current total or a count of fully restored films.[4] The figures record storage and work in progress.

Skills need somewhere to continue

A workshop can begin a working life. Continuing it takes somewhere to practise, experienced colleagues and time paid for the care each object needs.

A November 2025 agreement between the Odisha government and Film Heritage Foundation concerned preservation and an archive centre.[5] Kalinga Studio's cinema archive and museum were inaugurated in October 2026.[6] The established Cuttack collection, the agreement and the inauguration should each retain their own place in

the chronology; a collection's location and access arrangements need to be established individually.

Paid placements alongside experienced conservators and cataloguers could help trainees continue this work. Time to practise, ask for help and care for an object is part of what an institution would need to support. The learning-cinema reading follows that need for continued guidance in other kinds of film work.

Custody and access belong together

NFDC-NFAI describes donations by filmmakers and collectors, and deposits of negatives and prints through agreements with producers or copyright holders. It also evaluates used prints for condition and suitability for preservation or projection.[7] A handover therefore involves decisions about the object, its condition and the terms under which it will be held.

Knowing where a film is kept is a beginning. A researcher may need a viewing copy; an organiser may need permission for a public screening. Those requests serve different purposes. A useful collection description would help people understand whom to approach and what information to supply, without making them assume that possession of a copy grants every right to use it.

There are established routes worth exploring. NFAI's library page asks visitors seeking library or digital material to book at least three days ahead.[8] Its Distribution Library serves member cultural and

educational institutions and film societies, with conditions that vary by title.[9] Before planning a visit or screening, ask about the particular item and intended use. These national services are distinct from Odisha's state and independent collections.

What we can carry forward

For a family holding a songbook, photograph or labelled tape, a useful first contribution could be to write down the names, dates and story of how it came into their care. Keep uncertain identifications marked as uncertain. When approaching an institution, ask what it can accept, what documentation it needs and how the family's contribution would be acknowledged. Damaged film deserves specialist advice rather than an improvised repair.

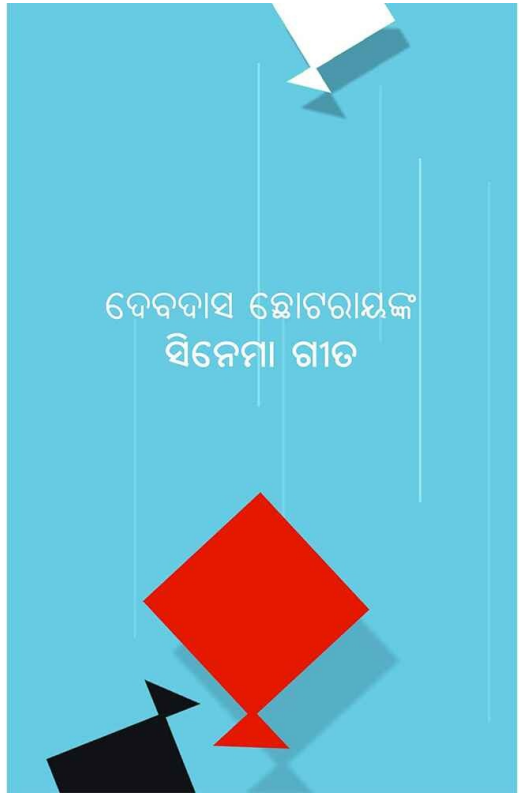
A permitted screening can bring the work before people again, with time to acknowledge those who made and preserved it. The economics of cinema extends into this continuing labour: a completed film still asks for skilled time, resources and agreements.

Keeping a film alive is work passed between people. The person who saves a tape, the person who describes it, the technician who makes it usable and the organiser who brings it before viewers each carries a part. A future audience becomes possible when those contributions can meet.

Ready for another audience.

PART 4 · MEMORY AND DISCOVERY

40 Reading Odia Cinema: the books behind the screen



Devdas Chhotray's Cinema Geeta, published by Ketaki Foundation Trust. [21]

A song can remain with a family long after the film around it has become difficult to find. A photograph may outlive the studio where it was taken. Somewhere, a reader opens a book and encounters the name of the person who wrote the song.

The writing around Odia cinema belongs to this continuing exchange. It includes histories and criticism, but also collected lyrics, working

lives and memories kept by families. Read together, these works can bring more people into the picture.

This growing guide draws on selected original pages and public previews, as well as catalogue and publication leads. It is not an exhaustive bibliography or a review of every book. The entries distinguish what is available and keep unsettled edition details visible.

Begin with the question you want to follow. For chronology, look towards Ghosh and Rath; for cinema's social questions, Sanjoy Patnaik. For songs, try Surya Deo's collections and Devdas Chhotray's lyrics. For a working life remembered from within, turn to the memoirs below.

Where a longer account begins

Kartik Kumar Ghosh - *Oriya Chalachitrara Itihas*. A Fakir Mohan University accession list records a first edition dated **1984**. The explanatory notes in the *Encyclopedia of Indian Cinema* also identify Ghosh's work as a source. This is an important earlier point of reference when tracing who has documented the field; later bibliographies give another date, so editions still need to be compared.[1]

Bhim Singh - *Odia Chalachitrara Agyanta Adhyay*. The filmmaker's book is documented in biographical reporting and later scholarship. Roy's bibliography gives 2008; the edition history still needs to be established. Its place here also reminds us that practitioners have written about the industry from within.[2]

Surya Deo - *Odia Cinema Rupa Rupantara*. A history of changing forms of Odia cinema. Reports place its beginnings in 2010; a bookseller lists a 2016 second edition. His *Kali Paine Kalira Cinema*, published by Pakshighar Prakashanee, brings together accounts of 21 films. It received a **Special Mention for Best Writing on Cinema** in the 68th National Film Awards, announced in 2022 for the 2020 cycle.[3, 4]

Ranjan Kumar Rath - *Evolution of Odia Cinema: A Historical Study (1936-2010)*. Published by B K Publications in 2024, this English-language study is listed at 324 pages. In the preview passages we examined, the cinema's beginnings connect to theatre-trained actors, musicians, makeup workers and stage builders. That is a useful starting point for following skills across media. Explore the available Google Books preview.[5]

Sanjoy Patnaik - *Of Reels, Romance and Retakes: Social Narratives of Cinema in Odisha*. Released in 2023, with Routledge's catalogue carrying a 2024 copyright date, this study places cinema in a social and cultural frame. Its contents and publisher description point towards literature, audiences, class, gender and the industry's future. We have read selected preview passages, not the full arguments of those chapters. Explore the Google Books preview.[6]

The books ask different questions: what followed what, who participated, and how audiences encountered the films.

Songs, literature and the people around a film

Surya Deo - *Jhura Mana Jhara Giti*. A study of Odia film music, documented in his published profiles. Alongside it are his two film-song compilations: *Odia Cinema Gita 1936-1969* and a second volume described in a festival biography as covering **1970-1978**. The first appears in a government book-selection list and a scholarly bibliography; the second volume's exact title-page date range still needs inspection.[3, 7]

Devdas Chhotray - *Cinema Geeta* (ସିନେମା ଗୀତ). Published by Ketaki Foundation Trust in January 2020, this collection gathers Chhotray's film lyrics. A lyricist's words on the page offer a different object of attention from the finished recording.[8]

Dillip Kumar Pani - *Odia Chalachitra Ra Sahitika O Sanskrutika Mulyayana*. Its launch was reported alongside a 2019 Film Journalists'

Forum screening of ରକ୍ତ ଗୋଲାପ *(Rakta Golapa)*. The title concerns cinema's literary and cultural evaluation. We still need the title page to settle its exact transliteration and publication details.[9]

Iti Samanta, editor/compiler - ***Odia Cinema: Expansion & Analysis (1936-2019)*.** Her author website lists this work with material spanning creative and technical roles. The English wording is how the website presents the title; it does not establish an English-language edition.[10]

Sanjoy Patnaik, editor - ***Odia Cinema@90: Rhythms, Renditions and Reflections*.** The Bhubaneswar Film Circle's 2024 collection brings multiple contributors into the discussion. A contemporary review identifies writing on literature, folk music, film songs, production facilities and representation. The festival's subsequent report describes the book as bilingual. The organisers later reported that nearly 200 copies sold within an hour of its launch.[11]

Pragati Mohapatra's chapter on literary classics and cinema is also recorded in her institution's publication list. The collection's review names Mahasweta Baxipatra on film songs and Debasis Mohapatra on folk music. These are promising routes for further reading, rather than arguments we can claim to have examined in full.[11]

Sandip Kumar Nayak - ***Ollywood and Its Superstars: Its All About Odia Cinema*.** Catalogues list this short English-language book from Notion Press in 2021. Its contents have not been assessed here.[12]

A lyric collection may help us find a writer's contribution. An interview collection may reveal an editor, a technician or a producer whose decisions shaped a film. For the question that brought us here - how creative work reaches people and supports those who make it - both deserve attention.

Lives that sit beside the histories

A memoir remembers from one position. A family account preserves access to another. Those qualities make such books valuable, while leaving room to compare recollections with other records.

- **Sarat Chandra Pujari - *Nijaswa Chitranatya: Smrutipatha*.** Collected autobiographical writings, edited by Pritish Acharya (Sikshasandhan, 2015). In the title essay, Pujari recalls being asked how a film actor could also be a college principal. The question opens a way to read him beyond his screen roles.[13]

- **Ratri Ghose Barman - *Gour & Parbati*.** Launched in 2021, this family-authored account concerns Gour Prasad Ghose and Parbati Ghose. The family archive provides a route into their photographs and continuing remembrance.[14]

- **Akshaya Mohanty - *Aryyadasara Atmalipi* and *Aryyadasara Sheshalipi*.** The catalogue records these as separate works, dated 2002 and 2003. They belong to his autobiographical literary writing; individual episodes should not be treated as independently established biography merely because they appear in that form.[15]

- **Iti Samanta, compiler - *Amara Akshaya*.** Her bibliography lists this work on Akshaya Mohanty and his literary creations. Its wider literary scope makes it a companion to cinema reading rather than a general film history.[10]

Read beyond the cinema shelf

Four broader works offer useful connections without being books exclusively about Odia cinema:

- **Piyush Roy's *Appreciating Melodrama: Theory and Practice in Indian Cinema and Television*** includes a chapter on rasa, the *Natyashastra* and the birth of Odia cinema. The publisher's contents

identify the chapter; our earlier research used selected passages of Roy's related doctoral thesis.[16]

- **Ashish Rajadhyaksha and Paul Willemen's *Encyclopedia of Indian Cinema*** offers a wider reference setting. Its bibliographic trail also makes earlier documentation visible.[1]

- **Sharmila Chhotaray's *Cultural Politics of Popular Performances: The Structure and Representation of the Odia Jatra*** concerns theatre rather than cinema. It belongs beside our exploration of storytelling, audiences and performance economies.[17]

- **Madhusudan Pati - *Kalindi Charan Panigrahi*.** Published by Sahitya Akademi in 2001, this literary biography leads from *Matira Manisha* into the writer's working life. In selected sample pages, Pati describes a handwritten magazine carrying Odia, Bengali and English writing under Kalindi's editorship. He also follows memoir instalments for *Kalana* into an enlarged autobiography. Magazine-making and recollection offer two ways to approach the person behind the film's story credit.[18]

Periodicals and the people behind the pages

A magazine can give stories, songs and the people making a film a place to meet. In his retrospective account of **Chitrapuri**, Surya Deo describes film-special issues carrying stories, songs, crew names and contributors' own experiences. Fiction and radio plays also appeared alongside cinema writing.[19] His account invites us towards the original issues, where those different voices shared space on the page.

The opening pages of the *Encyclopedia of Indian Cinema* make another kind of collaboration visible. Its acknowledgements name **Chandidas Mishra** and **Samarendra Das** among the Odia contributors. Its source notes identify Ghosh's 1984 history and credit Das with compiling information after 1986.[1] Behind a reference entry are people finding,

assembling and passing on information. Their names deserve to accompany the films we look up.

A smaller object offers a further reading trail. Indiana University's **South Asian Cinema Ephemera Collection** lists a booklet titled *Shesha drushti = The last vision: an Oriya film*, catalogued as 1997. That is the item's catalogue date, not an established release date for the film.[20] The booklet's pages remain to be examined.

A shelf that can keep growing

The present reading list identifies **14 cinema-focused entries and five related entries in life writing or tribute**, with the four broader works above kept separate. Editions and formats are not interchangeable: the two reported song compilations are listed separately, while a paperback and an ebook of the same text are not different works.

Older editions and overlooked writing may still change this shelf. A title page supplied by a reader can settle an uncertainty; a full reading can change what we thought a book offered.

For Project Odisha, the next step is to let that reading sharpen our questions. What can an earlier production teach a new team? How did a song acquire a life beyond its film? Which experiences have still not reached a page?

A bibliography becomes useful when somebody follows it - and returns with something we had not yet seen.

A book can preserve an earlier film's history. It can also hold the story from which another film begins.

PART 5 · A NEW SEARCH FOR STORIES

41 Gourahari Das: fiction, public life and the art of listening

The written story returns to the centre of our journey. Gourahari Das's Bapa inspired Pratikshya. A different encounter, in Malkangiri, leads towards DAMaN. These beginnings let us look behind recognition and meet people deciding that a story was worth the work.

Gourahari Das, photographed on 3 March 2011. [18]

A constable wants a promotion. The man in his custody begins to speak. In Gourahari Das's short story **"The Culprit,"** the encounter gradually unsettles the policeman's sense of what that promotion would mean. Listening changes the weight of the case before him.[1]

ଗୌରହରି ଦାସ **(Gourahari Das)** writes across short fiction, novels, columns, essays, plays and translation.[2] Cinema is one of the places that work has travelled; the literary life is larger.

Formative surroundings and education

The biographical account on his website places his beginnings in **Sandhagara near the Mantei river**. It describes growing up in a monastery amid financial hardship, then continuing his education with scholarships, studying at Ravenshaw and pursuing postgraduate study at Utkal University.[3]

What a short story can make us reconsider

The exchange between Nimai and Sanatan in “The Culprit” gives the detained man room to be heard. Read the complete story in **Snehaprava Das’s translation** at The Dreaming Machine, published through an exchange with *The Antonym*.[1] The translator and journal bring that encounter to people who do not read Odia.

The description of **The Little Monk and Other Stories** on Das’s website introduces rural lives, uneasy family relationships and people living with unequal power.[4] This is another route into his short fiction, alongside **Kanta O’ Anyanya Galpa**, the collection recognised by the Sahitya Akademi in 2012.[5]

Novels and the pressure of a choice

Panchaparba, published by Friends Publishers in 2019, gathers five novels: *Chhayasoudhara Abasesha*, *Nija Sange Nijara Ladhei*, *Eithu Arambha*, *Apananka Ajnadhina* and *Kete Rangara Jibana*. Its bibliographic description foregrounds women facing constraints on safety, choice and independence.[6]

One English reading route is **The Labyrinth**, translated by **Manoranjan Mishra**. Niyogi Books describes its central character,

Draupadi, caught between reporting a crime and protecting her family.[7] The dilemma is a useful question to carry into the novel: what happens when doing what seems right also threatens someone one loves?

The newspaper column and the editor's desk

Das's literary life also includes journalism. The Kalinga Literary Festival biography identifies **Rajdhani Rajneeti**, a Sambad column written as **Sri Narada**, and **Jibanara Jalachabi**, a column drawing on observations of life.[8] The newspaper offers a different rhythm from the novel: a recurring conversation with readers, returning to public affairs and daily experience.

The **2022 Kolkata Literary Meet** profile records him as Sambad's features editor, editor of the literary monthly **Katha**, and principal of the **Sambad School of Media and Culture**.[9]

His website's 2019 account also describes *Katha*'s young-writer competition and his theatre involvement.[10] Editing brought him into contact with other writers' work, including those entering through the young-writer competition.

Translation in both directions

Sahitya Akademi's English catalogue lists **The Nail and Other Stories**, translated by **Mona Lisa Jena** from *Kanta O' Anyanya Galpa*, in a 2017 edition.[11, 5]

Das is also a translator into Odia. The Akademi's **2021 Translation Prize** recognises **Chheli Chareibara Dina**, his translation of Benyamin's Malayalam novel *Aadujeevitham*, known in English as *Goat Days*.[12] The 2022 Kolkata profile additionally records his translations of autobiographical work by **Kuldip Nayar and Ruskin Bond**.[9]

These journeys run both ways. Readers elsewhere encounter Odia fiction through translators such as Jena and Mishra; Odia readers encounter other literary worlds through Das's translations. Translation is part of a living language's curiosity, as well as its visibility.

Recognition and a reading route

Alongside the Akademi recognitions attached to his writing and translation, Das received the **2022 Sarala Puraskar**, recorded by award organiser IMPaCT.[13]

For a first encounter, read "The Culprit" online. For a collection, explore *The Nail and Other Stories* or *The Little Monk and Other Stories*. For a longer fictional world, follow *The Labyrinth* or the novels gathered in *Panchaparba*. Together they offer several lengths and forms in which to spend time with his writing.

One journey from fiction to cinema

The IFFI account of ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା **(Pratikshya)** credits a short story by Das as the film's inspiration. Director **Anupam Patnaik** and lead actor **Dipanwit Dashmohapatra** bring another set of creative lives into that journey.[14]

The film companion explores the family drama. Ashok Palit's interview with Patnaik names the source story as *Bapa*.[15] The adaptation offers a way back to the writer, just as a book can send a reader towards theatre or a film.

In a December 2022 account, Das says he wrote *Bapa* in 2000 and that it appears in Rupa's *The Little Monk and Other Stories*. He also recalls an earlier television film, *BAPA*, made by Nirmal Rout of Bhadrak.[16]

Recognition returned him to the film's public life. Das reports being felicitated as *Pratikshya*'s original story writer at an OFDC event at Kalinga Studio on 24 October 2026. In his account, he names Roshan separately as screenwriter and Anupam Patnaik as director.[17]

A viewer coming from *Pratikshya* can return to Nimai and Sanatan in "The Culprit," or to Draupadi's dilemma in *The Labyrinth*. The film opens a door into a much larger body of writing.

PART 5 · A NEW SEARCH FOR STORIES

42 ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା (Pratikshya): a family waiting for security

During the making of Pratikshya. [8]

Four applicants sit shoulder to shoulder, books and papers on their laps. In the official trailer for ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା **(Pratikshya)**, Sanjay turns towards the woman beside him while the two men on his other side keep looking down at their reading material. The row fills the frame. His search for a job already has company: other people, other pages, another turn to wait for.[1]

The Film Bazaar viewing-room synopsis locates the story in a middle-class Bhubaneswar household. Sanjay wants a government job; his father Bipin approaches retirement while the family carries wedding debt. Illness changes the meaning of their waiting.[2]

A writer, a director and a leading actor

The official IFFI account identifies a short story by **Gourahari Das** as the film's inspiration. Anupam Patnaik directed it; **Dipanwit Dashmohapatra**, playing Sanjay, described this as his first lead role.[3]

Asked about adapting Gourahari Das's *Bapa*, Patnaik said he had connected with the story when he read it. He chose *Pratikshya* because waiting extended beyond the father relationship: waiting for a job, marriage and a settled life.[4]

In his account of *Bapa*, Das recalls an earlier television film of the story, made by Nirmal Rout of Bhadrak and shown on Doordarshan.[5]

Patnaik's profile follows the work that led to the film. The Gourahari Das profile opens a path to the writer's fiction beyond this adaptation.

Alongside Dipanwit Dashmohapatra, the ensemble includes **Choudhury Jayprakash Das, Barsha Patnaik, Sreela Tripathy and Roopambika Nayak**.[1]

The pressure inside a household

The Film Bazaar synopsis describes Sanjay learning of compassionate appointment after an employee's death. The prospect distorts his hopes for his father.[2]

The discomfort of that premise gives viewers room to think about the relationship between affection and economic pressure. A household can contain care, resentment and dependence at the same time. The film's premise holds those feelings together, making security a question about relationships as well as income.

A film's development and its recognition

The Film Bazaar entry credits **Roshan Bisoi** as writer, placing screenwriting beside the source story in the film's creative history.[2]

Deepak Kumar's cinematography and **Deven Mishra's editing** helped bring that writing to the screen. **Barsha Patnaik** contributed production and costume design; **Ankesh Anand and Ashish Pradhan** composed the music and background score, with **Bivash Rath** composing one song.[6]

Pratikshya later received **Best Odia Film at the 69th National Film Awards**, announced in August 2023 for the **2021 award year**. The result names **Amiya Patnaik Productions** and **Anupam Patnaik** as producer and director recipients.[7]

Watch an official introduction

The official trailer offers an introduction to the film. Availability may vary by location.

You can also select the Pratikshya trailer in our viewing room, where it remains clearly separated from full-film listings.

The household's search for stability lingers beyond its synopsis. The economics chapter turns to a different uncertainty: how the people making such a film can sustain their own work.

Waiting, within a household.

PART 5 · A NEW SEARCH FOR STORIES

43 Anupam Patnaik: the work behind the waiting

Anupam Patnaik in Bhubaneswar, December 2023. [7]

Seventeen drafts and three years of work: that is how Anupam Patnaik described making ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା *(Pratikshya)*. In an interview before its release, he recalled working with screenwriter Roshan Bisoi to find the shape of a story about a son, an ailing father and the longing for a secure job.[1] The title means waiting. Behind the finished film was another kind of patience - the repeated work of returning to a story until it could be filmed.

Learning the work of production

Patnaik's education took him through business administration and information technology at Symbiosis, then an MSc in International Marketing Management at Leeds University Business School. His production company's biography dates his entry into television and film production to 2011, with work on Tarang's *Horror Zone* and the shorts *Ichha - A Silent Urge* and *Smruti - Memories*.[2]

Feature production came before the recognition for his direction. The Bengaluru International Film Festival's 2016 catalogue credits him as producer of ତୁଳସୀ ଆପା *(Tulasi Apa)*, directed by his father, Amiya Patnaik. The film follows the life and educational work of Tulasi Munda.[3]

A family story carried through loss

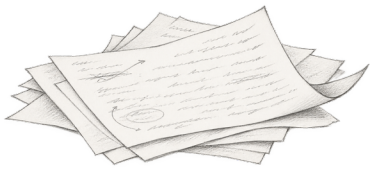
Pratikshya drew inspiration from a short story by Gourahari Das. As Patnaik recounted at IFFI in 2022, his father died during the film's development. He considered stopping; his family encouraged him to finish it. The same festival account records Dipanwit Dashmohapatra describing Sanjay as his first leading role.[4]

Pratikshya received **Best Odia Film at the 69th National Film Awards**, announced in August 2023 for films of **2021**. The official result names **Amiya Patnaik Productions** as producer recipient and **Anupam Patnaik** as director recipient.[5]

Another story, another form

Patnaik's later କର୍ମ *(Karma, 2024)* moved into a murder-investigation thriller, with Anubhav Mohanty playing investigator Amar Patnaik.[6] A family drama and a thriller ask different things of a director. Together, they suggest a career still exploring what kinds of stories can find an audience in the language.

Seventeen drafts are easy to compress into a sentence. Patnaik's recollection asks us to leave room for the time behind them: writing with Bisoi, losing his father, and accepting his family's encouragement to continue.



Time between one draft and the next.

PART 5 · A NEW SEARCH FOR STORIES

44 ଦମନ (DAMaN): the road from Malkangiri to national recognition

Babushaan Mohanty and Dipanwit Dashmohapatra in a scene from DAMaN. [17]

The story began with another film that needed making. In 2020, Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka travelled to Malkangiri for a documentary assignment about malaria prevention. What stayed with them was the work: doctors, ASHA and anganwadi workers, and staff from other departments reaching distant villages. Mourya later recalled that encounter as the inspiration for ଦମନ *(DAMaN)*.[1]

On **16 August 2024**, *DAMaN* was announced as **Best Odia Film at the 70th National Film Awards**, which honoured films of **2022**. The official record names producer JP Motion Pictures and directors Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka.[2]

The award followed a story rooted in the difficult business of getting care to people.

The people who brought it together

Vishal Mourya: learning to work together

Vishal Mourya. [18]

Mourya recalled leaving software work after studying engineering, then finding his way into filmmaking. He met editor Debi Prasad

Lenka on a television project in 2010. Their collaboration made room for disagreement: they discussed shots together and worked through roughly ten drafts of *DAMaN* before filming.[3]

Debi Prasad Lenka: from voices to the edit

Debi Prasad Lenka at the 70th National Film Awards ceremony; broadcast frame. [19]

Lenka recalled a fifteen-day workshop before filming, during which preparation helped the team revise dialogue and translate passages spoken by tribal characters.[4] He also edited the film.[5] His contribution connects the words prepared for performance with the work of assembling its finished form.

Deependra Samal: a producer in the conversation

Deependra Samal at the 70th National Film Awards ceremony; broadcast frame. [20]

Samal produced the film under JP Motion Pictures.[6] Mourya recalled his encouragement to make something distinctive.[1] The directors also credited him with constructive feedback and an understanding of the project's needs.[7]

These responsibilities met the work of local performers, technicians and the healthcare workers who inspired the film.

A doctor who has to decide whether to stay

The catalogue sets the story in 2015: a young doctor takes up a posting in Malkangiri and commits himself to tackling malaria.[5] Babushaan Mohanty plays the doctor; Dipanwit Dashmohapatra plays the pharmacist.[8]

The premise raises a question: what happens when an assignment becomes a responsibility a person can no longer walk away from? The film gives that question a particular location and profession.

Babushaan Mohanty, photographed in 2018, before DAMaN. [21]

Babushaan told *Indulge* that he spoke with doctors while preparing for the role. He also described the Hindi release as fulfilling his wish to take his industry to a national audience. The ambition he expressed was to carry work from Odisha further while continuing to belong to its film industry.[9]

Making the story travel

Mourya said the production drew performers from the Koraput and Jeypore film societies, alongside the lead actors and other local talent. Pratap Rout handled cinematography.[1, 5]

The soundtrack brought another set of collaborators into that journey. Mourya credits **Gaurav Anand** with the music and **Tushar Jena** with the score, recalling roughly six months spent developing the music.[1]

DAMaN opened in Odia on **4 November 2022**. Its Hindi version reached cinemas on **3 February 2023**. The second release brought the Odia production to viewers in another language.[9, 8]

Contemporary reporting described packed shows during the first week. The New Indian Express recorded an opening in **51 theatres in Odisha and 15 across nine other cities**, including Bengaluru, Mumbai and Delhi.[10] The release gave the team's ambition to reach audiences beyond the state a concrete form.

The reception was not uniform. *Film Information*, reviewing the Hindi version, praised the lead performances but found the screenplay slow and its dramatic appeal limited. That contemporary dissent belongs beside the later national honour. The film was finding attention and different responses at the same time.[8]

The people beyond the central character

A feature film can organise a complex effort around one protagonist. The history behind it needs a wider frame.

That choice also drew criticism. Atri Prasad Rout, writing in *OrissaPOST*, admired the filmmaking but warned that building the story around a single doctor risked making an outsider into a saviour.[11] In *Countercurrents*, Pradyumna Behera argued that the film gave too little space to Adivasi agency and the history behind unequal access to healthcare.[12] These readings ask whose experience a story brings forward when it follows the person arriving to help.

The real programme, **Durgama Anchalare Malaria Nirakarana**, began implementation in 2017, after the film's 2015 setting. Its work in remote and high-burden villages depends on repeated camps and screening.[13, 14] A published camp evaluation found reduced infection odds in its early-camp group, but its non-randomised design could not establish causation; it measured the programme, not the film.[14]

Health workers interviewed in a 2025 study described infrastructure, staffing and resource constraints, and proposed flexible camp schedules and more support for volunteers. Their accounts, from districts outside Malkangiri, show the organisation of care around the central encounter between a patient and a clinician.[15]

A resident's account brings those access barriers closer. In a 2023 *Down To Earth* report, a Bonda resident of Sanuguda in Malkangiri, identified under the changed name Raja Kirsani, described a walk of more than three hours to reach care because ambulances could not reach his village. His testimony concerns healthcare access, not a response to *DAMaN*.[16]

A cinema story and a programme history can illuminate each other while answering different questions. The fictional doctor gives the film a central journey; the wider record makes room for the repeated work of teams and volunteers.

Returning to the film

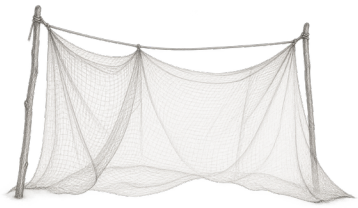
The production brought performers and film-society networks together; its release found audiences within and beyond Odisha. Watching it also leaves room to ask how the doctor's journey makes the people around him visible. Recognition and thoughtful disagreement can both keep a film in conversation. The accounts of workers and residents help that conversation attend to lives beyond the screen.

Watch and explore

- **Full-film listing: ଦମନ (DAMaN) on Amara Muzik Odia's YouTube channel.** Verified official-channel page displayed a 1:58:31 player. Playback was not started; access elsewhere is not guaranteed.

- **Official trailer: ଦମନ (DAMaN).** Amara Muzik Odia; a trailer, not the full film.

The work continues on other screens, through programmes that ask viewers to return.



Care continues beyond one journey.

Doordarshan Kendra, Bhubaneswar, photographed in 2022. [16]

PART 6 · CHANGING SCREENS

45 Odia television and the stories that came home

A story can enter a home at a familiar hour, or wait for someone to choose it on a phone. Television and streaming change the occasions for watching. The need for writing, performance and an audience remains.

A cinema screening asks viewers to enter a theatre. A television serial asks them to return to a story. Its characters can become familiar through repetition: a conversation continues tomorrow, a conflict develops over weeks, and a household's ordinary routines become the setting for drama.

For Odia storytelling, television added a different relationship between performers and audiences. It brought pictures into the domestic space already occupied by radio, and created a continuing demand for programmes. Its history belongs beside AIR Cuttack and Odia cinema, with room for their shared writers, performers, music and audiences.

A film actor on the small screen

କେମିତି କହିବି କହ **(Kemiti Kahibi Kaha)** offers a concrete connection between television and cinema's performers. ZEE5's programme page identifies **Siddhant Mohapatra** and **Supriya Nayak** in its cast and dates the Odia drama to 2021. Its central relationship brings a wealthy businessman and a younger woman into a story about love and an age difference.[1]

A serial gives that relationship time to develop across repeated episodes - and asks the production to keep it alive.

Before the satellite channel

Prasar Bharati's 2010-11 annual report traces a production centre in Cuttack to September 1973 and an Upagraha Kendra to August 1974, preparing programmes for the Satellite Instructional Television Experiment. It records Sambalpur's terrestrial service from 30 April 1978, local Odia programmes from Cuttack in November 1987, and the inauguration of the Bhubaneswar complex in November 1992. Production, transmission and a dedicated language channel were different stages of development.[2]

The experiment's educational purpose matters. Television was being considered as a way to address dispersed communities, rather than only as a delivery system for entertainment. Mrinal Chatterjee's historical account identifies Dhenkanal, Sambalpur and Phulbani among Odisha's SITE districts in 1975-76.[3]

A public platform for stories

Prasar Bharati dates the Odia Regional Language Satellite Service to **2 October 1993**, initially named DD-5. It records the change to DD-6 on **15 August 1994**, followed by round-the-clock broadcasting on **1 April 2001**. The satellite service built on the earlier production and transmission network.[4]

The broadcaster describes a programme mix spanning literature, folk music, dance, agriculture, news and festivals. Its public catalogue links କଥା ସରିତା **(Katha Sarita)** stories and ଗୋପାଳ ରହସ୍ୟ **(Gopala Rahasya)**, alongside a programme identified with Godabarisha Mishra's ପାଣୁ ମିଶ୍ର **(Panu Mishra)**. The catalogue connects literary and oral storytelling with television.[4]

A retrospective of Manmohan Mahapatra's work lists *Rakta Tirtha Eram* (1997) and *Nua Sakala* (2000) for DDK Bhubaneswar. The work list places a feature filmmaker within the broadcaster's production history.[5]

Cable and private channels broaden the schedule

Odisha Television Network dates its beginnings to a cable service in Bhubaneswar and Cuttack in 1997, and its move to satellite broadcasting to 2006. That news-oriented history belongs alongside entertainment television, rather than standing in for it.[6]

Chatterjee's account describes ETV's arrival in the early 2000s and the expansion of Odia entertainment through Tarang in 2008. It also credits independent producer Biren Das with the 1995 news magazine *Ajira Odisha*: production initiatives mattered as well as channel ownership.[3]

A later corporate milestone was ZEE's acquisition of Sarthak Entertainment. Its financial notes record the company becoming a wholly owned subsidiary on **4 December 2015**, identifying Sarthak TV as an Odia general-entertainment channel. This was an acquisition, not the channel's founding date.[7]

These developments created different places for a programme to be commissioned and encountered: public broadcasting, a local cable service and competing entertainment schedules.

Animation, and the language a child hears

An Odia voice can make an animated character familiar before a child can read its name. Behind that encounter are writers, voice performers, animators and the people finding a way to bring their work to a screen. Odisha's animation ventures include shorts, television series and feature projects, each with its own production demands.

IDMT's own catalogue records ଚତୁର କାଉ (Chatura Kau) as an Odia animated short released on 14 January 2008. It also describes ଧର୍ମପଦ (Dharmapada) as an animated feature project. The short and the proposed feature show different ambitions within local animation.[8]

କୁନି ଗଣେଶ (Kuni Ganesha) provides a television connection. Reporting on Media Pixels Productions described an eight-episode Odia 3D series prepared for Doordarshan, with Gouri Shankar Singh as producer and Jyotiranjan Swain as writer-director. The account also records the difficulty of bringing funding and technology together.[9]

A later example connects local production to national broadcasting. ELE Animations' announcement for ଜୟ ଜଗନ୍ନାଥ (Jay Jagannath) describes its collaboration with Toonz and Warner Bros. Discovery and a Pogo premiere in May 2024. The six announced broadcast languages did not include Odia. The collaboration connects an Odisha studio to a wider children's television audience, while leaving an Odia-language broadcast unconfirmed.[10]

The distinction continues into features. ELE's ମହାପ୍ରଭୁ ଜଗନ୍ନାଥ (Mahaprabhu Jagannath), directed by Shripad Warkhedkar, received a trade review recording a Bombay theatrical release on 4 September 2026. Producer publicity named Odia among its planned languages. An advertised language does not establish that an Odia-language screening took place.[11, 12]

These productions also widen the economics story. ELE's agreement announcement describes distribution, licensing and merchandising alongside the series itself. Such rights offer possible income beyond tickets; the announcement provides no audited return.[13]

A child may meet an original Odia story or hear a translated one in Odia. Both depend on people shaping words and voices for that audience.

The people keeping the pictures on air

The expanding schedules depended on different kinds of teamwork, from a live festival broadcast to a serial delivered on time.

Participant **Fakira Mohan Nahak** recalls ETV's **12 July 2002** Rath Yatra coverage as a coordinated operation: **Sanjay Pathak** led the Puri field team, broadcast engineer **Akshay Mohanty** handled the technical system, **Amitabh Bhattashali** led the Hyderabad team and **Vijay Krishna** handled panel production. Nahak also describes arranging graphics for the transition to live pictures. Those named roles - and the wider crew - made the broadcast possible.[14]

The work behind the returning characters

Serials need actors, but also writers, camera crews, editors, sound workers, makeup artists and the people who keep a production running. The promise of regular episodes creates work and a demanding timetable.

In a January 2025 interview, director **Mihir Swain**, then working on Tarang's *Rajayoga*, described how more broadcast days had led to longer shoots and less time to prepare episodes ahead. Producer **Akshay Parija** identified irregular delivery of outsourced stories as another obstacle. Actor **Sarmili** described the insecurity of promised roles being reassigned and the difficulty of depending on serial income. Their accounts bring the pressure of a continuing schedule into view.[15]

More episodes can create more work, while preparation time, pay and continuity of employment remain concerns in these interviews. The production schedule gives the channel history another scale: the time and resources available to make the next episode.

Television also travels through the internet

The same ZEE5 catalogue advertises episodes of *Kemiti Kahibi Kaha* before their television telecast for viewers in India. A television serial can therefore also be an on-demand offering. The serial's life now extends beyond its broadcast hour.[1]

The Odia OTT journey follows this extension of the schedule into a catalogue, alongside acquired films and work commissioned for streaming.

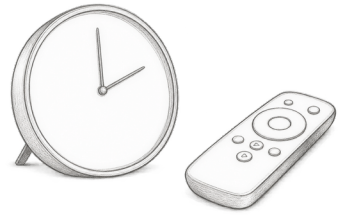
Watch and explore

Availability may vary by region and account conditions.

- **Programme and episode catalogue: କେମିତି କହିବି କହ (Kemiti Kahibi Kaha) on ZEE5.** Check individual episode access and current account terms.

- **Official programme information: DD Odia at Prasar Bharati.** Channel history and linked catalogue; not a promise that every listed programme is available to watch.

- **Producer catalogue:** IDMT's Utkal Cartoon World. Production information, not a verified full-film player.



A story beyond its scheduled hour.

PART 6 · CHANGING SCREENS

46 The Odia OTT journey and the search for an audience

Kaushik Das, founder of AAONXT. [9]

For an on-demand viewer, an episode can fit around the day rather than a fixed broadcast hour. A viewer may pause a story, return to it after work, or discover an Odia film far from a cinema that screens it. Streaming changes the circumstances of watching. Whether it also changes the stories depends on the people commissioning, writing and making them.

Odia OTT belongs within the longer history of theatre, radio, television and cinema. It provides another route to audiences, while drawing on works and performers already moving between those media.

What enters the catalogue

OTT, or over-the-top delivery, broadly describes media delivered through the internet. For this history, it helps to distinguish three kinds of offering: live or catch-up television, films acquired for streaming, and productions commissioned for a platform. An app can contain all three. “Original” and “exclusive” also need care: a work available exclusively through one service is not necessarily a work that service originally commissioned.

That is why the Odia journey has several starting points. A broadcaster can extend an existing television library; an independent service can build a catalogue and produce new work; a filmmaker can license a completed film.

From broadcaster to streaming service

A contemporary launch report dates **Tarang Plus** to **27 October 2019**, after an earlier planned launch was delayed. It described a service combining the network’s television channels with films, jatra, early access to serials and original web content. This was a bridge between established broadcasting and a different way of watching.[1]

Chumbak and the possibility of different stories

By March 2020, ଚୁମ୍ବକ **(Chumbak)** was providing a concrete example. MyCityLinks reported on the Tarang Plus series directed by **Susant Mani**, with **Tamanna Vyas** and **Divyadisha Mohanty**, about a same-gender relationship. Mani described the opportunity to experiment within a limited budget; Mohanty discussed preparing for a role that initially took her outside her comfort zone.[2]

The new commission asked something of both director and performer: a story Mani wanted to attempt, and a role Mohanty had to prepare for.

Independent platforms build another route

Kaushik Das, founder of **AAO NXT**, described a progression from **AAO TV in 2019**, which brought existing online Odia content together, to a fuller OTT service launched in **December 2020**. In his February 2023 interview, he explained that the venture needed both a technology operation and a production unit. His account places the work of building a catalogue beside the work of making originals.[3]

Kanccha Lannka represents another initiative. In a March 2025 interview, co-founder **Bibhu Prasad Rath** dated its establishment to **2021**, with **Akshay Parija** and **CR Nayak**. He named programmes including *Gangs of Puri*, *Barang 1999* and *Okha Express*, and discussed the challenge of meeting production expectations shaped by other language industries.[4]

Building a service means keeping both parts working: a place where viewers can find programmes and a continuing relationship with the people who make them.

Finding a place among other apps

Distribution also changed through bundles. On **12 January 2023**, Tata Play announced the addition of Tarang Plus to its Binge service, alongside other regional platforms. A viewer could encounter Odia programming through a shared subscription interface rather than searching for the standalone app. [5]

Language can travel beyond the state

Streaming offers a route to people who cannot attend an Odia theatrical screening nearby. In an April 2025 Mint report, Das described overseas viewers seeking stories that reconnect them with their cultural roots. His account connects the search for an audience with the wish to hear familiar language and stories.[6] A different encounter appears in Madhushree Chakrabarty's December 2022 review of Abhishek Swain's anthology *Four*: she described following its stories as a non-Odia viewer.[7]

Language access matters too. Kanccha Lannka's App Store description advertises English subtitles for selected titles. "Selected" is significant: the availability of an app abroad does not mean every programme has subtitles or can be played in every territory.[8]

Subtitles can invite a viewer who does not know Odia into the story. They can also help a younger diaspora viewer follow a language heard at home. Careful translation, clear credits and reliable access can help that invitation reach more people.

Reach must become sustainable work

A catalogue needs more than an upload button. Das described the expense of maintaining the platform and producing content, alongside the difficulty of making potential viewers aware of a regional service.[3] For an Odia production, being discoverable is only one part of the business. Payment arrangements, rights, promotion and continued availability shape whether a release supports the next project.

A durable home for these stories must serve both sides of the screen: viewers able to find the work, and makers paid on terms that help them continue. The economics chapter follows that question from an audience's payment towards the next production.

Watch and explore

Check the provider's current catalogue, location and subscription terms.

- **Provider catalogue: AAO NXT.**

- **Provider app listing: Kanccha Lannka on the App Store.**

A story has found a way onto a screen. What returns to the people who made it?

A story reaches another viewer.

PART 7 · MAKING THE NEXT FILM POSSIBLE

47 Odia Cinema's Commercial Successes

Affection for a film can become a ticket bought, a book sought out, a new collaboration. Sustaining that possibility also requires money to return to the people doing the work. We close by asking how makers, audiences and public institutions can help a good beginning become continuing creative life.

Publicity image for Bou Buttu Bhuta. [8]

An Odia film reaching another city, a longer theatrical run, an audience for a literary adaptation: commercial success can take several visible forms. Behind each is a practical question. What does this run make possible for the people who made the film?

The comparison below gathers dated reports before following some of the films behind them. It is a selection, not a ranking of the highest earners.

Reported budgets and collections

These sources use different reporting windows and do not consistently define territory or accounting basis. **The figures are not audited or directly comparable, and none establishes producer profit.** "Not established" means the cited sources do not supply a usable budget, not that a film had no budget.

Film	ବଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ (Bou Buttu Bhuta)
Reported budget	₹2-3 crore
Reported collection	Nearly ₹21 crore
Report date	24 September 2025
Limits and source	TNIE; gross/net and territory unspecified.[1]

Film	Jadi
Reported budget	₹1.8-2 crore
Reported collection	Over ₹8 crore gross (reported)
Report date	22 October 2026
Limits and source	CineJosh; territory unspecified; indexed publisher text inspected.[2]

Film	ଦମନ (DAMaN)
Reported budget	Nearly ₹1 crore
Reported collection	₹7.5 crore, described as lifetime
Report date	Budget: 13 November 2022; collection: 23 June 2025
Limits and source	Separate TNIE/Pinkvilla reports; collection's gross/net and territory unspecified.[3, 4]

Film	କର୍ମ (Karma)
Reported budget	Not established
Reported collection	₹6.5 crore, described as lifetime
Report date	23 June 2025
Limits and source	Pinkvilla; gross/net and territory unspecified.[4]

Film	Pabaar
Reported budget	Not established
Reported collection	₹3.5 crore, described as lifetime
Report date	23 June 2025
Limits and source	Pinkvilla; gross/net and territory unspecified.[4]

Bou Buttu Bhuta: following a run through time

For ବଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ **(Bou Buttu Bhuta)**, The Federal reported almost **₹12 crore after 17 days**, against a **₹2-3 crore budget**, on 30 June 2025.[5] By 24 September, The New Indian Express reported nearly **₹21 crore** and a run of close to 50 days. Its account also described Dharma Productions as acquiring remake rights, with the process still under way.[1]

The film brought Aparajita Mohanty, Babushaan Mohanty and Archita Sahu together in a horror-comedy directed by Jagdish Mishra.[1] The two reported collections describe different stages of that run; they are not amounts to add together.

Remake interest raises a separate possibility. A story may have value to another producer beyond the tickets sold for its original release. But an acquisition being discussed is not the same as money received, and neither establishes that a remake was completed. For its makers, those possibilities extend the life of the work beyond its first audience.

DAMaN: success measured in reach

The November 2022 account of ଦମନ **(DAMaN)** records an opening in **51 Odisha theatres and 15 outside the state, across nine cities**, alongside packed shows. That contemporary report supplies no market-by-market receipts.[3]

Babushaan Mohanty and Dipanwit Dashmohapatra led a story about a doctor working in Malkangiri. The November report described audiences returning for a locally situated healthcare drama.[3] Its reception belongs beside the debate over whom the film represents and how, explored in the companion reading.

Pinkvilla's later lifetime estimate, listed above, adds a reported collection to this account of reach.[4] The DAMaN companion follows the film's making and representation; its commercial reception is one part of that wider story.

Karma: an opening and a longer run

କର୍ମ **(Karma)** had a reported **₹37.20 lakh opening day**, recalled in The New Indian Express's June 2025 coverage.[6]

Pinkvilla subsequently described a ₹6.5 crore lifetime collection.[4] Together with the opening-day report, it gives two dated points from which to follow the film's commercial run.

A strong opening can draw attention to a film and give exhibitors a reason to watch its next few days closely. Sustaining that encounter is the continuing challenge: making room in the schedule for people who hear about a film after its release weekend. The reported figures leave Karma's production costs and final settlement unresolved.

Ananta: literature finding a public

ଅନନ୍ତ **(Ananta)**, adapted from Fakir Mohan Senapati's story, shared the reported packed Raja shows; its collection was then unspecified.[6]

The Raja release starred Sabyasachi Mishra, distinct from filmmaker Sabyasachi Mohapatra.[6] A literary story was sharing the festive cinema calendar with a horror-comedy. Their simultaneous presence offers a more varied picture of audience choice than a single successful genre could provide.

The literature-to-cinema reading follows the choices behind such adaptations. A viewer drawn to *Ananta* may also become curious about Fakir Mohan's story; a reader may want to see what the film makes of it.

A growing list, with different kinds of evidence

Jadi extends the comparison into 2026. CineJosh's October report paired its budget and collection estimates with an announcement of a Telugu version; a release date for that version was still to be announced.[2] As with remake interest, this is a further commercial possibility, not evidence of receipts from the proposed version.

Pabaar's inclusion comes from the same Pinkvilla comparison that supplied the DAMaN and Karma lifetime figures.

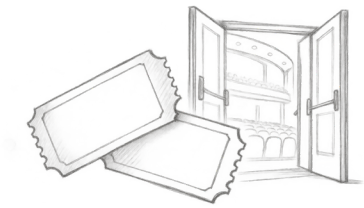
A budget-only report belongs beside this discussion, but outside the collection table. Odia Celebrity reported a roughly **₹10 crore budget for Landfall** on 30 June 2026, when it announced completion of shooting.[7] That is a reported investment, not evidence of release earnings or a verified highest-budget record.

A budget describes spending; box-office receipts describe ticket business; the producer's return depends on the amounts and terms that reach the production. Subtracting a headline budget from a headline collection does not establish profit. The economics reading explains these distinctions in more detail.

After the successful run

What success makes possible may become clearer only later: another film financed, a booking extended, a collaborator paid and able to continue. Those outcomes matter to the people whose work made the release possible.

The future of Odia cinema rests partly on that continuity. A successful run can open a possibility; the next working relationship determines what grows from it.



An audience for the next story.

PART 7 · MAKING THE NEXT FILM POSSIBLE

48 What Makes the Next Film Possible

Kalinga Studio at its redevelopment inauguration in October 2026. [10]

Speaking at the Odisha Literary Festival in 2024, Sabita Mohanty recalled funding as an obstacle and said Nirad Mohapatra sought a Rs 4 lakh loan from the National Film Development Corporation, repaying it gradually. Her recollection concerns the financing of the 1984 ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga). It does not establish its complete budget. The distinction matters: borrowed money can make production possible while also creating an obligation that survives the shoot. [1]

That obligation gives us a way to look at money across a film's life: first as the means to begin work, later as income to be shared and commitments still to be met. Comparing the loan with present-day

spending would require a full expenditure record and an account of changing prices.

From a ticket to the next production

For a recent commercial example, consider ବଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ (Bou Buttu Bhuta). On 30 June 2025, The Federal reported a production budget of Rs 2-3 crore and almost Rs 12 crore at the box office after 17 days. The Rs 12 crore figure is a receipt estimate, not a production budget.[2] The commercial-successes reading follows the differently dated reports of this and other films.

It helps to follow money through the work. **Finance** makes preparation and production possible: writing, casting, paid working days, equipment, editing and sound. **Release costs** support delivery and the effort to reach viewers. **Box-office receipts** record ticket business. The amount that reaches a producer then depends on the exhibition and distribution agreements, deductions and payment terms.

A film may also earn through separately agreed television, streaming or other rights. Those payments can arrive on different schedules. To understand what can support another production, the producer needs to bring the actual receipts together and set them against the full costs and obligations. The published Bou Buttu Bhuta reports do not supply that settlement, so they establish a reported hit rather than an audited profit.

A successful release can make a new project worth discussing. For the next team, the question becomes concrete: when will the money arrive, and what work can it pay for?

The audience needs a screen

For **Lokanath Das**, bringing a film to viewers could mean a boat journey. In a 2020 recollection, the retired Dhenkanal information and public relations employee described putting on village screenings between 1978 and 1995. The government mobile-cinema programme combined films with information documentaries. Among the films he remembered were ଅମଡ଼ା ବାଟ (Amada Bata) and ମାଟିର ମଣିଷ (Matira Manisha).[3]

A different route into organising appears in **Abhishek Parija's** account of the Film Society of Bhubaneswar. He joined its core team after submitting his own film to its festival. At Ravenshaw, he helped a junior and friends establish a film society. A July 2018 report records their screening of Spike Lee's *Do the Right Thing* on 18 July. Parija described screenings followed by conversation, with attention to a film's wider context.[4]

The Waterfall was made by Lipika Singh Darai for LXL Ideas' School Cinema. Shot around Khandadhar and the nearby forests of Sundergarh, it has English and Hindi versions.[5]

In a 2017 account, producer Syed Sultan Ahmed described choosing themes and selecting stories offered by independent filmmakers and scriptwriters. School Cinema describes screenings followed by discussion and workbook or digital activities, delivered by teachers with LXL training and support.[6] For an Odia counterpart, makers and education partners could agree on a story, its language, payment and screening terms before production begins.

Das's journeys, Parija's organising and the school programme bring me back to the question raised in my conversation with the *DAMaN* team: how does a good film reach people? Here are three specific routes. Transport, a venue, permission and working equipment still need to be arranged; so does the time of the people putting on the show. A public information programme, a film society, a school

programme and a commercial theatre must each find a way to meet those costs.

Support is more than a building

OFDC's stated objectives connect several parts of this chain: finance for films, assistance for rural and semi-urban cinemas, studio and processing facilities, and support for film societies. Its 1976 incorporation belongs to a longer history of public involvement than any single redevelopment. These stated purposes connect the making of films with the places and communities that can encounter them; individual assistance still needs to be established from disbursement records. [7]

The redevelopment of Kalinga Studio, inaugurated in October 2026, can be judged over time through access to facilities, actual bookings and the productions those facilities help complete. Alongside public provision, the India Cine Hub directory lists Bhubaneswar's Mute Studio as advertising post-production services. A production considering those advertised services would need to confirm rates, capacity and suitability for its work. [8, 9]

A digital release has costs too

Streaming changes the route to a viewer, but does not abolish the cost of reaching one. The OTT chapter follows the work of building platforms and catalogues. The economic question is what continuing arrangements these outlets can sustain with creators, as well as how many titles they carry.

The literature reading leaves the original author's compensation unresolved in the accounts examined there. That question belongs beside the producer's receipts and the crew's wages. For someone deciding whether they can commit to another work, a dependable payment matters more than a headline collection.

PART 7 · MAKING THE NEXT FILM POSSIBLE

49 Beyond One Successful Film: Building Odia Cinema Together

A visitor photographs film posters at BYOFF in Puri. [16]

I began this journey wanting literature to reach more people and more of its value to return to writers. The films and lives in these pages have widened that question. A script needs time; a finished film needs a screen; a copy kept for decades may need restoration before anyone can see it again.

The return of *Maya Miriga*, the working lives recalled here and the films that found new audiences give us specific achievements to build on. The question about source authors' compensation remains open in the records we examined. I want it to stay part of the conversation, alongside the practical work of making and showing the next film.

Start with people and the work

Quality cannot be reduced to a prize, a production budget or one preferred genre. A comedy, a thriller, a children's film and a formally adventurous drama can each be made with care. For a production team, useful questions are concrete: does the screenplay earn its turns, can we hear the dialogue, does the performance fit the scene, and does the finished film reach the audience it was made for?

The series already contains histories of initiative. Gour Prasad Ghose brought collaborators into productions; Parbati Ghose carried literary material into film; Nirad Mohapatra worked through teaching and film societies. These examples offer different starting points. Each joins individual initiative to a wider circle of collaborators, learners and viewers.

Before the camera begins

A producer and writer can agree on the script stages, feedback process, payment schedule, adaptation rights and credits before a shoot is announced. Rehearsal, location research and conversations with people whose lives inform the story belong in preparation. Using a person's private experience calls for their informed agreement, as well as attentive listening.

There are existing Indian models to learn from. NFDC's Screenwriters' Lab describes mentorship, screenplay development and preparation to pitch to producers and investors. Its Work-in-Progress Lab brings directors and editors into discussion of a rough cut with advisers.[1, 2] An Odia initiative could adapt that attention to writing and editing at a scale it can sustain; each participating team would still need to develop its own work and release plan.

Books can enter a film conversation before a screenplay exists. NFDC's 2022 Book to Box Office brought publishers, agencies and authors before prospective buyers and producers. MAMI's 2024 Word to Screen rules described open pitches and one-to-one meetings with

rights-holders, without guaranteeing a deal.[3] These public and industry initiatives offer complementary examples for an Odia gathering: readers and translators could help introduce books, while authors and relevant rights-holders or their authorised representatives meet filmmakers. An introduction would leave the participants to decide what to develop together, with recognition and terms for the source author distinct from the screenwriter's and translator's contributions.

An early-career assistant needs someone to learn from, a real role and compensation. A production might need an experienced sound practitioner, an editor willing to discuss a rough cut, or paid time to rehearse. Support becomes useful when it meets the particular work in front of the team.

Build with the people already beside us

Co-creation can begin before anyone knows the finished film. A writer brings a story; a director brings experience of performance; another person knows a place well enough to question how it is being represented. What they choose to make may change as they listen to one another.

Saras Sarasvathy's five principles of *effectuation* offer a way to think about such beginnings.[4] **Bird in Hand** begins with available knowledge, skills and relationships. For a film, that might mean a story its author is willing to discuss, rather than a distant idea waiting for unlimited resources. **Affordable Loss** asks what each participant can afford to lose while exploring it. Someone else's unpaid labour cannot simply be counted as our affordable risk.

With **Crazy Quilt**, partners contribute something real and help shape the undertaking: a producer might fund development, a theatre group offer agreed rehearsal space, a film society arrange a licensed screening. **Lemonade** leaves room to use a surprise - a response at a reading might suggest a form or an audience the makers had not considered. **Pilot in the Plane** places attention on choices people can

make together, while recognising that they cannot command the market or a viewer's response.

These are possibilities for working with uncertainty, not a recipe for a hit or a description of how every filmmaker in this book worked. Their value here is in the invitation to begin thoughtfully, share responsibility and let new commitments change what becomes possible.

The voices already around us

A film can begin with a remembered voice. In ନାନୀ ମା (Nani Ma, 2022), filmmaker and language archivist Subhashish Panigrahi records the songs and stories of his grandmother, Musamoni Panigrahi, in Balasore. His English-language documentary *The Volunteer Archivists* (2022) follows Srujanika's work preserving Odia publications, bringing the labour of Nikhil Mohan Pattnaik, Puspashree Pattnaik and their colleagues into view. Padmaja Sahoo's part in proofreading, editing and compilation reminds us that an archive grows through patient work on individual pages.[5] Spoken memory and printed literature offer different beginnings for a film; both give us people whose work we can follow.

Another connection leads back to Prahallada Nataka. In 2018, Prateek Pattanaik documented performances with photographer Debendra Pattanayak and theatre artist Arjun Samantaray. Prateek credits Subhashish with lending a camera and advising on videography and production; community contributions helped fund the work.[6] A camera, a performer, someone who knows the tradition, and people willing to help: this is one concrete way shared care can take shape.

The collaborations extend into other films. O Foundation's 2021 treatment credits Prateek as co-cinematographer of *Remosam*.[7] The released trailer of Shankhajeet De's *Ramaleelas of Odisha* credits Prateek and Puloma Pal for additional script, research and subtitles.[8]

For a new collaboration, the invitation could be to listen first - to a remembered song, a living performance or the people caring for books. Agree with participants how their voices will be recorded, credited and shared. Their knowledge can help shape what the film becomes.

A public foundation people can use

Odisha's **2019 State Film Policy** set out support for film production, shooting permissions, cinemas and film infrastructure. Its official policy page also links training and scholarship guidelines.[9] The framework is a starting point for examining public support, not proof that a particular incentive is currently open or that announced benefits were paid.

A useful next step would be a clear public service record: which schemes are operative, who can apply, what documents are needed, how long decisions take, and the sums actually disbursed. Applicants should be able to distinguish a sanction from a payment and a policy intention from an available service. Existing rules and eligibility would need checking before any producer budgets for assistance.

Public support could help where a small production struggles to act alone. A modest development fund could support research, writing, translation and rehearsal through published criteria and independent selection. A separate finishing fund could help promising films complete sound, colour, subtitles and delivery materials. Clear selection, declared conflicts of interest and an account of the work supported would give people a basis for trust. These are proposals, not newly announced schemes.

Studios and shared facilities should be judged through usable access: clear rates, functioning equipment, booking availability, trained personnel and completed productions. The economics chapter places Kalinga Studio and private services in that history. New buildings matter when people can afford and reliably use them.

Public support should also preserve variety. A film need not serve as a tourism advertisement to contribute to cultural life. Small-language audiences, children, documentary work and less commercially obvious subjects deserve consideration alongside productions with larger markets. At the same time, public funding needs transparent limits and evidence of what it accomplishes.

Let a success help the work continue

The commercial-successes reading gives us achievements to examine; the economics reading asks what returns after the costs and contractual deductions. A headline collection cannot answer that second question on its own.

A producer who knows what has actually returned can decide what to undertake next. Sharing comparable, consented figures through an industry body could help others plan, while protecting commercially sensitive details. A prospective streaming sale still needs an agreement; a promise of income cannot pay a crew.

Reinvestment remains a choice. A profitable film might help pay for another script, an apprenticeship or a smaller production. Agreed wages and clear terms give people a basis for taking part. Those involved could also choose to share how the collaboration developed - what helped a script take shape, or gave a newcomer useful experience - without disclosing private financial details.

Reach audiences beyond Odisha without leaving Odisha behind

Plan translation and access while the film is being made. Good subtitles need editing, contextual judgement and testing with viewers who do not know the language. Translation subtitles, captions for deaf and hard-of-hearing viewers, and audio description serve different purposes. India's Ministry of Information and Broadcasting issued OTT accessibility guidelines in February 2026 with an implementation schedule; producers and distributors need to check the applicable requirements.[10]

A release plan could then identify separate routes: cinemas within Odisha, selected cities elsewhere in India, licensed diaspora screenings, festivals, television and streaming. Each needs its own rights, delivery materials, publicity and realistic cost. A festival encounter can begin a distribution conversation. A licensed screening abroad can help a team learn about a particular audience. Sales and further bookings would then need to be secured on their own terms.

A few well-supported screenings with local partners could help filmmakers meet viewers beyond familiar audiences. Conversations afterwards may reveal how people found the film, whether the subtitles carried its meaning, and whether they would welcome another screening. The costs and receipts matter too: reaching people should leave the team able to consider what comes next.

Preserve the film while planning its release: retain masters, sound elements, subtitles, credits, stills and the rights information needed for future use. The Maya Miriga chapter shows why a film's later life belongs in its history too.

A connection Return to Maya Miriga: a restored film meets another audience. Keeping a finished work available belongs beside making something new.

What audiences and communities can do

People can choose authorised screenings and services, recommend a film with a useful description, and pay for work they want to see continue. They can also offer specific criticism. Thoughtful disagreement belongs in that support: it gives filmmakers a clearer account of what moved, puzzled or disappointed a viewer.

Colleges, libraries, cultural groups and diaspora associations could organise licensed screenings followed by discussion. NFAI's Film Distribution Library provides an existing institutional model for educational and film-society access, with borrowing conditions that vary by title.[11] A local programme would still need to establish which films are available and secure the relevant screening permissions.

At the 2023 Dhwani festival in Bhubaneswar, people with disabilities joined other viewers for screenings and discussion. Its rules required English subtitles and provided for half of any prize money to go to a disabled performer playing the main role.[12]

In Puri, the Bring Your Own Film Festival (BYOFF) gave filmmakers another place to meet an audience. A 2005 report described a gathering without a selection process, jury or awards: Sammit Das's short *At the Midnight Hour* had screened the previous year, and Pankaj Advani contributed to the festival fund. In 2015, its organisers described meeting costs through registrations, crowdfunding and state or corporate sponsorship.[13] Showing a film and helping sustain a place to see it are different contributions to the same encounter.

Children can also help make the films a community gathers to watch. In 2022, students from schools in Balangir, Rayagada and Jajpur joined

Kallola filmmaking workshops. Aaina's report records around 47 participants working in groups to produce nine short films about climate change, presented in Bhubaneswar that November through its partnership with UNICEF.[14] The example opens another question: what stories might children choose to tell about the places they know?

A children's or family screening could let younger viewers encounter Odia as a language of imagination. Beside an adaptation, there could be a book to borrow, a passage to hear, an author or translator to discover. A film audience may include the next reader. Making that encounter welcoming is something a library, a film club or a group of families could try.

At a screening, the conversation could include the writer behind the story or the weaver whose cloth appears on screen. Invite them to speak about their choices, agree on payment, and help viewers find their work afterwards. A name in the credits could become a book to read, a textile to seek out, a person whose work we follow. We can give our affection for Odisha this practical form: helping its makers be seen and heard.

Begin with the next encounter

"ଏକା ହାତରେ ତାଳି ବାଜେ ନାହିଁ" - one hand cannot clap.[15]

The saying offers a way to think about the relationship between a maker and an audience. A story needs someone willing to tell it and someone willing to give it attention. Around that encounter stand the people who write, perform, record, edit, translate and arrange a screening.

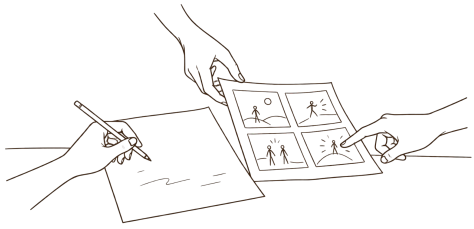
For the maker, give a story time to develop, and plan to pay the people who help tell it. For the viewer, give the work a fair encounter: watch, question, recommend, return. A film that stays with us may send us towards a book, a voice or a life we had scarcely noticed.

The restored *Maya Miriga* reached another audience because people carried the work forward. A story can remain close to home and still

welcome someone from far away. Its language, its humour, the particular lives and places within it can become reasons to enter.

We need not know in advance which film will travel furthest. We can choose the care with which we make it, the fairness with which we work, and the welcome we extend to an audience. The next beginning may be a comedy, a searching independent film, a child's adventure - or a few pages someone has quietly been writing.

There is room at this table. What story will we help one another bring to the screen?



Companion survey: the wider screen

The detailed survey continues here. Its numbered sources belong to Chapter 16.

Before the camera: Natak, Rasa and Gitinatya

Sita Bibah had a life before the camera. A later report by Minati Singha identifies a play by Kamapal Mishra as the basis of *Sita Bibah*.[2] Piyush Roy's research describes Goswami's touring rasalila group and his work training performers. In an interview recorded by Roy, film historian Surya Deo characterises the first film as primarily *gitinatya*, or musical drama.[3]

Goswami brought experience of performing, singing and organising a troupe to filmmaking. A familiar dramatic story could now be carried by recorded voices and moving images.

Gitinatya joins dramatic storytelling with music and verse. Theatre scholar Alok Baral places Kalicharan Pattanaik among its practitioners.[4] Kalicharan also wrote lyrics for *Lalita*, according to Bhuyan's retrospective.[5] A *Lalita* credit card reproduced in Roy's thesis also names Kalicharan for story, dialogue and direction.[3]

The prospectus of Orissa Theatres Limited proposed bringing Odia plays, novels and stories to the screen. It named Kalicharan Pattnaik as officer in charge of production and Kalindi Charan Panigrahi among its honorary literary advisers. The plans reached beyond making films: a studio, touring cinemas and training for artists and technicians were also proposed.[6]

The wider performance world deserves its own attention. Our guides to Prahallad Nataka, Pala and Daskathia explore different ways of singing, narrating and enacting a story. They introduce cinema's

neighbours, while Goswami's own Rasa and theatre background supplies the documented connection to this first production.

Radio drama: another home for the storyteller

Radio enters this account later. AIR Cuttack began in **1948**, twelve years after the first Odia feature. The Odia Bibhaba archive records Gopal Chhotray's association with the station from its beginning.[7] Its writers joined a film culture already underway.

Chhotray is a concrete link between the media. The Library of Congress documents his work in Gitinatya, his long association with AIR Cuttack, and his writing of plays, operas and screenplays.[8] The Gour-Parbati archive credits him specifically with **dialogue for** ଶ୍ରୀଜଗନ୍ନାଥ ***(Sri Jagannath)*** **(1950)**, while assigning direction and screenplay to C.R. Mitra.[9]

Chhotray worked between the stage, the microphone and film production. Dialogue was part of what he carried between them.

Continue this history: ଆକାଶବାଣୀ କଟକ - AIR Cuttack: where stories found another voice.

The people who built more than a screen career

Parbati Ghose belongs near the centre of this history. The Gour-Parbati filmography records her as a co-producer with Gour Prasad Ghose on ଲକ୍ଷ୍ମୀ *(Laxmi)*, କା *(Kaa)* and ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ *(Stree)*. It also credits her within the directing partnership used on *Kaa* and *Stree*. Her work crossed the boundaries between performing, organising a production and deciding what would reach the screen.[10]

The archive dates her ଛ' ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ *(Chha Mana Atha Guntha)* adaptation to 1986. Its credits name **Nagen Barik** for sound and **Asim Basu and Sarat Sahoo** for art, and acknowledge Olosingh's villagers and host **Kalyani Patnaik**.[11] The Parbati Ghose companion follows her producing, writing, directing and acting work.

The places and teams that sustain production

Institutions mattered too. The Odisha Film Development Corporation was incorporated on **22 April 1976**. Its stated remit included support for film production, cinema houses, studio services and film culture. These are the less visible foundations: access to equipment, places to finish a film, and places where audiences can watch it.[12]

The *Chha Mana Atha Guntha* archive names **Kalinga Studio** and **Prasad Film Laboratory** among its credits, while stating that the shoot took place entirely in Olosingh. The credits do not specify which services those facilities supplied.[11]

Private facilities form another part of this infrastructure. India Cine Hub lists Mute Entertainment's Mute Studio in Bhubaneswar under post-production companies, advertising editing, visual effects, chroma services, colour grading, and sound design and mixing.[13]

Technology also appears in performers' memories. Uttam Mohanty contrasted reflector-lit shoots earlier in his career with later low-light work, in a 2018 interview.[14]

Public infrastructure has its own chain of responsibility. **Naveen Patnaik** laid the rebuilding foundation stone for Kalinga Studio on **25 March 2021**; the Industries Department assigned implementation to **IDCO** and existing-building renovation to the **R&B Department**.[15] **Mohan Charan Majhi** inaugurated the redeveloped studio and its cinema archive and museum on **5 October 2026**. The recorded events concern redevelopment; they do not establish its commercial outcomes.[16]

A script also needs people who can turn it into images, edited sequences and sound. In Cuttack, **Biju Pattanaik Film and Television Institute of Odisha (BPFTIO)** offers a four-year degree in Cinematic Art and Technology (B.CAT), with streams in cinematography, film editing, and sound recording and sound design. Its admission page directs applicants to OJEE for entrance and counselling information.[17]

A film culture needs places to learn and people willing to organise a screening. **Nirad Mohapatra's** memorial biography records his teaching at FTII and his work with **Cinexstasy**, a Bhubaneswar film society active from 1974 to 1983. Screenings and film-appreciation courses were another part of his contribution, beyond directing *Maya Miriga*.[18]

Maya Miriga and other films in circulation

Maya Miriga received Second Best Feature Film at the 31st National Film Awards, for films of 1983; festival records commonly date it to 1984.[19] In 1984 it was selected for Cannes Critics' Week and shared Mannheim's Grand Prize in the Third World competition, distinct from that festival's overall Grand Prize.[20, 21] The Maya Miriga companion follows both its family story and its restoration.

Manmohan Mahapatra offers another essential route into this period. ଶୀତରାତି *(Seeta Raati)* received the Best Oriya Film honour at the 29th National Film Awards, for the 1981 award year. The festival catalogue for 1985 also records screenings in Paris and Montreal.[22]

In his account of Odisha's New Wave, critic Ashok Palit describes the social worlds of Mahapatra's films: a rural community facing upheaval in ନୀରବ ଝଡ଼ *(Niraba Jhada)*, and a family negotiating social change in ନିଷିଦ୍ଧ ସ୍ୱପ୍ନ *(Nisiddha Swapna)*. His survey places Mahapatra and Nirad Mohapatra among the filmmakers who developed a sustained interest in cinema as an art of close observation.[23]

These films brought close observation of households and communities into national and international circulation. Their companion essays return to the particular relationships and choices within those worlds.

Bhukha, and the importance of hearing western Odisha

Sabyasachi Mohapatra's ଭୁଖା *(Bhukha)* (**1989**) makes the map of cinema in Odisha more expansive. It is a **Sambalpuri-language film**. Palit reads its conflict through the pressures between inherited ways of life and modernity.[23]

The story grew from a Sambalpuri play by Manglu Charan Biswal. It follows bajnia folk drummers whose livelihoods are threatened by changing musical practices. The stakes are both cultural and material: what happens to the people who carry a tradition when their work is no longer wanted?[24]

Naming the language matters. The cinema of a state can contain several cultural centres, accents and storytelling traditions. Sambalpuri cinema deserves to be heard in its own voice within this larger history.

The Bhukha chapter follows the film's circulation as well as the livelihoods within its story.

Mohapatra's later work offers further, separately documented milestones. ଶଳାବୁଢ଼ା *(Sala Budha)* was selected for Indian Panorama in 2013. ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର *(Aadim Vichar)* received the Best Odiya Film award at the 62nd National Film Awards, for 2014, announced in 2015.[25, 26]

Scholar Amrit Amlan Pattanaik approaches these Sambalpuri films through western Odisha's cultural and literary worlds, asking how they widen the ways Odisha appears on screen. His study's published abstract offers a valuable starting question for a deeper article: what becomes visible when we stop treating a region as if it has only one centre?[27]

Documentary and the memory of home

Documentary offers another way to stay with a place as it changes. *The Sea and Seven Villages*, directed by **Himansu Sekhar Khatua** and produced by **Iti Samanta**, follows displaced coastal communities from Satabhaya in Kendrapara.[28]

Khatua recalls meeting families resettled at Bagapatia, then visiting the coastal villages they had left. He describes filming waves damaging a temple; his later footage, he says, showed its ruins.[29] His recollection brings the memory of home beside the physical changes to a place.

The Odia documentary received a **Special Mention** in the non-feature section of the **71st National Film Awards**, for **2023**, announced in **2025**.[30]

In *Mo Bou, Mo Gaan (My Mother, My Village)*, **Subash Sahoo** turns towards his mother, **Seba Bou**, whose teaching of young women included *Kandana*.[31]

Sahoo describes a project made over eighteen years, fitted around his professional sound work. A few days of filming could be followed by months away; the village changed between visits. The team took reference photographs to maintain visual consistency when shooting resumed. He also credits his wife, **Suprava Sahoo**, who produced the documentary and supported its long making.[32] **Suvir Nath** worked as editor and co-producer; Sahoo has thanked him for helping bring the film to completion.[33]

The film shared **Best Biographical / Historical Reconstruction / Compilation Film** at the same National Film Awards.[30]

Lipika Singh Darai's work with puppeteers opens another documentary journey through the series.

Children, imagination and the screen

Children belong in this history as viewers with imaginative lives of their own. Live-action films made for children, local animation and films offered in an Odia-language version open different routes to those viewers. The birthday-party question in the author's introduction returns here: what Odia characters might children want to spend time with?

Sadhu Meher's ବାବୁଲା (Babula) provides a concrete starting point for the first history. A Lok Sabha answer of 7 December 1987 lists it among the Children's Film Society of India's productions for 1985-86, identifying it as an Oriya feature. A contemporary 1986 catalogue from Berlin's Arsenal describes Meher's CFSI-supported film through a lonely boy's dreams of outer space. This places institutional support and a child's imagination within the same account. [34, 35]

A. K. Bir's ଲାବଣ୍ୟ ପ୍ରୀତି (Lavanya Preeti) received Best Children's Film for 1993. Its dedicated page follows young characters into the imaginative world of an inherited story.[36]

For କୁନି ଗଣେଶ (Kuni Ganesha), **Shreyas Sahil**, then a Class IV pupil, supplied the character's voice. **Jyotiranjan Swain** wrote and directed the series, with music by **Rajesh Shankar**. It was prepared for a planned Doordarshan broadcast.[37] A child was helping make the character speak. The television reading follows this animation work further.

Children can also encounter films through Odia-language versions. CBFC's 2022 list records an Odia video version of ରିଟର୍ଣ୍ଣ ଅଫ୍ ହନୁମାନ (Return of Hanuman), certified on 11 February 2022 and naming Shemaroo Entertainment. Airtel Xstream lists the Anurag Kashyap film as a 2007 animation title available in Odia. This is a route to a dubbed film, distinct from an original Odia production; current access depends on the provider.[38, 39]

A character can invite another encounter: with a story, a book or the people who made it. We could give children room to follow those connections, while making clear credits and paid creative work part of the care behind their screens.

The people audiences returned to

The history of a film culture also lives in the performers people recognise across different stories. A leading role, a comic interruption, a supporting character or a song can give an audience someone to return to. These careers connect that affection to less visible work: rehearsal, teaching, choreography, producing and helping another performer find her place.

Bijay Mohanty: performance and teaching

Bijay Mohanty carried theatre training into films and into the classroom. A National School of Drama graduate, he worked in the drama department of Utkal Sangeet Mahavidyalaya and retired as a professor. His screen career includes ଚିଲିକା ଟୀରେ *(Chilika Tire)*, ନାଗଫାଣ *(Nagaphasa)* and ଚକା ଭଉଁରୀ *(Chaka Bhaunri)*.[40]

The theatre connection remained part of how colleagues remembered him. Director Manoj Pattanaik recalled his play *Amari Bhagaban*, staged by Manan Natya Sangstha.[41] The classroom and the theatre group were part of the work he passed on.

Uttam Mohanty: a remembered encounter

Uttam Mohanty's ଅଭିମାନ *(Abhiman)* debut connects his story to Sadhu Meher, its director. In a 2018 interview, he recalled a Bengali viewer in Cuttack praising his portrayal of Salabega. The memory gives one audience encounter a place beside the career record.[14]

Akashvani records his work in Bengali cinema and the Hindi film ନୟା ଜହର *(Naya Zahar)* alongside his Odia career.[42] His recollection of

reflector-lit shoots also brings an actor's experience into the changing conditions of filmmaking.

Aparajita Mohanty: acting, producing and learning from another woman

Aparajita Mohanty's work offers several points of entry. ଉଦଣ୍ଡୀ ସୀତା *(Udandi Sita)* is among the films associated with her screen career.[43] She produced *Love Master*.[44]

Her remembrance of Anita Das opens another relationship. Aparajita described the senior actor as an elder-sister figure who taught her about acting and the workings of the industry.[45] Her later appearance in ବୋଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ *(Bou Buttu Bhuta)* brings that working life into the recent films discussed later in this survey.[46]

Performers and the company around a film

Leading roles are only one part of what audiences remember. The following selection brings other kinds of contribution into view; it is a set of routes for further watching and reading, not an order of importance.

Performer	Mahasweta Ray and Prasanta Nanda
A contribution to follow	Nanda cast her as Manika in ଶେଷ ଶ୍ରାବଣ *(Sesa Srabana)*; she recalled viewers calling her by that character's name after a screening.[47]

Performer	Sarat Pujari
A contribution to follow	He plays Mangaraj in Parbati Ghose's ଛ' ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ *(Chha Mana Atha Guntha)*, bringing Fakir Mohan's landowner to the screen.[11]

Performer	Siddhanta Mahapatra
A contribution to follow	His films include *Suna Panjuri*.[48]

Performer	Mihir Das
A contribution to follow	His career moved among leading, supporting, villainous and comic parts: different kinds of presence within an ensemble.[49]

Performer	Jayiram Samal (Jayee)
A contribution to follow	His account of the mischievous priest in ଯାଯାବର *(Jajabara)*, and work across film, television and stage, places comedy within a sustained performing life.[50]

Performer	Shyamalendu Bhattacharya and Nari
A contribution to follow	Shyamalendu recalled forming a melody group with Nari and moving between performance and choreography, including ଯାଯାବର *(Jajabara)*. The partnership joins music, stage work and screen comedy.[51]

Performer	Anita Das
A contribution to follow	Lead and later supporting roles belong together in her career; Aparajita's testimony also records her contribution as a mentor.[45]

The songs people carried home

A film's life need not end when the screen goes dark. A voice, a phrase or a melody can travel into another room and another generation. Following those songs brings composers, lyricists and playback singers into the centre of this story.

The credits of ଶ୍ରୀ ଜଗନ୍ନାଥ *(Sri Jagannath, 1950)* name **Balakrushna Das and Ranjit Roy** as music directors, with **Kalyani Das, Chhabi Ray and Suryamoni Dei** among the singers. Cinema was already a meeting place for many voices.[52] **Shantanu Mohapatra** later composed Lata Mangeshkar's songs for ସୂର୍ଯ୍ୟମୁଖୀ *(Suryamukhi)* and ଅରୁନ୍ଧତୀ *(Arundhati)*. His son Koushik remembers a young composer approaching her, and

producer Dhiren Patnaik backing the later collaboration. Such journeys began with someone making a connection and someone else making room for it.[53]

Akshaya Mohanty belongs here as a composer, singer and producer. When ମଲାଜହ୍ନ *(Malajanha)* returned for a Film Journalists' Forum screening, actress **Jharana Das**, singer Pranab Patnaik, lyricist **Binodini Debi** and the filmmakers' families were part of the occasion. A literary adaptation had gathered actors, words and music; its return gathered people again.[54]

There is a smaller, telling story inside Prafulla Kar and **Chitta Jena's** collaboration. Film historian Surya Deo recalled that Jena wanted a solo and initially resisted another duet for ମମତା *(Mamata)*. Actor **Dhira Biswal** persuaded him to sing it with **P. Susheela**. Kar later remembered Jena as a close friend whose voice gave him room to experiment. A song's making could depend on that mixture of ambition, persuasion and trust.[55]

Other voices deserve their own listening paths. **Bhubaneswari Mishra's** “Tiki Mora Naa Ti” in କୃଷ୍ଣ ସୁଦାମା *(Krushna Sudama)* is one such doorway.[56] Pranab Patnaik's account of his long friendship and stage work with Prafulla Kar offers another.[57] These are starting points for a wider account of the singers, lyricists, arrangers and instrumentalists behind the songs.

The question of writers' livelihoods returns here. A poem can become a lyric; a lyric needs a composer and a voice. Following that shared work also means asking how its authors are credited, paid and remembered. The Songs We Carry Home follows these connections through fifteen musicians, with dedicated stories of Akshaya Mohanty, Prafulla Kar, Pranab Patnaik and Tapu Mishra.

Actors whose journeys crossed languages

For performers, the path beyond Odisha sometimes ran through films made in other languages.

Sadhu Meher received the National Film Award for Best Actor for his performance in Shyam Benegal's Hindi film ଅଙ୍କୁର *(Ankur)*, honoured at the 22nd awards for 1974. The official catalogue records his upbringing in Odisha and his training at the Film and Television Institute in Pune. This is a major achievement by an actor from Odisha, within the history of Hindi cinema.[58]

Nandita Das carries a different connection. In her own essay about belonging, she recalls her father's Baripada roots and her childhood visits. She was born in Bombay and grew up in Delhi. Her Odisha relationship is one of family and experience, rather than an Odisha birthplace.[59]

Her connection also includes acting in Odia: she appeared in Susant Misra's ବିଶ୍ୱପ୍ରକାଶ **(Biswaprakash / The Young Rebel, 1999)**, listed in her official filmography. The Nandita Das article explores that credit alongside her wider career.[60]

Cannes records her membership of its feature-film jury in **2005** and its Cinéfondation and short-film jury in **2013**. Her film ମଣ্ଟୋ *(Manto)* was selected for Un Certain Regard in **2018**. These occasions mark both jury service and film selection across her career in acting and directing.[61]

A festival history and a history of popular affection answer different questions. We need both to understand what a film culture means to the people who sustain it.

National and international recognition

An award can bring a film to someone who has never heard its language. It can also lead that viewer back to the people who made it. The selected milestones below gather recognition discussed in this series; they are a reading guide, not a complete census of Odia film awards.

National Film Awards

Award years identify the films considered by that edition and can differ from theatrical release or announcement dates. The final column opens a route into the filmmakers' work; it is not a full list of award recipients.

Film	ଶୀତରାତି (Seeta Raati)
Recognition	Best Oriya Film[22]
Award year and edition	1981 · 29th awards
Filmmakers to explore	Manmohan Mahapatra

Film	ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga)
Recognition	Second Best Feature Film[19]
Award year and edition	1983 · 31st awards
Filmmakers to explore	Nirad Mohapatra

Film	ତାରା (Tara)
Recognition	Best Feature Film in Oriya[62]
Award year and edition	1991 · 39th awards
Filmmakers to explore	Bijaya Jena, producer and director

Film	ଲାବଣ୍ୟ ପ୍ରୀତି (Lavanya Preeti)
Recognition	Best Children's Film[36]
Award year and edition	1993 · 41st awards
Filmmakers to explore	A. K. Bir

Film	ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର (Aadim Vichar)
Recognition	Best Odiya Film[26]
Award year and edition	2014 · 62nd awards
Filmmakers to explore	Sabyasachi Mohapatra

Film	ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା (Pratikshya)
Recognition	Best Odia Film[63]
Award year and edition	2021 · 69th awards; announced 2023
Filmmakers to explore	Anupam Patnaik

Film	ଦମନ (DAMaN)
Recognition	Best Odia Film[64]
Award year and edition	2022 · 70th awards; announced 2024
Filmmakers to explore	Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka

Film	ପୁଷ୍କରା (Pushkara)
Recognition	Best Odia Film[30]
Award year and edition	2023 · 71st awards; announced 2025
Filmmakers to explore	Subhransu Das; producer Tarang Cine Productions

Film	ଲହରୀ (Lahari)
Recognition	Best Odia Film[65]
Award year and edition	2024 · 72nd awards; announced 2026
Filmmakers to explore	Amartya Bhattacharyya; producer Jhilik Motion Pictures

Recognition also follows people across languages. Sadhu Meher received Best Actor for ଅଙ୍କୁର *(Ankur)* at the 22nd awards for 1974. His achievement belongs here as an actor from Odisha working in a Hindi film.[58]

International prizes and festival journeys

An international prize: *Maya Miriga* shared the **Grand Prize of the Third World competition at Mannheim in 1984**. The festival archive lists it alongside *Leila et les loups*. This was a distinct competition prize, not Mannheim's overall Grand Prize.[21]

A Sambalpuri film abroad: the Bhukha reading follows the record of its international recognition.

A festival selection: *Maya Miriga* was also selected for **Cannes Critics' Week in 1984**. Selection brought the film before another audience; it is not a Cannes prize.[20]

Jury service and wider careers: Cannes records Nandita Das as a jury member in 2005 and 2013, and *Manto* in Un Certain Regard in 2018. These are jury appointments and a selection across her wider career, rather than awards for Odia-language films.[61]

Surya Deo also served on the East regional panel of the feature-film jury for the **72nd National Film Awards**, covering films of **2024** and announced in **July 2026**.[66]

The newer ମାଲିପୁଟ *(Maliput Melodies)* was screened in **Indian Panorama at IFFI 2025**. That documented festival appearance opens a contemporary thread below; it is kept distinct from the prize record.[67]

A new search for stories

A film can leave something behind after its run: a new collaborator, an audience willing to try another story, or the confidence to begin a difficult script. ଦମନ *(DAMaN)* and ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା *(Pratikshya)* offer two recent starting points for that conversation. Their subjects are different - healthcare in a difficult landscape, and the pressures inside a household - but both give recognisably local lives room on the screen.

We place them together here as an invitation to follow the next chapter of Odia filmmaking. The foundations reach back through the earlier films in this series. What these recent works add is a fresh reason to ask which stories, collaborators and audiences might come together next.

The Pratikshya companion follows the collaboration behind the film, from Gourahari Das's source story to Dipanwit Dashmohapatra's first leading role.[68]

Babushaan Mohanty offers another route into the period through ଦମନ (DAMaN). Our companion article follows the film's making, its fictional doctor and the wider healthcare work behind its subject. These films invite us to follow performers and collaborators as well as prizes: who receives a substantial role, whose writing reaches the screen, and which stories find a larger audience?

The range also includes କର୍ମ **(Karma, 2024)**. Anupam Patnaik directed **Anubhav Mohanty** as investigator Amar Patnaik in a murder-case thriller. The filmmaker behind *Pratikshya* was working with a different star and dramatic form; contemporary Odia cinema cannot be reduced to a single kind of revival.[69]

Recent releases and the work of reaching audiences

A film culture also depends on tickets sold and the chance to finance the next production. In 2025, ବଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ **(Bou Buttu Bhuta)** supplied a conspicuous commercial story. Directed by **Jagdish Mishra**, the horror-comedy brought **Aparajita Mohanty, Babushaan Mohanty and Archita Sahu** together in leading roles. On 24 September 2025, *The New Indian Express* reported box-office revenue of nearly **₹21 crore**, against a reported budget of **₹2-3 crore**. These are reported figures, not audited accounts or a calculation of producer profit.[46]

The same report described Dharma Productions as being **in the process of acquiring remake rights**. That was a commercial development reported at the time, not evidence of a completed remake. It suggests another way an Odia story can travel: through interest in adapting it for other audiences.[46]

Commercial momentum has a setting as well as a number. During Raja in June 2025, *The New Indian Express* reported packed shows for *Bou Buttu Bhuta* and ଅନନ୍ତ **(Ananta)**. The latter starred **Sabyasachi Mishra** and was directed by **Sabyasachi Mohapatra**, drawing on Fakir Mohan Senapati's *Randi Pua Ananta*. Literature and popular exhibition were meeting again.[70]

Yet distributor **Prashant B**, quoted in that report, said a shortage of cinema halls left some areas unreached. The point matters: a successful run in available theatres does not mean everyone has access to the film. The commercial story includes the work of exhibitors and distributors, ticket affordability, and the distance between a willing viewer and a screen.[70]

These recent films extend several parts of the history at once: literary adaptation, substantial acting roles, genre entertainment and the search for a sustainable audience. A national award, a busy screening and a remake negotiation each tell us something different. Taken together, they give a fuller picture of the work still being made.

New stories to follow

Hope becomes more tangible when we can name a film, the people behind it and the possibility it opens. These examples invite further viewing and discussion across different kinds of storytelling.

ବଡ ବଧୂ (Bara Badhu): work, friendship and dignity

Bara Badhu brings the search for a livelihood into a story of relationships. CBFC's synopsis describes unemployed Biju entering a marriage arrangement with Suman, with consequences for love and loyalty. The record credits **Biswaranjan Pradhan** with direction, story, screenplay and dialogue, and **Chandra Mani / Useful Garbage Creations** with production. BookMyShow lists its release on **13 February 2026**.[71, 72]

The ensemble includes **Sailendra Samantaray, Sivani Sangita, Suryamayee Mohapatra and Subasis Sharma**. **Bijitesh De's cinematography** and **Deepika Kalara's editing** are also part of the work behind the relationships on screen.[72, 71]

The premise gives it a place beside *Pratikshya*: economic insecurity enters intimate life, and a decision about work becomes a decision about other people. That is a thematic connection, rather than an

established adaptation or influence. Its official Amara Muzik Odia trailer offers an introduction for readers who want to explore it.[73]

ମାଲିପୁଟ (Maliput Melodies): making room for local voices

At IFFI in November 2025, director **Vishal Patnaik** and producer **Kaushik Das** presented an anthology rooted in rural Koraput. The official account describes a production lasting more than two and a half years, with local performers coached for their roles. The filmmakers spoke of local food, speech and everyday culture as part of what they wanted audiences to encounter.[67]

The festival credits give that collective work names: **Sudhakar Patnaik** wrote the screenplay, **Tosh Nanda** composed the music, and **Vishal Patnaik and Santosh Kumar Nanda** edited the film. Its ensemble includes **Md. Shariff, Sona Khemundu, Usha Rani Dash, Dhana Harijan and Brundaban Hantal**, among others.[74]

Here the possibility lies in who gets to participate and whose surroundings become a film's world. Its Indian Panorama screening is a concrete point of recognition, while the AAO NXT trailer offers a way into the work.[75]

ମଧୁମାଳତୀ (Madhumallati): another age of love

Madhumallati places older lovers at the centre of a musical drama. Its release listing names **Sanjay Mishra and Mahasweta Ray**, director **Mrutyunjaya Sahu** and writer **Priyabrata Panda**, with a story of reunion after 35 years apart. BookMyShow dates the release to **16 October 2026**.[76]

The subject broadens the range of lives and relationships a popular film can hold. Alongside the younger characters, rural worlds and genre experiments elsewhere in this chapter, it gives audiences another kind of story to seek out.

These films do not need to resemble one another to sustain the same language. The commercial-successes chapter follows evidence of

audience spending; the economics chapter asks how that income can support further work. The opportunity is to turn the desire for a good story into sustained support for writers, performers, crews and the next production.

On the horizon

These **October 2026 announcements** introduce two projects to follow. Their finished work and its reception remain ahead.

ଦଶାହ (Dassaaha): returning to an audience

Anupam Patnaik announced *Dassaaha* at a special screening of *Pratikshya*. That setting brings a new project before people already gathered around an earlier story. Its announced interest in tradition, emotion and life and death offers a direction to explore; a detailed plot, cast and release date were not established in the material available.[77]

The title poster gives the work a more concrete shape. **Barsha Patnaik and Sanghamitra Behera** are its producers, with **Bishnu Sahoo** on cinematography, **Rashmi Ranjan Dash** on editing, and **Ashish Pradhan and Anurag Patnaik** on music. **Anupam Patnaik** is credited with story and screenplay. These are announced production credits, under Amiya Patnaik Productions in association with Shubham Cine Productions.[78]

The continuity worth following is the relationship between a filmmaking team and its audience: what will people who connected with one film be invited to consider in the next? That remains an open question. A shared occasion or promotional connection does not establish that the new film is a sequel.

ଦେବକନ୍ୟା (Debakanya): a performance tradition meets the screen

Rasesh Mohanty's *Debakanya*, starring **Subhasis Sharma**, places a folk performer's personal and social life within a story involving Puri's **Ghoda Nacha**. The production announced a **November 2026** theatrical release.[79]

The tradition opens a wider path into the series. Odisha Tourism describes **Chaiti Ghoda** as a performance associated with coastal fishing communities: a dancer appears mounted on a dummy horse, mythological episodes are enacted, and improvised dialogue is part of the performance.[80] That combination of movement, speech and shared cultural memory takes us back to the storytelling forms discussed at the beginning of this chapter.

A film can bring a performance tradition before viewers who have never encountered it in person. It can also prompt us to seek out the performers themselves. When *Debakanya* becomes available, there will be room to ask how its fictional story engages with the skills, livelihoods and voices of the people who carry this tradition. The announcement alone cannot answer that question.

Release plans can change. These projects are invitations to follow the work, with space for audiences and practitioners to add their own responses when the films can be seen.

Audiences and income beyond Odisha

The New Indian Express reported that ଦମନ **(DAMaN)** opened in **51 theatres in Odisha and 15 across nine other cities** in November 2022.[81] The DAMaN reading follows that wider reach and the responses to the film.

Overseas announcements show another route to audiences. On 26 April 2023, *OrissaPOST* reported plans to screen ଫାଲ୍ଗୁନ ଚୈତ୍ର **(Phalguna Chaitra)** on 13 May at Hoyts Docklands in Melbourne, Hoyts Blacktown in Sydney and Event Cinemas in Brisbane. A July follow-up

in *OrissaPOST* subsequently reported overseas screenings, including Australia. Neither report supplied receipts or a country-by-country earnings breakdown.[82, 83]

Streaming can reach viewers who have no nearby Odia screening. In Lata Jha's April 2025 report for *Mint*, **Kaushik Das**, founder of Odia platform **AAO NXT**, described overseas viewers seeking stories that reconnect them with home. [84]

Paid screenings, streaming and rights agreements can provide income, but these sources do not establish the share of Odia cinema's earnings from outside the state or overseas. The OTT companion follows the platform and audience questions further.

The story continues on television and online

Cinema is one part of a wider screen culture. Odia television created another rhythm of storytelling through recurring programmes and serials. Prasar Bharati dates the Odia satellite service to 1993 and its round-the-clock broadcasting to 2001.[85]

Streaming added further routes. Tarang Plus's 2019 launch offering combined television channels, films, jatra and original web content. An inherited catalogue and a newly commissioned series could now reach viewers through the same service, although they remained different kinds of production.[86]

The Odia television history follows public broadcasting, private channels, performers and production workers. The Odia OTT journey examines original storytelling, platform economics and audiences beyond Odisha. Together with AIR Cuttack, these histories show how stories can move between forms without every new medium displacing its predecessors.

Keeping the next chapter within reach

The Bologna screening at the beginning of this story adds another question to this contemporary energy. What can another generation actually see?

Preservation depends on teams too. **Shivendra Singh Dungarpur** describes Film Heritage Foundation's conservators repairing *Maya Miriga*. Its restoration credits also name **L'Immagine Ritrovata, Digital Film Restore and Prasad Corporation**, in association with the filmmaker's family, and identify NFDC-NFAI's surviving print. A restored image carries technical labour that a director's name alone cannot acknowledge.[87]

The work behind those names deserves attention too.

The next chapter of Odia cinema history belongs partly to viewers: watching beyond the famous titles, learning the names behind the credits, asking for subtitled and restored editions, and making room for films whose worlds are unfamiliar even within Odisha.

For a viewing journey, one starting point is the household in *Maya Miriga*, followed by the livelihoods in *Bhukha* and today's family dramas, thrillers and popular releases. The companion readings stay with their households, livelihoods and collaborators in greater detail. Which film would you want the next generation to be able to find?

Reported film counts: a dated reference

Film counts can suggest the scale of a working life, but the reports below count different things. Dates and scope travel with each estimate; the rows are not ranked, combined or treated as a current filmography census.

Performer	Bijay Mohanty
Reported estimate	More than 180 films
Date and scope	21 July 2020; Films; languages not separately enumerated.[88]

Performer	Uttam Mohanty
Reported estimate	More than 135 Odia; as many as 30 Bengali; Hindi film Naya Zahar named
Date and scope	28 February 2025; Separate language estimates; other published totals differ.[89]

Performer	Aparajita Mohanty
Reported estimate	More than 100 films
Date and scope	1 February 2021; Films; language scope unspecified.[43]

Performer	Mihir Das
Reported estimate	More than 150 films
Date and scope	12 January 2022; Films in an account of his Odia career; no separate language breakdown.[90]

Performer	Jayiram Samal
Reported estimate	More than 300 films / comic roles
Date and scope	October 2012; Reporter describes Odia films; the interviewee describes comic roles. Those units are not independently reconciled.[91]

Performer	Mahasweta Ray
Reported estimate	Almost 40 lead-film credits
Date and scope	December 2010 article; updated May 2012; Lead-film credits including Bengali films, not all appearances.[47]

Performer	Shyamalendu Bhattacharya
Reported estimate	More than 50 Odia films
Date and scope	15 October 2018; Odia films, in the reporter's introduction.[51]

Performer	Anita Das
Reported estimate	More than 100 films
Date and scope	11 May 2018; Films; languages not explicitly enumerated.[92]

Performer	Siddhanta Mahapatra
Reported estimate	More than 150 films
Date and scope	January 2013; films, language breakdown unspecified.[93]

Watch and explore

Availability and subscription terms can change by location.

- **Official interview: Suvir Nath on Mo Bou, Mo Gaan.** Sansad TV, 7 October 2025.

- **Full-film listing: ଦମନ (DAMaN) on Amara Muzik Odia's YouTube channel.** Amara Muzik Odia.

- **Official trailer: ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା (Pratikshya).** Amiya Patnaik Productions.

- **Official trailer: କର୍ମ (Karma).** Amara Muzik Odia.

- **Official trailer: ବୋଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ (Bou Buttu Bhuta).** Sidharth Music.

- **Official trailer: ଅନନ୍ତ (Ananta).** Amara Muzik Odia.

- **Restoration clip and information: ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga).** Film Heritage Foundation's restoration page and comparison clip, not the full film.

- **Provider catalogue, Odia version: ରିଟର୍ଣ୍ଣ ଅଫ୍ ହନୁମାନ (Return of Hanuman).** Check current access and subscription terms; playback unverified.

People, work and selected milestones

Choose a thread

From a written page to a listening audience

Follow language through adaptation, broadcasting and song.

The page behind the screen

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Who Keeps a Film Alive?

The work of finding a story

Move between a writer, two films and the people who learn together.

Gourahari Das: fiction, public life and the art of listening

Pratikshya: a family waiting for security

DAMaN: the road from Malkangiri to national recognition

Learning Cinema Together

Keeping creative work possible

Connect audiences and income with practical choices for the next production.

Odia Cinema’s Commercial Successes

What Makes the Next Film Possible

Beyond One Successful Film: Building Odia Cinema Together

Follow the work between people: a novel and its screenplay, a song and its voices, a film and those who keep it available. These selected connections are an invitation to return to the chapters and explore further.

People and their work

Literature and the screen

Basanta Kumari Patnaik and Gopal Chhotray · A novel and its screen adaptation

ଅମଡ଼ା ବାଟ (Amada Bata) joins Basanta Kumari Patnaik’s source novel with Gopal Chhotray’s screenplay. Ch. 3, note 7.

Kalindi Charan Panigrahi and Mrinal Sen · Literature and direction

Kalindi Charan Panigrahi receives the story credit for ମାଟିର ମଣିଷ (Matira Manisha); Mrinal Sen wrote its screenplay and directed it. Ch. 4, note 7.

Kanhu Charan Mohanty and Sarada Naik · Novel, screenplay and dialogue

କା (Kaa) draws on Kanhu Charan Mohanty’s novel; its archive credits Sarada Naik with screenplay and dialogue. Ch. 5, note 3.

Manglu Charan Biswal and Sabyasachi Mohapatra · A play becomes a film

Manglu Charan Biswal's ଭୂଖା (Bhukha) became Sabyasachi Mohapatra's Sambalpuri-language film. Ch. 26, note 2.

Sabyasachi Mohapatra and Kapileswar Prasad Mohapatra · Director and credited story writer

ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର (Aadim Vichar) credits Sabyasachi Mohapatra with direction and Kapileswar Prasad Mohapatra with its story. Ch. 28, note 3.

Gourahari Das, Roshan Bisoi and Anupam Patnaik · Screenwriting and direction

ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା (Pratikshya) draws on Das's short story. Its development catalogue names Bisoi as writer and Patnaik as director and producer. Ch. 42, note 3; Ch. 42, note 2.

Bibhuti Patnaik and Nirad Mohapatra · A shared story credit

Bibhuti Patnaik and Nirad Mohapatra share the story credit for Maya Miriga. Ch. 24, note 2.

Basanta Kumari Patnaik and Jatindra K. Nayak · A story in translation

Jatindra K. Nayak translated Basanta Kumari Patnaik's In Bondage into English. Ch. 3, note 2.

Solila Parida and Prasanna K. Pati · A story crosses countries

Parida produced Desires of the Heart from Pati's The Woman from Georgia; the film is in English with some Hindi dialogue. Ch. 2, note 28.

Voices, performance and production

Bhubaneswar Mishra, Akshaya Mohanty and Pranab Patnaik · Composition and playback

ମାଆ (Maa) credits Bhubaneswar Mishra with music; Akshaya Mohanty, Pranab Patnaik and Ila Chakraborty are its playback singers. Ch. 12, note 3.

Prafulla Kar, Pranab Patnaik and Sikandar Alam · Composition and playback

ଛ' ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ (Chha Mana Atha Guntha) credits Prafulla Kar for music, with Pranab Patnaik and Sikandar Alam among its playback singers. Ch. 18, note 1.

Tapu Mishra and Humane Sagar · Playback voices

Tapu Mishra and Humane Sagar are the credited voices on the Ishq Tu Hi Tu title recording. Ch. 11, note 13.

Gour Prasad Ghose and Parbati Ghose · Production and directing partnership

Gour and Parbati produced କା (Kaa) and ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ (Stree); with Ram Chandra Thakur, they shared the directing name Siddharth. Ch. 17, note 4.

Bijay Mohanty and Parbati Ghose · Literary characters on screen

Bijay Mohanty plays Bhagia and Parbati Ghose plays Saria in ଛ' ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ (Chha Mana Atha Guntha), adapted from Fakir Mohan Senapati's novel. Ch. 18, note 1.

Bijaya Jena · Producing, directing and performance

Bijaya Jena produced and directed ତାରା (Tara) and played its title character. Ch. 31, note 1.

Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka · Directing partnership

Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka are named as ଦମନ (DAMaN)'s directors in its Best Odia Film award entry. Ch. 44, note 2.

Deependra Samal · Producer

ଦମନ (DAMaN)'s certification entry names Deependra Samal alongside JP Motion Pictures. Ch. 44, note 6; Ch. 44, note 1.

Learning, experiment and preservation

Nirad Mohapatra · Filmmaker, teacher and film-society organiser

Nirad Mohapatra taught at FTII, organised Cinexstasy screenings and edited the film section of Mana Phasal. Ch. 25, note 1.

Pramod Pati and Abid Surti · Filmmaking and visual art

Abid brought Pati's filmmaking together with Surti's visual art. Ch. 34, note 1.

Biren Das and JD Centre of Art · A television collection's continuing life

Biren Das donated U-matic and Beta tapes to JDCA; selected tapes were digitised with NCAA at IGNCA. Ch. 39, note 1.

Surya Deo and Lipika Singh Darai · Collected traces and a film-history search

IFA's project record names Surya Deo as Lipika Singh Darai's collaborator in Rediscovering Sita Bibaha, drawing on surviving records and memories. Ch. 38, note 2.

Selected milestones

Dates mark different kinds of events; releases, awards, institutions and restorations are identified separately.

28 April 1936 · Formal opening

ସୀତା ବିବାହ (Sita Bibah) formally opens in Puri, following a Calcutta screening in March. Ch. 16, note 5.

1948 · Radio

AIR Cuttack begins in the old Madhupur building. Ch. 10, note 2.

1956 · Film

ଭାଇ ଭାଇ (Bhai Bhai) brings together producer Gour Prasad Ghose and director Nitai Palit. Ch. 17, note 2.

1959 · Film music

ମାଆ (Maa) brings Akshaya Mohanty, Pranab Patnaik and Ila Chakraborty into its playback credits, with music by Bhubaneswar Mishra. Ch. 12, note 3.

1964 · Literary adaptation

ଅମଡ଼ା ବାଟ (Amada Bata) adapts Basanta Kumari Patnaik's novel, with screenplay by Gopal Chhotray and direction by Amar Ganguly. Ch. 3, note 7.

1966 · Literature and film

ମାଟିର ମଣିଷ (Matira Manisha) credits Kalindi Charan Panigrahi for its story and Mrinal Sen for screenplay and direction. Ch. 4, note 7.

22 April 1976 · Institution

Odisha Film Development Corporation is incorporated, with a remit including film production and cinema infrastructure. Ch. 16, note 12.

1981 awards · held in 1982 · National award

ଶୀତରାତି (Seeta Raati) receives Best Oriya Film at the 29th National Film Awards, with Balaram Misra named as producer and Manmohan Mahapatra as director. Ch. 23, note 4.

1984 · Festival selection

ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga) enters the Cannes Critics' Week selection. Ch. 24, note 5.

1986 · Literary adaptation

Parbati Ghose's ଛ' ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ (Chha Mana Atha Guntha) brings Fakir Mohan Senapati's novel to the screen. Ch. 18, note 1.

2 October 1993 · Television service

Doordarshan's Odia regional satellite service begins as DD-5. Ch. 45, note 4.

1993 award year · National award

ଲାବଣ୍ୟ ପ୍ରୀତି (Lavanya Preeti) receives Best Children's Film at the 41st National Film Awards, with A. K. Bir named as director. Ch. 29, note 2.

24 March 2015 · Award announcement

ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର (Aadim Vichar) is announced as Best Odiya Film in the 62nd National Film Awards for 2014. Ch. 28, note 7.

24 August 2023 · Award announcement

ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା (Pratikshya) is announced as Best Odia Film in the 69th National Film Awards for 2021. Ch. 42, note 7.

27 June 2024 · Restoration programme

Il Cinema Ritrovato schedules the restored ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga) in Bologna. Ch. 24, note 2.

16 August 2024 · Award announcement

ଦମନ (DAMaN) is announced as Best Odia Film in the 70th National Film Awards for 2022. Ch. 44, note 2.

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Edition note

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49 readings in 7 parts. The longer overview appears in the companion survey. Suggestions and corrections are welcome through Project Odisha.

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A language. A people. A living screen.

A film begins with people: someone who writes, someone who listens, and others willing to bring a story to the screen. *Odia Cinema: A Living Screen* follows those connections across literature, performance, radio, film, television and streaming.

From the household world of *Maya Miriga* to the journeys of *DAMaN* and *Pratikshya*, these readings explore the work behind recognition, the search for audiences and the care that lets older films be seen again. They invite us to enjoy what has been made, and consider how the next good story might reach its audience.

Ahimanikya Satapathy

Ahimanikya Satapathy, founder and editor-in-chief of Project Odisha, connects research, local knowledge and storytelling. His interest in Odisha's people, language, arts and culture shapes this book: an invitation to discover the people behind cinema and imagine its possibilities.

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